



QUALITATIVE INVESTIGATION

Add a forensic auditor to Ram Temple SIT: SC

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CRITICAL LEAK

Bank of Baroda starts probe into 'data breach'

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'NOT SEEKING TALKS'

Iran says it is still in control of Hormuz

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DATA POINT

Why youth fight for govt. jobs

India should aspire for growth that generates opportunities

OPINION » PAGE 11



DOUBLE DELIGHT

Gyaneshwari and Raja clinch silver medals

SPORT » PAGE 17

NEARBY



'Inam land titles were not in the name of temples'

CHENNAI
Defending the Tamil Nadu government's decision to lift the ban on registration of Inam lands in the name of individuals, HR&CE Minister S. Ramesh said these land titles were not in the name of temples. » **PAGE 8**

Ahluwalia to head panel for revenue augmentation

CHENNAI
The Tamil Nadu government has constituted a Revenue Augmentation Committee under Montek Singh Ahluwalia, former member of the Prime Minister's Economic Advisory Council. » **PAGE 8**

CJP warns of fresh protests over govt.'s 'promise breach'

Centre violating assurance of not taking action against protesters, says CJP; hundreds of students held while many are under surveillance, says its spokesperson; FIRs withdrawn in Bihar, Bengal

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) on Monday warned of fresh protests, accusing the Centre of violating its assurance that no punitive action would be taken against protesters. "We are observing a complete breach of the agreement regarding no police action against the protesters. Hundreds of students have been arrested in Bihar and Bengal, and hundreds are being surveilled/harassed in Delhi and other States," CJP spokesperson Ashutosh Ranka said in a post on X. The statement came following reports of crack-down on volunteers assisting protesters with logistics in various States.



CJP leaders Saurav Das, centre, and Ashutosh Ranka, right, with Rajya Sabha MP Kapil Sibal and others in New Delhi. R. V. MOORTHY

The Bihar government announced later in the evening that it was withdrawing all FIRs against protesters registered before 6 p.m. on July 26. FIRs in West Bengal and Assam have also been withdrawn, the CJP said on Monday night.

In Uttar Pradesh, Samajwadi Party leader Akhilesh Yadav alleged that many students in Prayagraj have been abducted by a special team of police in a vehicle without number plates.

Govt. tables Bill in LS to toughen penalties on leaks

NEW DELHI
The Union government on Monday introduced a Bill in the Lok Sabha providing for harsher penalties for exam paper leaks, amid a huge uproar by Opposition members demanding a discussion on police action against protesting students first. » **PAGE 13**

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RELATED REPORTS ON
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SC considers guidelines for police during mass protests

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

Observing that the constitutional right to peaceful protest must be protected, the Supreme Court on Monday indicated that it may consider framing uniform guidelines to regulate police conduct during large-scale demonstrations. "The right to peaceful protest is absolutely guaranteed under the Constitution. So long as it is a peaceful agitation, merely because there is agitation, there cannot be [police excesses]... If there is police excess committed, it should be independently examined," Chief Justice of India Surya Kant said as multiple petitions concerning protests over examination issues and alleged police excesses were mentioned before the Bench.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 12**

HC strikes down govt. job orders for Karur stampede victims' kin

The Hindu Bureau
MADURAI

The Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court on Monday struck down the government orders (GOs) granting government jobs to the family members of the Karur stampede victims. A Division Bench of Justices C.V. Karthikeyan and R. Sakthivel allowed a batch of public interest litigation petitions which challenged the Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay-led government's decision to grant jobs to the family members of the victims. Earlier, the court had permitted the government to go ahead with an event in Karur in July to distribute the appointment orders. However, it had made it clear that the appointment would be subject to judicial review. The stampede occurred in September last year during a Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam roadshow addressed by Mr. Vijay, who is also the party president. The court said appointment on compassionate grounds was based on specific guidelines. The government submitted that it was only a humane gesture, which should not be challenged.



The Madurai Bench said jobs on compassionate grounds are based on specific guidelines.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 8**

Tamilnad Mercantile Bank

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Unaudited (Reviewed) Financial Results For The Quarter Ended 30th June 2026

Particulars	Quarter Ended 30 th June 2026	Quarter Ended 30 th June 2025	Change/Growth %
TOTAL DEPOSITS	64,409	53,803	19.71
TOTAL ADVANCES	57,306	45,120	27.01
CASA	16,852	14,411	16.94
OPERATING PROFIT	611	412	48.22
NET PROFIT	412	305	34.97
NET INTEREST INCOME	765	580	32.01
GROSS NPA %	0.69	1.22	53 BPS
NET NPA %	0.17	0.33	16 BPS
NIM %	4.29	3.84	45 BPS
ROA %	2.14	1.82	32 BPS
ROE %	15.93	13.30	263 BPS
CRAR %	32.33	31.55	78 BPS
EPS (₹) (Not Annualised)	25.99	19.25	35.01

Sl. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended 30-06-2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter Ended 30-06-2025 (Unaudited)	Year Ended 31-03-2026 (Audited)
1	Total Income from Operations (Net)	1,900.79	1,617.47	6,696.49
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period, (exceptional and/ or extraordinary items)	557.14	403.92	1,806.60
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax, (after exceptional and/or extraordinary items)	557.14	403.92	1,806.60
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax, (after exceptional and/or extraordinary items)	411.51	304.89	1,337.55
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period (comprising Profit / Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)	NA	NA	NA
6	Paid-up Equity Share Capital	158.35	158.35	158.35
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserves)	10,403.67	9,169.92	9,951.81
8	Securities (Premium Account)	769.23	769.23	769.23
9	Net Worth	10,562.02	9,328.27	10,110.16
10	Paid-up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt	-	-	-
11	Debt-Equity Ratio	0.05	-	0.02
12	Earnings Per Share (of ₹10/- each) (Not annualised) (For continuing and discontinued operations)	25.99 25.99	19.25 19.25	84.47 84.47
13	Capital Redemption Reserve	-	-	-
14	Debenture Redemption Reserve	-	-	-

NOTE: 1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly/Yearly Financial Results filed with Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly/Yearly Financial Results is available on the website of the Stock Exchange(s) (www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com) and on the Bank's Website (www.tmb.bank.in). 2. Information relating to Total comprehensive income and other comprehensive income is not furnished as Ind-AS is not yet made applicable to banks. Place: Thoothukudi Date: 27.07.2026

On Behalf of Board of Directors
SALEE S NAIR
Managing Director & CEO

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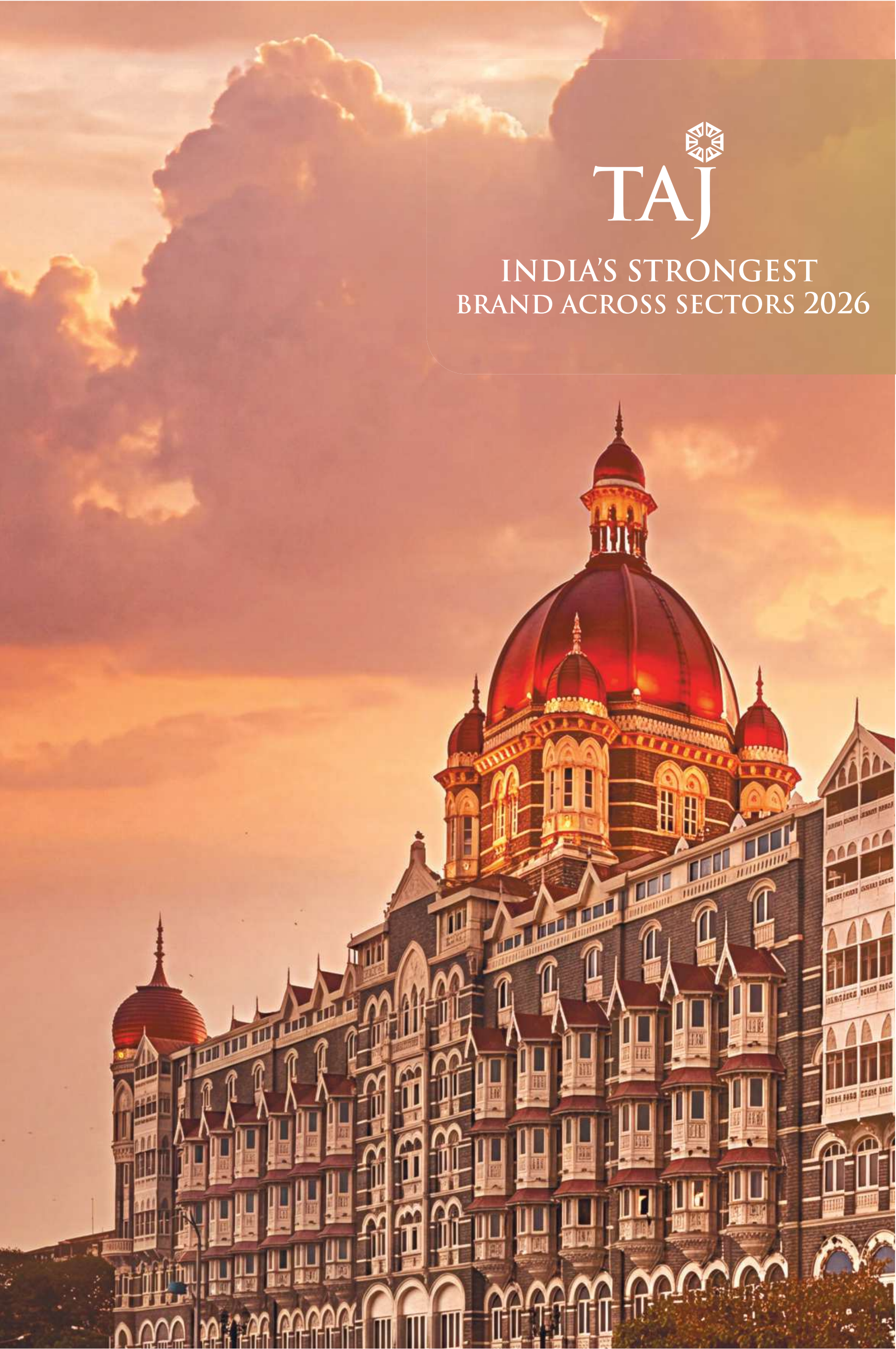
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INBRIEF



ICOI ASEAN Congress 2026 begins at Saveetha University

The International Congress of Oral Implantologists (ICOI) ASEAN Congress 2026 was inaugurated at Saveetha University. ICOI ASEAN Congress 2026 brings together over 700 delegates from across 18 countries for three days, according to a press release. ‘Crafting the Future: Human Artistry in a Digital Age’ was the theme of the event. Five hundred dental professionals will be honoured with the ICOI fellowship, mastership and diplomate credentials at the congress. The programme will have 20 internationally renowned speakers and there will be lectures, panel discussions and scientific sessions. Thiyaneswaran Nesappan, scientific chairman of the congress, spoke. While Deepak Nallaswamy, pro-chancellor, Saveetha University, was the guest of honour, representing ICOI were Betty Palti, executive director, Rick Ferguson, president, Sunil Kumar Nettemu, director and membership chairman of India and ASEAN nations.



‘Gross Enrolment Ratio of 50% by 2035 an achievable target’

Achieving Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) of 50 per cent by 2035, an NEP 2020 target, is possible through a collaborative strategy, V. Kamakoti, director, IIT-Madras said. While speaking at Sandipandi Vidyalaya School’s annual day on Sunday, Mr. Kamakoti said every higher secondary school student and their parents may talk to a minimum of 2-3 families from the marginalised communities and motivate them to enrol into higher education institutions, according to a press release. “If this can be done by every student in each school and create a ripple effect, the target of 50 per cent GER by 2035 can be achieved,” he said. He also distributed prizes to school toppers and special prizes to teachers.

Gang stabs 2 Pachaiyappa’s College students in subway, seven detained

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Two first-year students of Pachaiyappa’s College sustained multiple injuries after they were allegedly attacked by a group of armed youth inside the subway connecting Chennai Central Railway Station with Park Railway Station on Monday.

The Greater Chennai Police detained seven students for

questioning on Monday evening. According to the police, the victims had arrived at Chennai Central Railway Station and were walking in the subway towards Park Railway Station when they were confronted by nearly 20 youth who had allegedly been waiting there.

The gang reportedly attacked the duo with knives before fleeing the spot. The injured students, identified as Hemaraj, 19,

and Nitishkumar, 19, suffered multiple stab and cut wounds to the head, neck, and other parts of the body. Bystanders alerted the police, following which the victims were rushed to hospital for treatment.

Preliminary investigations indicated that the attack stemmed from hostility between two groups of students from the same college. The police have launched a probe.

Chennai Mayor lodges complaint with police over cyberbullying

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chennai Mayor R. Priya said she had filed a complaint with the police against certain social media accounts, alleging that they had been subjecting her to cyberbullying.

Ms. Priya said that on Friday (July 24, 2026), she submitted a list of accounts that had been “continuously bullying” her online for nearly a year, along with the complaint, to Greater Chennai Police Commissioner A. Amalraj.

She added that cyber abuse intensified after the new government assumed office in the State. She said a group of “virtual warriors” had been posting

obscene comments repeatedly. “I am a woman who is an elected representative and the Mayor of the city. If I am facing such issues online, that puts into question the safety of women who are not holding any authority. This will discourage many women who aspire to enter politics,” she told *The Hindu*.

She said many women who spoke against political parties or the State government were subjected to online attacks targeting their physical appearance or personal matters. “It is alright to counter or debate with valid political points, not such slander.” She added that a case had been registered and that the Commissioner had assured her that action would be taken.

Bodies of 2 girls handed over to wrong families at Stanley Hospital

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A lapse at the Stanley Medical College Hospital led to the bodies of two girls – Anushka, 19, from Tiruvallur, and Priyadarshini, 17, from Manali – being handed over to each other’s family after post-mortem.

The error was noticed after Priyadarshini’s relatives opened the coffin at her residence and realised the body was not hers. They informed hospital authorities, who launched an internal inquiry. The inquiry confirmed that the bodies had been inadvertently swapped while being handed over. Hospital staff retrieved the bodies and handed them over to the correct families.

Experts call for State-specific modules in future National Family Health Surveys

At a workshop on NFHS-6, they say that the survey should cover issues such as infertility, ageing, underweight children and migration for Tamil Nadu; an expert underscores the need for more research on nutritional status of children, as 1/4th of children under five years are underweight in the State

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Speakers at a workshop on National Family Health Survey 2023-2024 (NFHS-6) raised the need for State-specific modules in future rounds of the surveys. For Tamil Nadu, they said the survey should cover issues such as infertility, ageing, underweight among children and migration.

S. Irudaya Rajan, chairperson, International Institute for Migration and Development, Thiruvananthapuram, said only 10 of the 101 variables in NFHS-6 are really useful for policy making in Tamil Nadu. Citing Total Fertility Rate (TFR) as an example, he questioned the need to

talk about TFR, which stands at 1.7 for Tamil Nadu, instead of talking about infertility.

He raised the need for more research on the nutritional status of children, noting that children under five years who were stunted in Tamil Nadu stood at 20.7%, wasted was 17.4%, and underweight was 23.2%. “One-fourth of children are underweight. Where are we heading?” he asked.

Similarly, he said that men and women being overweight or obese has implications for the future (44.2% of women and 38.8% of men). Mr. Irudaya Rajan said that NFHS-6 has nothing about the elderly when ageing is an important topic for Tamil Nadu.



An expert said while ageing is an important topic in Tamil Nadu, there’s nothing about it in NFHS-6. GETTY IMAGES

He went on to emphasise the need to look at internal migration - factors such as their living conditions, wages, inability to bring their families and language barriers. “They

are your lifeline. Tamil Nadu should be a model in protecting internal migrants,” he said.

In his inaugural address, K. Srinivasan, former director, International Institute for Population Sciences, Mumbai, gave a brief history of NFHS, which was mainly started to understand factors including fertility, mortality trends, use of contraceptive methods and ideal family size.

‘Simplify questionnaire’ He said there has been considerable increase in the number of sample households interviewed from round-to-round as well as complexity of questions, sensitive questions such as on domestic violence and extramarital sex are asked

by unknown investigators (captured indirectly). He said that it is recommended that the questionnaire be trimmed to meet the basic objectives with which NFHS was started and State-specific modules added, if necessary in future rounds.

Padmavathy Srinivasan, independent consultant in demography, also raised the need to look at State-specific problems and study those in detail.

M. Suresh Babu, director, Madras Institute of Development Studies (MIDS), said caesarean sections, breastfeeding practices, co-existence of malnutrition and obesity, increase in Non Communicable Diseases are among the main concerns raised for further

examination, “We need State-level longitudinal surveys to understand some of these phenomena,” he said.

The workshop was jointly organised by MIDS and School of Public Health, SRM Institute of Science and Technology (SRMIST) on Monday.

Hari Singh, dean and Geeta Veliah and M. Benson Thomas, faculty, School of Public Health, SRMIST gave a presentation on NFHS-6. V.R. Murali leedharan, professor emeritus, Department of Humanities and Social Sciences, IIT-Madras, chaired a panel discussion in which K. Navaneetham, demographer, and Monalisha Chakraborty, assistant professor, MIDS spoke.

Creating awareness



The Ripon Buildings illuminated in green on Monday to mark World Hepatitis Day, as part of an awareness initiative by the Greater Chennai Corporation, Chennai Liver Foundation, and Rotary Club of Chennai Towers. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Japanese films to be screened at Alliance Francaise for 3 days

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Indo Cine Appreciation Foundation will organise a screening programme as part of the Japanese Film Festival.

The inauguration ceremony will be held at Alliance Francaise, Nungambakkam at 5.30 p.m. on July 28. Following the inauguration, the

film *The Hotel of My Dream* by Yukihiko Tsutsumi will be screened at 6 p.m., according to a press release.

The film *Aristocrats* by Yukiko Sode will be screened on July 29 at 6 p.m. Two films are planned for screening on July 30: *Time Scoop Hunter* by Hiroyuki Nakao (5 p.m.) and *The lines draw me* by Tokuhiro Koizumi (7 p.m.)

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Tender Reference No.	BMSICL/2026-27/ME-505
Date of Pre- Bid Meeting	07 th August 2026 at 15:00 Hrs in Conference hall of BMSICL, 3 rd Floor, Swasthya Bhawan, IGIMS Campus, Sheikhpura, Patna (Bihar) All Pre-bid queries to be submitted through e-mail on bmsictenderequipment@gmail.com Upto 10 th August 2026 till 17:00 Hrs. (Note:- No Pre-bid queries would be entertained after the above mentioned dead line)
Last date and time of submission of online bids	01 st September 2026 upto 17:00 Hrs.
Last date and time for submission of original documents of EMD.	02 nd September 2026 upto 14:00 Hrs.
Date, Time and Place of opening of Technical Bid	02 nd September (at 15:00 Hrs.) on the website of https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in the office of BMSICL
Date and time of opening of financial Bids	To be announced later on https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in
Validity of Tender	180 Days
Cost of the tender document	Rs.11,800/- (Eleven Thousand Eight Hundred Rupees only) Non-refundable.
Tender Processing Fee	Rs 1180/- (on the website of https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Note- Changes suggested by prospective bidder in Pre-Bid meeting may be incorporated in the tender document at the sole discretion of the tender inviting authority and for which corrigendum will be issued separately and uploaded on the website & www.bmsicl.gov.in	
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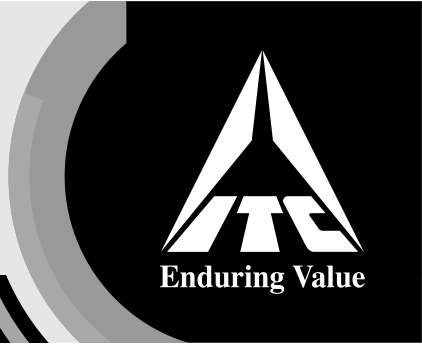




ITC: Partnering India in its Defining Decade

Excerpts from the Address by
Shri Sanjiv Puri, Chairman & Managing Director, ITC Limited

115th Annual General Meeting, ITC Limited | 23 July 2026



We meet today at a time of deep significance — for the world, for India, and for enterprises that aspire to create enduring value. The prolonged uncertainty arising from the West Asia crisis has severely impacted the global economy, threatening energy security and trade. Indeed, the multitude of events in the recent past only reinforce the fact that **global volatility is no more sporadic; it is now systemic**. Last year, in my address, I had described this as an era of **TURN** — a world constantly confronted by **Turbulence, Uncertainty and Rapid change**, calling for **Novel strategies** to reimagine our tomorrows. Today, that reality stands even more pronounced, as a deeper structural shift reshapes the future of nations, societies and enterprises.

What makes this juncture a perfect storm of exceptional complexity and consequence is the confluence of multiple forces at scale. On the one hand, global progress is challenged by the catastrophic climate emergency, widening inequality and advances in disruptive technologies like AI. On the other hand, decades of hyper-globalisation have given way to fragmented multi-polarisation — creating a world that is still deeply connected, but less trusting; still trading yet marred by weaponisation of supply chains; still global, but increasingly nationalistic. These tectonic shifts are being felt across everyday lives — through volatile commodity prices, inflationary pressures, disruptions in trade and the rising vulnerability of food, energy and supply chains.

It is said that crisis challenges the status quo like no other and spurs innovation to forge new pathways for growth, competitiveness and resilience. We stand today at such an inflection point with an unparalleled opportunity to make a meaningful difference to all our shared tomorrows.

It gives us immense pride, therefore, that India's resolute fortitude in accelerating the journey to a competitive, resilient and inclusive nation has earned it widespread trust, respect and admiration.

India's Ascent: A Beacon of Hope and Progress

Against this backdrop, the Hon'ble Prime Minister's powerful clarion call for an **Aatmanirbhar** and a **Viksit Bharat** assumes even greater significance. It has inspired multidimensional interventions enabling India to emerge as the fastest-growing major economy in the world. The far-reaching measures announced in successive Budgets have provided strong foundations to unleash growth. India's ascent is not merely about outpacing other large economies. **It has demonstrated that a nation of continental scale, democratic depth and extraordinary diversity can drive momentum with stability, pursue reform with inclusion, and convert aspiration into resilient growth.**

The India story is indeed an inspiring example of how the Government is creating an all-pervasive Bharat Capability Stack through exemplary foresight and foundational action to reinforce competitiveness for today, resilience for tomorrow and strategic readiness for the decades ahead.

Role of Business: Responsible Competitiveness

It is my deep conviction that businesses, as a crucial organ of society, serve a larger transformational purpose by contributing meaningfully to **national competitiveness, sustainable and inclusive development**.

This philosophy is reflected in your Company's ethos of **Responsible Competitiveness**, which has guided our thought, strategy and action over the years and inspires our commitment to be a **national value multiplier**. To my mind, businesses make a lasting contribution to the nation when they frame their growth agenda around three imperatives.

First, as engines of national competitiveness, it is mission critical for Indian enterprises to be **future-ready and globally competitive**. This calls for trusted Indian brands that anchor domestic ecosystems and retain value in the country; investments in state-of-the-art national assets that support India's ambition to become a global hub for manufacturing, services and exports; a deeper focus on cutting-edge innovation and R&D as well as capabilities for AI-led transformation.

The Hon'ble Prime Minister's vision of Build More, Produce More and Export More raises our collective aspirations to even bolder heights to craft products and services of world-class quality and trust, that earn their rightful place in households and markets across the world.

Taking this tenet further, the **second imperative** is for businesses to evolve as architects of **national resilience and anti-fragility**. While resilience sharpens the capacity to bounce back amidst adversity, anti-fragility goes beyond, to convert adversity into future opportunities. Strengthening resilience calls for locally anchored value chains, stronger MSME partnerships, diversified and trusted sourcing, import substitution, climate stewardship and robust digital adoption. However, the winners of tomorrow must also thrive amidst adversity, nurture new competencies, accelerate innovation and spur new engines of growth. Resilience is no longer the dividend of efficiency nor is anti-fragility a distant objective, they are the very foundation of our right to grow. **When enterprises embed resilience and embrace anti-fragility, they fortify the nation's foundation and position it to rise stronger with every adversity.**

Third, businesses must advance a paradigm of Compassionate Capitalism. Competitiveness gives enterprises the power to win, anti-fragility the right to win the future and purpose the legitimacy to win. Businesses exist to serve both an economic and social purpose. The enormous climate risks, livelihood challenges, inequality and regulations **make it a crucial responsibility of businesses to embed sustainability and inclusion as an integral component of strategy.** This belief lies at the core of your Company's approach.

A few years ago, your Company laid the foundations of the **ITC Next strategy** to drive scale, accelerated growth and profitability and make the enterprise even more future-ready. Guided by the Company's credo of **"Nation First, Sab Saath Badhein"**, our north-star is to **create growing value for all our stakeholders — by building national competitiveness that is globally benchmarked, resilience that is locally anchored, and growth that is anti-fragile, inclusive and sustainable.**

ITC: Ushering in NextGen Agri, Strengthening Rural India

I begin with agriculture — the lifeline of our economy and the foundation of rural India. India possesses vast arable land, diverse agro-climatic zones and leadership in several commodities. Yet, low productivity, fragmented holdings, limited value addition, climate vulnerability and inefficient market access continue to constrain its potential. This points to a defining opportunity to **transform Indian agriculture from volume-led production to value-led competitiveness**, not only to fortify food security but to raise farmer incomes, deepen rural capability and enhance exports.

The Government has spearheaded several commendable measures to support growth of the agri-food sector. Higher farmer incomes can trigger a virtuous cycle of consumption, investment, employment and rural prosperity. This requires a structural shift to shape **NextGeneration Agriculture** — from fragmented productivity to integrated competitiveness, from undifferentiated commodities to high-value agriculture, and from vulnerable farming systems to climate-smart, technology-enabled rural ecosystems.

With over a century of engagement with agriculture, 94% of your Company's businesses are linked to agri-crops or plantations, generating substantial livelihoods. ITC nurtures 21 value chains across 23 States to source nearly 6 million tonnes of agri-produce. In this address, I will focus on ITC's Agri Business, which is now the country's largest private sector agri-enterprise, **doubling segment revenue in just over 5 years to nearly ₹20,300 crore** in FY26. The **ITC Next strategy** is today transforming the Agri Business, while ushering in NextGeneration farming and rural empowerment.

At the core of this transformation is the **ITCMAARS** phytal ecosystem, designed to empower FPOs with digital technologies, hyper-personalised advisories, quality inputs, market linkages, scientific agronomy and climate-smart practices to improve farm competitiveness and resilience. In a short span, **ITCMAARS has onboarded over 2.6 million farmers** across 11 States, with the ambition to benefit 10 million farmers by 2030. Initial estimates indicate **crop yield gains of 15-20% and improvement in net returns by 25-30%.**

Building on a recent horticulture pilot, anchored by FPOs, for the supply of high-quality fruits and vegetables, ITC plans to develop 4 additional hybrid Open-to-Sky and Controlled Environment Agriculture clusters to create a reliable, traceable supply chain for fresh produce. Progressively, **ITCMAARS is introducing precision-led agriculture and advanced agri-tech solutions, like IoT-enabled weather tracking, remote-sensing, drone-based services, to promote smart farming.**

A vital component of your Company's agri strategy is to promote **Value-Added Agriculture** to enable farmers scale the next horizon of profitable growth. This portfolio, which has grown at a CAGR of 33% over five years, today encompasses **certified organic crops, processed agri-products, such as food-safe spices, horticulture, premium coffee, aquaculture and attribute-specific commodities, like high-starch maize and high-gluten wheat.**

Taking this further, **ITCMAARS will drive a Farming as a Service (Faas) ecosystem to 'Grow the Buy', where crop value chains are customised to meet specific buyer needs.** Certifications, traceability and responsible sourcing establish **trust systems at scale**, linking Indian farmers to domestic and global export markets. ITC's Spices Business, for example, is today the country's leading exporter of organic spices, supported by certified cultivation, backward integration and **one of Asia's largest spices processing facilities at Guntur.**

In an era of climate stress and rising food security imperatives, production of **high-quality, resilient seeds and hybrids** is vital to enhancing productivity, improving quality, increasing climate resilience, strengthening nutritional security and raising farmer incomes. Your Company's wholly owned subsidiary **Technico, a global leader in pre-basic potato seeds, is investing in the world's largest state-of-the-art aeroponic facility** with 60 hi-tech controlled-environment greenhouses, taking the combined capacity to 100 million TECHNITUBER's.

Fostering an effective **science-to-farm ecosystem**, ITC's LSTC is leveraging advanced breeding technologies, molecular genetics and digital tools to develop higher-yielding, climate-resilient, hybrid and disease-resistant varieties across crops such as tobacco, wheat, potato, eucalyptus and subabul. **These have led to yields improving by 15-50%.**

Your Company is making appreciable progress in high-value, future-facing categories, such as **Biological Extracts**, with the commencement of a US FDA-compliant, export-oriented, pharmacopoeia-standard **nicotine derivative** processing facility, serving customers in Europe, USA and South Korea. In addition, **ITC's medicinal and aromatic plant ecosystem** is developing high-active varieties and proprietary formulations, besides manufacturing high-purity extracts for domestic and global markets together with farmer training in best practices.

As we look ahead, ITC will continue to work towards shaping a more competitive, resilient and inclusive **new growth drivers but also contributing to enriching rural India, raising farmer incomes, fortifying food and livelihood security, and establishing globally trusted value chains.**

ITC: Proudly Indian Brands — Creating and Retaining Value in India

In a growing consumption-led economy, strong domestic brands assume strategic importance because they channel consumer aspiration into national value. Brands are vital **repositories of trust, quality, innovation and intellectual property.** When successful Indian brands win consumer preference at scale, they **retain larger value within the country.**

That is why **"Vocal for Local"** is not merely a sentiment; **it is a strategy to reinforce domestic capability, create and nurture brands that are born in India but made for the world with impeccable quality and trust that can delight consumers globally.**

Your Company's aspiration to be India's No. 1 FMCG player is anchored on this larger vision. Today, ITC's portfolio of over 30 world-class FMCG brands represents annual consumer spends of **nearly ₹37,000 crore** and reaches around **280 million households** while being exported to over **70 countries.** It is indeed difficult to find parallels globally of an enterprise that has launched so many large, successful and trusted home-grown brands in a relatively short period.

ITC's brands enrich everyday moments in Indian homes — from **Sunfeast** biscuits in the morning, to breakfast choices of **Aashirvaad Besan chillas** and **Yoga Bar** cereals, to **Fiams** bathing experiences, **Mangaldeep** devotional moments and **Classmate's** joy of learning, from baby and pet-safe clean homes with **Nimyle** to meals with **24 Mantra Organic**, **Aashirvaad** staples and **Sunrise** spices, to fun times with **Bingol**, **ITC Master Chef** and **Prasuma** snacks, mini meals with **YIPPeel** and ending the day with **Fabelle** for luxurious indulgence and **Pranah** for relaxation.

The Indian FMCG market is poised for significant expansion, with your Company's addressable market estimated at around ₹8 trillion by 2035, pointing to the immense headroom to grow. The consumer landscape in India is also evolving rapidly. The rise of Aspirational Bharat, premiumisation, Gen Z and Gen Alpha consumers, expanding digital access and the growth of quick commerce are reshaping categories, channels and expectations. Today's **'maximiser consumer'** simultaneously seeks taste and nutrition, convenience and trust, indulgence and wellness, value as well as premium experiences.

In line with the **ITC Next strategy**, your Company is making rapid progress in not only scaling its core power brands but developing a future-ready portfolio that is constantly alive to evolving consumer needs. A critical foundation is ITC's **AI-led consumer insight ecosystem**, that drives **targeted micro-segmentation** to help craft a pipeline of differentiated offerings — be it by life stages, lifestyle, channel, occasion,

shelf-life requirement and health need, among others. This vibrant portfolio has been enriched with new acquisitions in areas of promise that are already clocking an ARR of around ₹1,350 crore, effectively synergising the entrepreneurial energy of start-ups with ITC's scale and institutional strengths. These differentiated products reach millions of homes through your Company's smart omni-channel network with unique multidimensional capabilities across ambient, chilled, frozen and perishable supply chains.

India today faces the twin challenges of adequate nutrition and rising lifestyle-related health concerns. Aligned to ITC's **'Help India Eat Better'** Mission, a **Good-for-You** portfolio is being built to address **deficiencies in protein, fibre, micronutrients and gut health.** These include the **Yoga Bar protein range** for Gen Z, **Sunfeast Breakfast protein-rich shakes** for early jobbers and **Aashirvaad Protein Atta** for the entire family. The **Right Shift** range for the **40-plus cohort** is fortified with fibre, protein and micronutrients. **24 Mantra Organic** provides trusted organic products, while **Aashirvaad Millet Flour, Multigrain Flour, Sunfeast Farmlite biscuits**, and **Yoga Bar** high-fibre breakfast cereals serve the growing need for better fibre intake and gut health.

Leveraging emerging spaces such as wellness and naturals, your Company's Personal Care portfolio reflects the convergence of nature, and science. **Nimyle** brings the goodness of Neem into homeware, while **Savlon** continues to expand its trusted hygiene equity across personal wash, germ protection, surface disinfection and medicated skincare. The acquisition of **Mother Sparsh** marks ITC's strategic presence in premium natural baby care, rooted in traditional Indian knowledge for new-age mothers seeking specialised solutions. Building on **Fiams**'s industry-first gel bar technology, the new **Japanese Hokkaido Milk range**, which is being patented, reflects sensorial innovation that promises non-sticky moisturised skin.

Innovation is at the heart of your Company's future-ready portfolio, which is powered by ITC's **Life Sciences and Technology Centre**, with over 400 world-class scientists. **What sets the Centre apart is not just its deep research capabilities and future-ready platforms, but its focus on end-to-end value chains, from seed to fork and tree to paper, enabling your Company to craft winning products of impeccable quality.**

We recognise that **business innovation is as crucial as product innovation.** Consumers increasingly seek fresh cooked food solutions where freshness, speed, quality and trust converge. Responding to this, your Company launched the **Fresh Food Business**, leveraging ITC's institutional strengths in trusted brands, food sciences, cuisine expertise and digital capabilities. With over 70 cloud kitchens across five cities, the business has grown over 100% in the last three years through a delectable portfolio comprising **Aashirvaad Soul Creations, ITC Master Chef Creations, Sunfeast Baked Creations and Sansho** from ITC Master Chef, which have consistently received top consumer rankings.

Your Company's growing standing in FMCG, powered by the trust of millions of consumers, gives us the confidence to dream boldly — of a future where an ITC product adorns every household in India and makes its mark across continents. ITC's world-class Indian brands will continue to be a significant enduring strength, creating larger value for the enterprise and its stakeholders.

ITC: Powering Make in India for a Viksit Bharat

Your Company's **Bharat Built Manufacturing architecture** has created world-class national assets across **FMCG, Paperboards & Packaging and export-oriented value-added Agri Processing.** Today, ITC's manufacturing ecosystem spans over **300 factories**, including 45 owned plants, engaging with more than **9,500 MSMEs.** These large investments in modern facilities provide strong levers of competitiveness, resilience and local value-chain development.

In the true spirit of Make in India, nearly 90% of ITC's value addition takes place within the country. The agri and food processing industry has high employment-to-capital intensity. Therefore, your Company's 170 factories in this sector are a **powerful economic multiplier, deepening inclusive farm-to-consumer value chains and linking farmers to domestic and global markets.**

Your Company's confidence in the India story is reflected in its proposed medium-term capex of ₹20,000 crore for the Group in areas that have a multiplier impact. Close on the heels of 8 recently commissioned facilities, 6 new projects are in the pipeline. Your Company's leadership as **India's largest integrated paperboards and paper business** will be reinforced by the forthcoming acquisition of Century Pulp & Paper, raising capacity by over 50% to 1.5 million metric tonnes. The newly established **state-of-the-art Moulded Fibre Products** facility is pioneering complex engineered compostable solutions for single-use plastic substitution for both domestic and global markets. As each of your Company's businesses scales up in line with the ITC Next strategy, its manufacturing ecosystem is poised to expand further, contributing to India's aspiration to be a global manufacturing powerhouse.

Your Company's distributed manufacturing network is also a **vibrant hub of innovation, quality, sustainability and safety besides providing structural competitiveness.** An AI-first digital backbone in ITC's manufacturing facilities enhances efficiency, cost optimisation and responsiveness. Several units now meet nearly 100% of their electricity needs from renewable sources, are Platinum-rated green buildings or have achieved global AWS standards.

In line with ITC's deep commitment to an **Aatmanirbhar Bharat**, your Company is also placing sharper thrust on indigenisation and import substitution to **build structural competitiveness.** Your Company pioneered the **Bharat Fibre chain** for its **Paperboards** business through massive afforestation, substituting imports and saving foreign exchange while creating a **green cover, substantial rural livelihoods and larger value in India.** Today, this initiative has greened **nearly 1.5 million acres, generating over 270 million person-days of employment.**

ITC also established the **first-of-its-kind Bleached Chemi-Thermo Mechanical Pulp Plant** at Bhadrachalam, creating domestic capability in specialised pulp, and is now investing in a second BCTMP mill. Additionally, investments have also been made in domestic capsule manufacturing capacity and a Décor Paper plant to substitute imports. These interventions will significantly enhance cost competitiveness while also enabling foreign exchange savings exceeding **₹17,500 crore over the next decade.**

For us at ITC, this is the larger meaning of **Bharat Built**

Manufacturing in action — to build globally competitive domestic manufacturing assets, substitute imports, enrich the environment and support sustainable livelihoods.

ITC: Supporting Climate Action & Inclusive Growth

I now turn to two defining imperatives of our times — **climate resilience and livelihood generation** — both vital for a sustainable, inclusive and competitive future. For India, climate risks are acute, severely impacting agri-food security, livelihoods, productivity and infrastructure.

While the Government has spearheaded world-leading efforts, the consequences of the climate crisis demand far more urgent, collective and sustained action at scale — globally, nationally and locally.

To my mind, enterprises can take transformational measures to combat climate change and also foster inclusive development. ITC's comprehensive approach addresses climate risks through large-scale programmes aimed at decarbonisation, adaptation, nature-based solutions and circularity, while also implementing a mosaic of solutions for rural empowerment.

What differentiates ITC's sustainability journey is a triad of achievements. First, **Longevity**, that is reflected in decades of sustained environmental impact. Second, **Scale**, which is demonstrated through the massive creation of ecological capital and support to millions of livelihoods. Third, **Integration**, through a distinctive model where sustainability and inclusivity are core pillars of strategy, governance and programmes.

ITC is the only company in the world to be carbon positive, water positive and solid waste recycling positive for around 2 decades now. ITC's businesses support nearly 9 million sustainable livelihoods.

Decarbonisation remains an important element of our climate action. Over the years, your Company has made significant investments in areas like renewable energy, green infrastructure and mobility. It is a matter of immense satisfaction that ITC has **surpassed several of its ambitious 2030 Sustainability 2.0 targets**, even as our businesses have expanded considerably. We are now committed to achieving **Net Zero Operations by 2050**, entailing a reduction in GHG by over 85% in the next 25 years.

While Decarbonisation has gained significant traction globally, **Adaptation** measures have not drawn the attention they deserve. The world, after breaching the 1.5°C threshold last year, is headed towards 2.8°C warming in this century if stronger pathways are not pursued. This is clearly alarming and calls for decisive and urgent action.

Recognising this, ITC has implemented impactful **Adaptation and Nature-based Solutions** for ecosystem restoration that strengthens climate resilience, enhances farm productivity, water availability, green cover and biodiversity while supporting rural livelihoods. ITC's **Climate Smart Agriculture**, which now spans nearly **32 lakh acres** across 17 States, benefits over **12 lakh farmers.** It is premised on focused programmes that **build strong capabilities through skilling, technology adoption and development of institutional linkages.** We propose to cover **40 lakh acres under this initiative by 2030.** Impact studies have shown that CSA practices in rice and wheat have reduced costs by **over 20%, improved yields by around 10% and enhanced net returns by over 23%** compared to conventional practices.

Your Company has built deep capabilities in water stewardship, afforestation and biodiversity conservation. ITC's **large-scale water management interventions** follow a three-pronged approach — community-led watershed programmes, demand-side agricultural water management and revival of river sub-basins. Demand-side initiatives, focussing on **"more crop per drop"**, cover over 20 lakh acres, creating annual water-saving potential of **up to 50% across 15 crops, aggregating to 1.5 billion cubic metres.**

Supply-side watershed projects cumulatively span nearly **20 lakh acres**, helping around **90% of farmers** in catchments to cultivate through the year. Four river sub-basins have been made water positive, with work under way on the fifth. Such water stewardship interventions have improved gross cropped area by as much as 12%, cropping intensity and groundwater levels by up to 14 and 15% whilst delivering larger benefits for communities.

Biodiversity conservation is a key priority area for sustaining natural ecosystems, strengthening agri-food security, supporting rural livelihoods and building long-term resilience. Your Company's programme focuses on restoring ecosystem services that support agriculture. This is expected to cover **nearly 10 lakh acres by 2030.**

Your Company's **Social Investments Programme spans 275 districts in 20 States**, cumulatively benefiting over **10 million people**, including **6 million women** while amplifying impact with 98 public-private-people partnerships. While the scale and outcomes are deeply satisfying, what inspires us to do more are the human stories behind the numbers.

It is heartening to **witness farmers with better incomes, women with greater economic agency, children with stronger learning foundations and youth with improved employability.** This larger purpose to make a meaningful difference defines the core of our social endeavours.

India's ancient wisdom enshrined in **Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam** reminds us that the world is one family, and the responsibility to protect our only home — the planet as well as its people — rests on all of us. We believe that our **'dharma' of Responsible Competitiveness** and the spirit of **'Aparigraha' to mindfully use resources** as well as **'Abhyudaya'** which is **premised on simultaneous economic and societal progress**, are timeless principles that will continue to inspire us in creating enduring value for all stakeholders.

In Conclusion

As India advances towards becoming a developed nation, ITC will remain steadfast in its commitment to serve with purpose, innovate with responsibility, grow with the nation and multiply value for our country. **Our heart and soul have always belonged to India. This has been our legacy. It will remain our promise.**

It is a privilege for ITC to be part of this momentous journey — powered by an inspiring Vision, guided by unshakeable Values, and energised by renewed Vitality.

As I conclude, I would like to reaffirm my belief that your Company's greatest and most enduring asset is its people. It is their dedication, ingenuity and unwavering commitment that give wings to our ambition, resilience to our efforts and purpose to our progress. Their dedication gives us the courage to dream boldly and shape ITC as an exemplary institution of a new India with **passion, performance and purpose.**

On behalf of the Board and myself, I thank all our stakeholders for their continued trust, support and encouragement.

Together, let us partner India and help build a future worthy of the aspirations of this great nation.

APPOINTMENT



PONDICHERRY UNIVERSITY
(A Central University)
DR. B.R. AMBEDKAR ADMINISTRATIVE BUILDING
R.V. NAGAR, KALAPET, PUDUCHERRY – 605014

Advt.No: PU/RC-NT/2026/52 Dated: 24.07.2026

RECRUITMENT OF COUNSELLORS (ON CONTRACT)

Applications are invited from eligible candidates for engagement of 2 numbers of Counsellor on **contract basis**.

For details of the Qualifications, Job Requirements, Application form and General and Important Instructions to Applicants etc., visit the University website: recruitment.pondiuni.edu.in.

Last date for submission of Offline application is **10.08.2026**.

REGISTRAR



Centre For Railway Information Systems
Chennai, New Delhi-110021

TENDER NOTICE
Tender No: 2026 CRIS ELECT 02 dt. 27/07/2026; Subject: Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of Maintenance-Free VRLA(Valve Regulated Lead Acid) Batteries of 12V, 200 AH on Buy-Back Basis for UPS Systems of CRIS Data Centre at CRIS Office, Chitrayapuri, New Delhi-110021
Tender Closing Date: 17/08/2026 (15:00 hrs). Tender Documents can be downloaded from Website www.ups.gov.in. For future modification/extensions please see www.ireps.gov.in.



THE HINDU

Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-



Ministry Of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises
MSME - TECHNOLOGY DEVELOPMENT CENTRE - (CCDC)
An Autonomous body under Ministry of MSME, Govt of India
A-11 Industrial Area, Firezone-28/2020, www.ccdcindia.net

GOVERNMENT CERTIFICATE COURSE ON AI FOR PHARMACEUTICAL R&D

Course Duration : 4 Days (ONLINE) Date: 01.02.08 to 09.Aug.2026
Time : 6:00 PM to 8:30 PM

Course Content: Introduction to AI, Target identification, AI use in drug research, Molecular docking, Lead optimization, Pharmacodynamics, Pharmacokinetics basics, Dose response studies, Formulation development, Quality control in R&D, Patent filing in pharma, Regulatory documentation, Clinical trial design, Data analysis in trials, New drug approval steps, Vaccine formulation.

Fees - Rs.3,54,07/- (Study material in soft copy shall be provided)
REGISTRATION ONLY IN MSME TDC 608 ABROUNT
Coordinator: 8603769900, 9953920498, 8168984069
Government of India certificate will be awarded



इण्डियन ओवरसीज़ बैंक
Indian Overseas Bank
आपकी प्रगति का सच्चा साथी Good people to grow with

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY DEPARTMENT
Central Office: 763, ANNA SALAI, CHENNAI-600002

Indian Overseas bank (IOB) invites bids for the following:
GOVERNMENT E-MARKET PORTAL - PROCUREMENT OF DECEPTION TOOL.

BID NO: GEM/2026/B/7830742 DATED 24.07.2026

The Above GEM Tender document is also available and can be downloaded from the following websites www.job.bank.in & www.gem.gov.in For Tender details and future amendments, if any, keep referring to the following website www.gem.gov.in



JHARKHAND URBAN INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT COMPANY LIMITED
(Govt. of Jharkhand Undertaking)
JUIDCO Bhawan, KUTCHERY ROAD, RANCHI, JHARKHAND
Ph.No.: +91-651-2225878,e-mail id-juidcolimited@gmail.com,CIN: U45200JH2013SGC001752

Project Name: Construction of Municipal Building at Chhatarpur under Chhatarpur Nagar Panchayat.
NIT No.: JUIDCO/NIT/MB/Chatarpur/714
PR No.: 383923
Tender ID: 2026_UDD_115912_1

This is for information of all the bidders that following Corrigendum is being made in tender documents for **“Construction of Municipal Building at Chhatarpur under Chhatarpur Nagar Panchayat”**.
The bidders are advised to take into account the following Corrigendum before submission of their bids against this tender.

Sl. No.	Bid Document Ref.	Description	As per RFP Document	As per Corrigendum - 1
1.	NIT	Last Date & Time of submission of Bid, Tender Fee and EMD online	28/07/2026 at 17:00 Hrs	04/08/2026 at 17:00 Hrs
2.		Date & Time of Bid Opening	29/07/2026 at 17:00 Hrs	05/08/2026 at 17:00 Hrs

Note: Other terms and conditions remain unchanged.

Sd/-
Project Director (Technical)
JUIDCO Ltd.

PR 385960 Urban Development and Housing(26-27).D



KALYANA KARNATAKA ROAD TRANSPORT CORPORATION

Stores & Purchase Department, Central Offices, Sarige Sadana,
Main Road, KALABURAGI - 585 102.
Mobile No. 77606 86172 (COSP), 77609 92029 (S.O).

No.KKRTC/CO/COSP/05/2026-27. Dated:27.07.2026

TENDER INVITING NOTICE
(THROUGH KPP PORTAL MODE ONLY)

Tenders through KPP Portal (pre-qualification & commercial) are invited for supply of following items.

Sl. No.	Tender No.	Tender Nomenclature	Estimate Value(Rs.)	Last date for submission of tender
1.	KKRTC/2026-27/IND0221	Procurement of Tyre, Tube & Flap Sets, Tubeless Radial Tyres and Additional Tubes & Flaps	18.55 Crore	28.08.2026 at 15.00 hrs
2.	KKRTC/2026-27/IND0222	Procurement of Pneumatic Door Closure Assembly & Spares	0.29 Crore	17.08.2026 at 15.00 hrs
3.	KKRTC/2026-27/IND0223	Procurement of Window Flocked EPDM Rubber Channels.	0.11 Crore	17.08.2026 at 15.00 hrs
4.	KKRTC/2026-27/IND0224	Procurement of Automotive Bulbs	0.39 Crore	17.08.2026 at 15.00 hrs
5.	KKRTC/2025-26/IND0159/CALL-5	Procurement of Minor Garage Equipments	0.29 Crore	17.08.2026 at 15.00 hrs
6.	KKRTC/2026-27/IND0212/CALL-2	Procurement of First Aid Box & Medicine	0.35 Crore	17.08.2026 at 15.00 hrs

All the details of Tender, Registration, Tender form documents etc. are available at <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in/Mail to cospnekrtc@gmail.com or support@eprochelpdesk.com> for further information if required. Further, any addendum /corrigendum related to changes in terms and conditions of tender, specification and calendar of events etc. will be uploaded only through KPP portal.

Sd/- Controller of Stores and Purchases
(Tender Inviting Authority)

DIPR/Kalaburagi/357/Deshpande Publicity/2026-27



TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF ANDHRA PRADESH LIMITED
(A Government of Andhra Pradesh Undertaking & an ISO 27001:2022 Certified Company)
VIDYUTH SOUDHA, VIJAYAWADA-520004.

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

The APTRANSCO invites bids online for **Spec.No.PMM11-e-58/2026:** Supply of 17 Nos Thermovision Cameras. **Date & Time of availability of above tender: 27.07.2026 at 6:00PM.** Websites: www.tender.aeprocurement.gov.in
Contact No. CE/Transmission: **0866- 2429230.**

R.O.No.GMCC/APTRANSCO/110/26-27 Sd/- Chief Engineer/Transmission



BENGALURU EAST CITY CORPORATION

Office of the Assistant Conservator of Forest
HRB Colony, Phoenix Mall opposite, Mahadevapura,
Bangalore-560048, Telephone No: 9900245013,
E-mail: acfeastgba@gmail.com

No: ACF/BECC/TENDER/ 45/2026-27 Date: 27.07.2026

TWO COVER SYSTEM

Short Term Tender Notification
(Through GoK KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> only)

The Assistant Conservator of Forests, BECC, Bangalore on behalf of the Commissioner, BECC invites works tenders two cover systems from Contractors registered in Greater Bangalore Authority or equivalent registration / CPWD / KPWD / FOREST / Railways / MES / National Highway or any State Government Organizations for the works detailed in the table below.

S.N.	Name of the work
1	Raising of Monsoon Plantation in East City Corporation of Mahadevapura Zone-1 for the year 2026-27 and Maintenance during the year 2027-28 and 2028-29 in Mahadevapura Assembly Constituency Limits -3850 Plants (GBA BECC Grants). Tender Cost Rs.: 80.00 lakhs, EMD: Rs.1,60,000/-. Period of Completion : 31-03-2029.
2	Raising of Monsoon Plantation in East City Corporation K.R Puram zone for the year 2026-27 and Maintenance during the year 2027-28 and 2028-29 in K.R. Puram Assembly Constituency in Bile Shivala Main Road Bairathi, Arkawathi BDA Layout , Rampura Lake Main Road Rampura, Vaddara palya Layout Vaddara palya, Jayarama Reddy Layout Bairathi, Akshya soorya Layout Seegehalli, Abhivruddi Layout Seegehalli, Maruthi Meadows Layout Kottanuru and K.R. Puram Assembly Constituency Limits - 4450 Plants (GBA BECC Grants). Tender Cost Rs.: 91.50 lakhs, EMD: Rs.1,83,000/-. Period of Completion : 31-03-2029.
3	Raising of Monsoon Plantation in East City Corporation Zone - 1 (C.A) for the year 2026-27, and Maintenance during the year 2027-28, 2028-29, 2029-30 and 2030-31 in Mahadevapura Assembly Constituency in Bellanduru Lake-3840 Plants (Compensatory Afforestation Grants). Tender Cost Rs.: 119.98 lakhs, EMD: Rs.2,00,000/-. Period of Completion : 31-03-2031.
4	Raising of Monsoon Plantation (C.A) in East City Corporation K.R Puram Zone for the year 2026-27 and Maintenance during the year 2027-28 and 2028-29 in K.R. Puram Assembly Constituency limits of Kalkere Lake and Rampura Lake- 3840 Plants (Compensatory Afforestation Grants). Tender Cost Rs.: 119.98 lakhs, EMD: Rs.2,00,000/-. Period of Completion : 31-03-2031.

Calendar of events: 1) Date of Commencement of Download of Document from KPPP website: 29.07.2026, 5.00 PM after wards 2) Last Date and Time for uploading Online Queries in Procurement : 31.07.2026 Up to 4:30 PM. 3) Date and Time of Pre-Bid Meeting : 04.08.2026 at 4:30 PM. 4) Last Date and Time for uploading of Tender sine Procurement portal for : 07.08.2026 Up to 5.30 PM. 5) Opening of technical document : On 10.08.2026 at 11.00AM.

Sd/- Assistant Conservator of Forests



झारखण्ड राज्य विवरजेज कॉरपोरेशन लिमिटेड, राँची
(झारखण्ड सरकार का उपक्रम)
उत्पाद भवन, भुवनेश्वर, नवीन प्रोडिक्ट्स के समीप, कॉक रोड, राँची- 834008
कॉर्पोरेट पहचान सं० -U51228JH2010SGC014519, TIN No - 20520108277
E-mail :- jsbcl.jharkhand@gmail.com

अति अल्पकालिन ई-आमंत्रण पत्रांक सं०-JSBCL/07 दिनांक- 27.07.26

इच्छा की अभिव्यक्ति हेतु अति अल्पकालिन ई-आमंत्रण सूचना

क्र०सं०	विवरण	अभ्युक्ति
1	इच्छा की अभिव्यक्ति के प्रपत्र को वेबसाइट https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं http://jsbcl.in पर अपलोड करने की तिथि	दिनांक- 28.07.2026
2	इच्छा की अभिव्यक्ति को ऑनलाईन https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in के माध्यम से जमा करने की प्रारम्भिक तिथि	दिनांक- 29.07.2026
3	इच्छा की अभिव्यक्ति को Online रूप से जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि	दिनांक- 04.08.2026 के अपराह्न 06.00 बजे तक
4	इच्छा की अभिव्यक्ति को ऑनलाईन माध्यम से तकनीकी बिड खोलने की तिथि	दिनांक- 06.08.2026 के अपराह्न 03:00 बजे

नोट- (1) इच्छा की अभिव्यक्ति की विस्तृत जानकारी प्राप्त करने हेतु <https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> एवं <http://jsbcl.in> से डाउनलोड किया जा सकता है।
(2) इच्छा की अभिव्यक्ति हेतु आवेदन ऑनलाईन <https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> माध्यम से ही स्वीकार की जायेगी।
(3) तकनीकी बीड एवं वित्तीय बीड अलग-अलग भरे जाएंगे। किसी भी परिस्थिति में तकनीकी बीड में एक साथ अंकित वित्तीय बीड स्वीकार नहीं किए जाएंगे।

ह०/-
महाप्रबंधक (संचालन)
झारखण्ड राज्य विवरजेज कॉरपोरेशन लिमिटेड, राँची

PR 385941 Excise(26-27)#D



भारत सरकार/ GOVERNMENT OF INDIA / अंतरिक्ष विभाग/ DEPARTMENT OF SPACE
विक्रम साराभाई अंतरिक्ष केंद्र/ VIKRAM SARABHAI SPACE CENTRE
निर्माण एवं अन्वेषण ग्रुप / CONSTRUCTION AND MAINTENANCE GROUP
त्रिचुरवनपुरम/ THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - 22 / (फोन नं./ Ph. No. 0471 - 2564568 / 5669 / 4537/4545)

ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करते हुए संक्षिप्त सूचना / BRIEF NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

भारत के राष्ट्रपति की ओर से निम्नलिखित कार्यों के लिए ई-टेंडरिंग द्वारा अनिवार्य मद-दर निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। On behalf of the President of India, online item-rate tenders are invited through E-tendering for the following works.

- वीआरसी, वीएसएससी, तुंबा में सड़क का पुनःपुछलेन कार्य / Road resurfacing works at VRC, VSSC, Thumba NIT No. VSSC/CMG/CO11/11/2026-27 Dt. 24.07.2026. (बी.ए.सी/P.A.C: ₹ 465.50 लाख/Lakhs)
- डाउनलोड करने की अवधि/Period for downloading: दिनांक 25.07.2026, 10.00 बजे/hrs से/ to दिनांक 06.08.2026, 23.00 बजे/hrs. (Sl. No. 1)
- आइआइएसएच, वट्टिक्कावु में एलएच2 ऊष्मीय कक्ष सहित कोणीय गति अनुकरण के लिए प्रस्तावित भवन में विद्युत कार्य / Electrical works in proposed building for Angular Motion Simulator with LN2 Thermal Chamber at IISU, Vattiyoorakavu. NIT No. VSSC/CMG/EO1/06/2026-27 Dt. 24.07.2026. (बी.ए.सी/P.A.C: ₹ 36.23 लाख/Lakhs)
- डाउनलोड करने की अवधि/Period for downloading: दिनांक 24.07.2026, 18.00 बजे/hrs से/ to दिनांक 06.08.2026, 23.00 बजे/hrs. (Sl. No. 2)

इच्छुक निविदाकार व्यौरों के लिए www.tenderwizarad.in/isro या www.isro.gov.in देखें।/ Interested tenderers may visit www.tenderwizarad.in/isro or www.isro.gov.in for details.

प्रधान, सीएससी, वीएसएससी
Head, CMG, VSSC



BRIDCUL (ब्रिडकुल)

ब्रिज, रोपवे, टनल एवं अवर इन्फ्रास्ट्रक्चर डेवलपमेंट कॉरपोरेशन ऑफ उत्तराखण्ड लिमिटेड
(उत्तराखण्ड सरकार का उपक्रम) पूर्व में उत्तराखण्ड राज्य आवासयोजना विकास निगम लिमिटेड
प्रधान कार्यालय: अदरबाधमा भवन, 583-ड, राजकीय आईआईटीआरई
निरंजनपुर के सामने, आजरा, सहारनपुर रोड, देहरादून- 248001
CIN No - U45203UR2008SGC032591 टेलीफ़ैक्स - 0135-2522941, ई-मेल - bridcul@gmail.com
Ref : - 1143/BRIDCUL- 979(I)/26 Dated: 27/07/2026

E-Tendering (2nd Call)

On behalf of Hon'ble, Governor of Uttarakhand, E-Tender are invited by Managing Director BRIDCUL, from the Contractors registered with any Govt./Semi Govt./PSU/Nigam in suitable Class & Category for the works given as below:-

S. No	Ref No.	Name of Project	Estimated Cost (In Lac including GST)	Earnest Money (In Lac)	Cost of Tender Document (In Rs.)	Time Period
1	BRIDCUL/HQ HLD/17/2026-27	SITC of Lift work for State Guest House at Tanakpur Distt. Champawat.	62.48	1.25	5000 + 18% GST	12 Month

For above tenders, document download start date is 29.07.2026 and Bid submission end date is 12.08.2026 at 1500 Hrs. The details of e-tender of above works can be obtained directly from website <https://uktenders.gov.in>
Changes, if any will be intimated only through website <https://uktenders.gov.in>

DGM (HQ)



Government of Rajasthan
Directorate of Civil Aviation
State VIP Hanger, Sanganer Airport, Jaipur-302011
Tel. Fax, No. 0141-2550543 E-mail dcaraajasthan@gmail.com

RFPI/TO/00380 Dated: As E-signed

NOTICE INVITING BID

Directorate of Civil Aviation, Jaipur, Rajasthan invites proposals from eligible entities for establishment, operation and maintenance and transfer of DGCA approved Flying Training Organisations (FTOs) on State-owned airstrips as is where is for a period of 20 years up to 11:00 AM on or before 19-08-2026. Other particulars of the RFP may be seen on the procurement portals (<https://eproc.raajasthan.gov.in> or <https://sppp.raajasthan.gov.in/>).

UBN	Tender ID No.
4. DCA2627SLOB00002	2026_CIVAV_575607_1
5. DCA2627SLOB00003	2026_CIVAV_575633_1
6. DCA2627SLOB00004	2026_CIVAV_575641_1

DIPR/C/13087/2026 Director

E-Auction Notice for Leasing of SLR/LVPH

For and on behalf of the President of India, the Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager, South Eastern Railway, Kharagpur invites E-Auction Notice for Leasing of SLRs/LVPHs for a period of 03 (Three) years for transportation of parcels in the trains which are notified in the <https://www.ireps.gov.in/> website: (1); **Category:** Parcel; **Catalogue No:** LEASE-KGP-26-08; **Date of e-Auction:** 05.08.2026; **Auction Start time:** 11:00 hrs.; **Auction Close time:** 16:50 hrs. (2) **Category:** Parcel; **Catalogue No:** LEASE-KGP-26-09; **Date of e-Auction:** 07.08.2026; **Auction Start time:** 12:00 hrs.; **Auction Close time:** 12:40 hrs. Interested parties and contractors to take note of this and go through the website as mentioned above for details of the trains and related information about the E-Auction notice. For enquiries/clarifications if any, please contact the office of the undersigned.

Senior Divisional Commercial Manager/KGP
South Eastern Railway
We serve with a smile



AHMEDABAD MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
(BRIDGE PROJECT DEPARTMENT)
E - Tender Notice
Expression of Interest (EOI)

Sr. No	Name of Work
1.	EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI) For BRIDGE HEALTH MONITORING SYSTEM FOR THE WORK OF INSTALLATION, COMMISSIONING AND OPERATION OF BRIDGE HEALTH MONITROING SYSTEM (BHMS) FOR VARIOUS BRIDGES IN AHMEDABAD CITY.

Bid Available for Downloading : Dt. 29/07/2026
Date of Bid Opening : Dt. 02/09/2026
Details and Website available on : www.tender.nprocure.com

DY. MUNICIPAL COMMISSIONER (BRIDGE PROJECT)



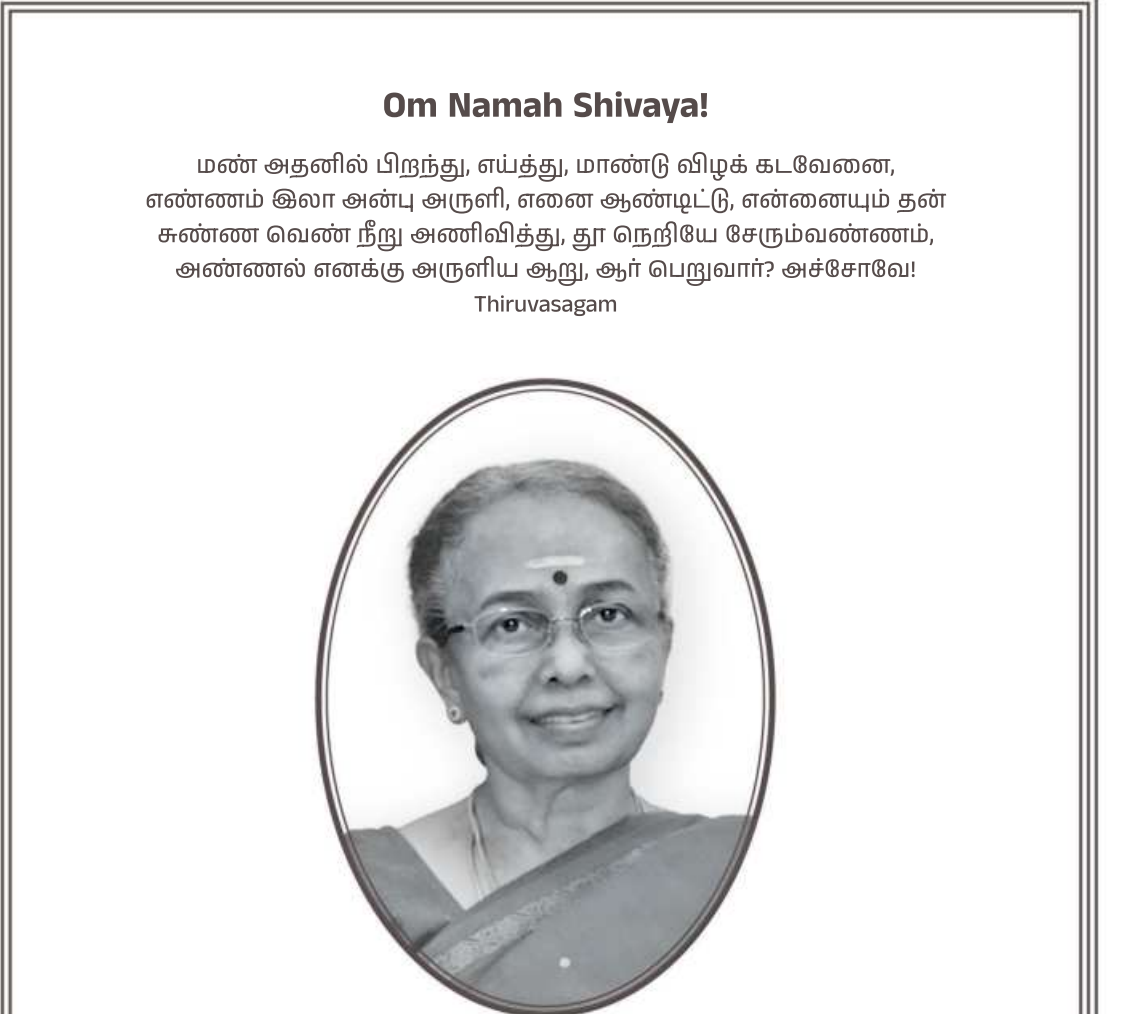
Your feedback will keep us Cleaner, Sharper and Bolder

Call our toll-free number
1800 102 1878

Or write to us at
customercare@thehindu.co.in

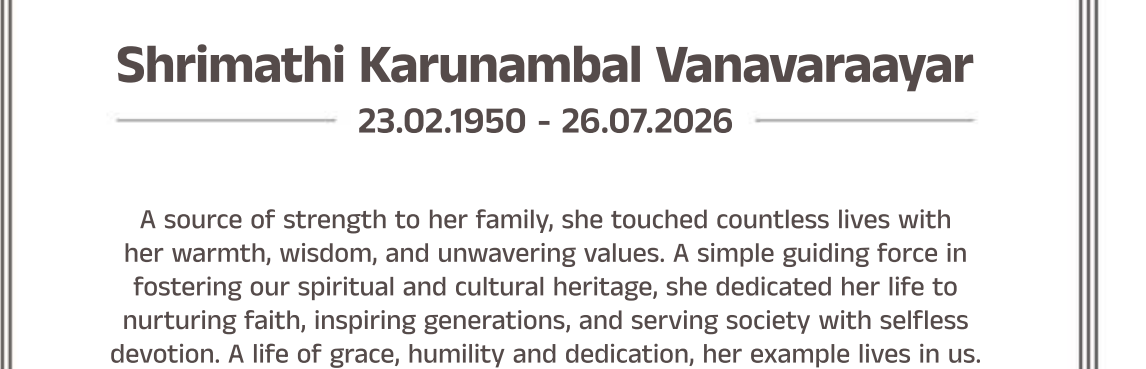
Scan the QR code to register your feedback

THE HINDU **thehindubusinessline.**
FRONTLINE **SPORTSTAR** **you@world** **THE HINDU**



Om Namah Shivaya!

मणं अतुनीलं पिरुन्तु, एयत्तु, माण्डु वीमुक्क कडवैवणे,
एण्णनंम इल्ला अण्णु अरुणी, एणेने अण्णुण्डु, एण्णैण्णयुं तण्
कुण्णण ववण्णं न्नीनु अण्णिवित्तु, त्ता न्नेन्नीयै सैरुंमवण्णणंम,
अण्णण्ण एण्णक्कु अरुणीयु अरु, अण्णं प्पेन्नुवार्? अक्शैवै!
Thiruvasagam



Shrimathi Karunambal Vanavaraayar
23.02.1950 - 26.07.2026



A source of strength to her family, she touched countless lives with her warmth, wisdom, and unwavering values. A simple guiding force in fostering our spiritual and cultural heritage, she dedicated her life to nurturing faith, inspiring generations, and serving society with selfless devotion. A life of grace, humility and dedication, her example lives in us.

A CH-CHE

A CH-CHE

INBRIEF



FIR registered over posters at NEET protest in Bengaluru

The protest over NEET question paper leak at Freedom Park in Bengaluru has triggered a political controversy after the police registered an FIR against a woman for allegedly displaying “provocative posters” during the demonstration. As part of the nation-wide agitation, about 1,500 students gathered at Freedom Park on July 24, where the woman allegedly displayed posters referring to Umar Khalid and Sharjeel Imam, the accused in the 2020 North-East Delhi riots case.

Yet another amoebic brain fever death reported in Kerala

A 48-year-old man from Kozhikode died of amoebic meningoencephalitis on Monday. Biju, an autorickshaw driver from Naderi, had been undergoing treatment at the Kozhikode Government Medical College Hospital. He sought treatment for fever earlier this month, and amoebic meningoencephalitis was confirmed on July 22. According to the Health department, there have been 14 cases of the infection across Kerala this month and four deaths.

Pay ₹50,000 for underweight packet, Parle and retailer told

A Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission in Kerala has directed Parle Products Private Limited and the Metro Hypermarket at Chakkarakkal in Kannur district to jointly pay ₹50,000 to a consumer after finding that a biscuit packet labelled 150 gram had only 125 gram. The consumer, who bought the packet in July 2024, said he decided to pursue the case to ensure that companies are held accountable, and that consumers know they can seek legal remedy.

SC order doesn’t speak of riparian States’ nod: Centre

Union govt. says 2018 order does not say that Karnataka must get consent of other States to build any structure across Cauvery; Karnataka maintains Mokedatu project will not affect T.N.’s share

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

In what could bolster Karnataka’s stand on the proposed Mokedatu balancing reservoir across the Cauvery, the Union Ministry of Jal Shakti has said that a 2018 Supreme Court judgment on the Cauvery dispute does not mention that Karnataka must obtain the consent of other riparian States, to construct any structure across the river.

The statement came on Monday in response to an unstarred question in the Rajya Sabha by Pattali Mak-



Karnataka is planning a dam over the Cauvery at Mokedatu to meet the drinking water needs of Bengaluru. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

kal Katchi member Anbumani Ramadoss. He sought to know whether the Centre was aware of the February 2018 Supreme Court verdict relating to the Cauvery water dispute,

which, according to the query, required the upper riparian State of Karnataka to obtain the consent of the lower riparian States, including Tamil Nadu, before constructing any structure

HC orders HYDRAA Commissioner’s exit

Marri Ramu
HYDERABAD

In a significant development that could have wider implications for the functioning of the Hyderabad Disaster Response and Asset Protection Agency (HYDRAA), the Telangana High Court on Monday directed the Chief Secretary to relieve IPS officer A.V. Ranganath from his post as HYDRAA Commissioner and appoint a suitable replacement.

The direction came while the court was hearing a batch of contempt

cases arising out of allegations that HYDRAA officials violated court orders during an operation at a disputed land parcel in Lothkunta.

At the heart of the controversy is a 40 acre property claimed by M/s Shanta Sriram Constructions Private Limited. The company alleged that HYDRAA officials entered the land in July with nearly 50 vehicles and around 200 personnel, and damaged containers, chairs, tables and other office infrastructure, asserting that the land belonged to the government.

Kerala nominates its expert on dam panel

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Kerala has nominated Ashutosh Dash as its nominee on the Independent Panel of Experts (IPOE) on the Mullaperiyar dam.

Following Kerala’s protests over what it termed the “unilateral” decision of the National Dam Safety Authority (NDSA) to remove its nominee from the panel, the NDSA had on June 25 written to the State to nominate an expert to represent it.

Mr. Dash is a former Chief Engineer and a form-

er across the river.

In a written reply, Minister of State for Jal Shakti Raj Bhushan Choudhary said, “As per the Supreme Court judgment dated February 16, 2018, regarding the Cauvery dispute, there is no mention that Karnataka has to obtain the consent of other riparian States, namely Tamil Nadu, Kerala and the Union Territory of Puducherry, to construct any kind of structure across the river.”

Karnataka has been contending that the project at Mokedatu in Bengaluru South will not affect Tamil Nadu’s water share.

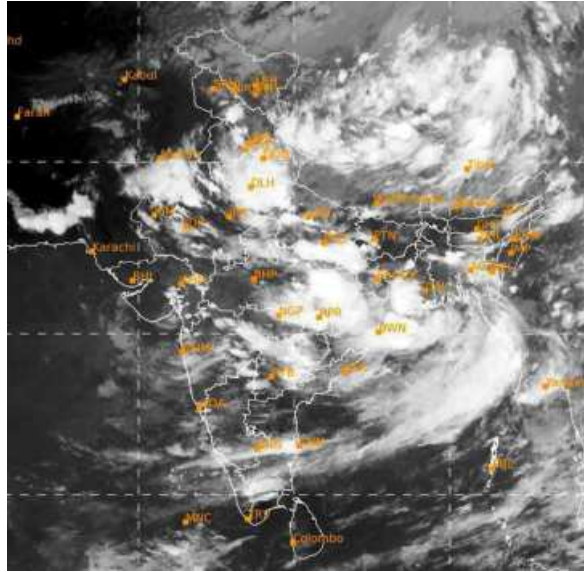
er Special Secretary to the Odisha government, Water Resources department sources said. The NDSA was informed about the State’s nomination last week.

The NDSA, in line with the provisions of the Dam Safety Act, 2021, had created the IPOE comprising five members for carrying out a comprehensive dam safety evaluation of the Mullaperiyar dam on January 6.

The removal of Kerala’s nominee T.K. Sivarajan had sparked protests by the State government.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



Forecast for Tuesday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Gujarat, Himachal Pradesh, Chandigarh, Delhi, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Assam, Mizoram, Tripura, Sikkim, West Bengal, Jharkhand, Odisha, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Konkan & Goa, Karnataka, Kerala and Mahe

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN		
Agartala		7.6.....	34.4.....	25.6	Kurnool		34.6.....	25.7	
Ahmedabad		13.2.....	29.4.....	25.1	Lucknow		9.4.....	33.3.....	27.6
Aizawl		15.2.....	33.0.....	21.0	Madurai		40.4.....	27.5	
Bengaluru		28.6.....	21.4	Mangaluru		33.1.....	29.6.....	23.8	
Bhopal		31.8.....	24.2	Mumbai		12.....	30.5.....	23.0	
Bhubaneswar		1.8.....	32.6.....	24.0	Mysuru		30.8.....	20.4	
Chandigarh		40.8.....	34.8.....	25.4	New Delhi		38.1.....	28.6	
Chennai		38.7.....	29.6	Patna		36.4.....	28.7		
Coimbatore		33.0.....	22.6	Port Blair		1.8.....	30.5.....	24.6	
Dehradun		0.9.....	31.6.....	25.3	Prayagraj		35.6.....	25.3	
Gangtok		7.....	22.8.....	18.6	Puducherry		33.6.....	27.9	
Goa		56.....	29.1.....	24.0	Pune		8.2.....	27.8.....	22.3
Guwahati		13.....	34.3.....	26.4	Raipur		1.....	31.9.....	26.0
Hubballi		13.....	28.0.....	22.0	Ranchi		28.4.....	24.0	
Hyderabad		13.2.....	30.9.....	23.2	Shillong		28.2.....	17.6	
Imphal		31.3.....	22.1	Shimla		16.8.....	22.....	17.5	
Jaipur		35.3.....	27.5	Srinagar		30.8.....	18.9		
Kochi		13.4.....	31.4.....	24.6	Thiruvananthapuram		33.6.....	25.2	
Kohima		26.0.....	19.0	Tiruchirappalli		38.7.....	28.4		
Kolkata		4.6.....	31.3.....	26.4	Vijayawada		17.....	35.0.....	24.6
Kozhikode		6.....	31.5.....	25.5	Visakhapatnam		0.1.....	32.5.....	28.5

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing											Yesterday
CITIES	SO ₂	NO _x	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE	Observation made at 4.00 p.m., Raebareilly, Uttar Pradesh recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 276 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Madikeri, Karnataka recorded a healthy AQI score of 13				
Ahmedabad		71		59		55		82		84	
Bengaluru		20		23		36		39		61	
Chennai		5		12		12		65		65	
Delhi		17		54		72		111		230	
Hyderabad		13		14		20		49		50	
Kolkata		16		20		59		68		82	
Lucknow		14		10		40		50		114	
Mumbai		1		397		20		16		22	
Pune		11		19		64		24		31	
Visakhapatnam		20		65		24		52		94	

Air Quality Code: ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)
SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.
NO_x: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.
CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.
PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

‘Shoot the protesters’ jab by Hindutva supporter kicks off row

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Hindutva ideologue T.G. Mohandas from Kerala faced a barrage of criticism on Monday after a recent video of him saying he “would have shot” the protesters at Jantar Mantar if he were in control, surfaced online.

Mr. Mohandas, a former head of the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)’s State intellectual cell, made the comments in a video posted on his YouTube channel *Pathrika* on Sunday.

In a 30-minute video, Mr. Mohandas speaks at length about how he would have tackled the student protests against the NEET exam irregularities.

“I will impose a curfew in about a four square kilometre area around Jantar Mantar. Then I would announce thrice for the crowd to disperse. After that, I will shoot. People will scatter away and run for their lives. Some may die, some may suffer disabilities. Within four hours, the situation will be calm. Then I will collect the bodies and take them to hospitals,” he said.

In another video, he said secular women who take part in protests “enjoy being gangraped”.

“Gangrapes will happen. In this case, there won’t be any complaints as these are people who like being raped. There are women who like being raped, especially Leftists, secular, democratic and proletarians,” he said.

Rajya Sabha MP A.A. Rahim, told *The Hindu* that Mr. Mohandas’s comments will be “dealt with legally.”

Silent dreams



Grim smiles: With his sleeping child seated on the bicycle and a little girl beside him, a vendor waits with his colourful smiley balloons along a busy roadside in Bengaluru on Monday. SUDHAKARA JAIN

T.N. imposes ban on transport of rough stones to other States

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government has imposed a three-month ban on transportation of rough stones and its aggregates to other States, except Puducherry and Karaikal, with immediate effect.

The government has amended the Tamil Nadu Prevention of Illegal Mining, Transportation and Storage of Minerals and Minerals Dealers Rules, 2011, by inserting a new rule 3(A) with regard to “Transportation of Minerals to other States” and a Government Order (G.O.) has been issued in this re-

gard. The Director of Geology and Mining will regulate the transport of rough stone, which includes khandas, boulders, and building and road construction stones to the other States. This has been done to ensure the supply is sufficient in Tamil Nadu.

According to the G.O., Tamil Nadu has been consistently witnessing infrastructure development and urbanisation, which requires a steady supply of building and construction materials. Since large-scale movement of rough stone and aggregates to neighbouring States occurs, it has caused constraints in the availability of construc-

tion materials in the State. The present production from the operational quarries is not adequate to entirely meet the domestic demand. Also, the constant movement of these heavily-loaded trucks damage the local roads and routes, resulting in traffic congestion for commuters.

When transportation to other States occurs, it leads to enormous supply-demand gap and ‘fuels unscientific or illegal quarrying’, according to the order. This results in excessive mining, well over the authorised depths in most cases, and poses serious threat to environment and ecology.

Karnataka CM seeks support of MPs for 13 major projects

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar on Monday sought the cooperation of Members of Parliament (MPs) in working for the State’s progress and particularly to get Centre’s clearance for 13 proposals. They include the Satellite Town Ring Road for Bengaluru, re-opening of HAL airport for commercial operations and Bengaluru Suburban Rail Project.

Mr. Shivakumar held a dinner meeting with MPs from the State in Delhi for the first time after becoming Chief Minister, which was attended by Union Mi-



Key huddle: Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar chairing a meeting with MPs in Delhi on Monday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

nisters Pralhad Joshi, V. Somantha, and Shobha Karandlaje, among others.

He appealed to MPs to convince the Centre to provide approval for pending irrigation and drinking water projects and extend drought relief to the State.

Seize financial documents from Shwetha panel: actors



Shwetha Menon

tration Act, 1955, and such other enabling provisions of law as may be applicable, to safeguard the interests of the association and its members”.

Account freeze

“We further request that immediate directions be issued to the bank concerned to refrain from honouring any cheque or

permitting any operation of the association’s accounts until the lawful governing body assumes complete charge of the books of accounts, financial records, banking credentials and other assets of the association,” it said.

The actors said the association maintains more than ₹6 crore in its bank accounts.

“We are informed that several signed cheque leaves continue to remain in the possession of the former office-bearers. The bank concerned may not yet have been informed of the change in the governing body and may inadvertently honour cheques presented by persons who are no longer authorised to operate the accounts of the association, risking financial loss,” they said.

Suspected drug peddler rams car into policemen

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

A suspected drug peddler rammed his car into police personnel while attempting to flee a raid by the Hyderabad City Police’s Narcotics Enforcement Wing in Abids on Sunday, leaving two policemen injured.

The police was acting on a tip-off on a drug transaction that was to take place in Abids, and had kept the area under surveillance. They intercepted a car in which the suspected peddler had arrived to allegedly supply narcotics.

Forced labour farce

India should not let the U.S.'s new tariffs push it towards a trade deal

The 10% tariff that the United States has imposed on India and several other countries over their imports of goods supposedly made using forced labour is merely an attempt to restore permanent tariffs and, once again, highlight the benefits of a trade deal with the U.S. The U.S. Supreme Court's February 2026 decision dealt a body blow to the U.S.'s attempts to secure trade deals. The main threat, of high reciprocal tariffs, had been removed. U.S. President Donald Trump's solution, of a temporary 10% tariff on all countries, suffered from two weaknesses: it would expire in 150 days, and was levied on all countries equally, regardless of whether they had a deal with the U.S. or not. Those tariffs have now expired. The Section 301 'forced labour' tariffs announced last week are more permanent, and have carved out benefits for those with trade deals with the U.S. For example, while U.S. imports from India will face a 10% tariff over and above the base tariff the U.S. charges everybody, the European Union and Taiwan will face a total tariff of 10%. Similar benefits have been accorded to Japan, South Korea and Switzerland, all of which also have trade deals with the U.S. at various stages of formalisation. If stopping forced labour was the primary focus, tariffs would have been applied equally across all offenders, regardless of trade deal status. The tariffs would also not have had as many product-wise exemptions and country-wise quotas as the final version has.

There is also the question of whether the U.S. should be penalising other countries for their trade with third parties. India has not been accused of using forced labour, yet faces tariffs because others have been. This, soon after the U.S. government told a court that it did not want to act as the "world police". India has done well to reduce the proposed 12.5% tariffs to a final 10%, the same as or better than most of its competitors. All it took was a notification banning the import of goods made using forced labour. The action itself will be difficult to enforce, since it will require countries such as China and Malaysia to allow Indian government officials to visit and investigate their labour conditions. But simply issuing the notification won India a tariff reduction. However, uncertainty persists since the other Section 301 investigation, on excess capacity, is yet to play out and could result in further tariffs. It is highly unlikely that India will accept a trade deal until those tariffs become clear. That said, the tariffs should not push India towards a deal. Experience has shown that the U.S. tariff landscape can change radically even after a deal is signed.

All art, no deal

Donald Trump miscalculated timing and substance of Saudi nuclear deal

The announcement of a United States-Saudi Arabia civil nuclear deal, in the midst of a U.S.-Iran war that began over Tehran's nuclear programme, could hardly have come at a worse time. Matters became more complicated when U.S. President Donald Trump, after the agreement had been signed, added a new condition: that Saudi Arabia should join the Abraham Accords. Saudi Arabia has long sought to develop a civilian nuclear programme. Crown Prince Mohammad bin Salman, or MBS, wants to end the kingdom's "addiction" to oil. His Vision 2030 aims to diversify the economy through finance, megaprojects, tourism and power-hungry artificial intelligence (AI) data centres. The kingdom currently relies heavily on oil and gas for electricity generation. Saudi officials believe that nuclear power would help meet rising domestic energy demand, while freeing more oil and gas for export. MBS first took up his nuclear ambitions with Mr. Trump during the latter's first presidential term. His successor Joe Biden offered a deal but made it contingent on Riyadh joining the Abraham Accords. At that time, Saudi Arabia appeared open to normalising ties with Israel, but Hamas's October 2023 attack on Israel and Israel's genocidal war on Gaza prompted the Saudis to shelve the idea. The July 22 deal suggested that Riyadh and Washington continued talks and remained keen on nuclear cooperation.

As a signatory to the NPT, Saudi Arabia has every right to pursue a peaceful nuclear programme. But the agreement announced by U.S. Energy Secretary Chris Wright leaves open the possibility of nuclear enrichment on Saudi soil. This flies in the face of the U.S. opposition to any Iranian enrichment on its soil. The agreement, according to U.S. media reports, does not require Saudi Arabia to adopt the IAEA's Additional Protocol, which grants inspectors broad powers to conduct short-notice inspections. The omission has fuelled concerns that the kingdom could eventually acquire the technical capability to weaponise its nuclear programme. Facing domestic criticism, Mr. Trump declared that the deal would proceed only if Saudi Arabia joined the Abraham Accords – a condition which was conspicuously absent when the agreement was signed. This apparent reversal is unlikely to reassure Riyadh, which is already questioning the reliability of U.S. security guarantees. If the deal eventually goes ahead, Tehran is likely to harden its position on enrichment in any future nuclear talks with the U.S. If Mr. Trump's objective was to reassure a long-standing ally while signalling strategic leverage over a regional rival, the execution of the deal has had the opposite effect. Ill-timed diplomacy, ambiguous provisions and shifting conditions have deepened Saudi concerns and strengthened Iran's resolve. That is the result of Mr. Trump's version of the "art of the deal".

Beyond compliance, India's road to cleaner mobility

The debate over India's proposed Corporate Average Fuel Efficiency (CAFE) III norms comes at a crucial time for the global automobile industry as it transitions from internal combustion engines (ICE) to electrified powertrains. It also highlights India's vulnerability to imported crude oil amid renewed geopolitical tensions. The framework India adopts today will influence investment, technology choices and energy security for decades.

CAFE III, compliance or transformation
The Power Ministry's July 16 draft notification marks the third iteration of CAFE III after months of industry lobbying. While some manufacturers pushed for stricter norms, others sought flexibility. The proposal attempts a compromise, but the question remains whether it prioritises compliance over transformation.

CAFE norms set annual sales-weighted average fuel-efficiency targets for manufacturers' passenger vehicle fleets rather than individual models. Introduced in the United States in 1975 after the 1973 Arab oil embargo, they aimed to reduce oil dependence and protect consumers from high fuel costs. The rules caused automakers to adopt smaller, more efficient vehicles. This also helped accelerate the rise of Japanese manufacturers.

From the 1990s, fuel-efficiency regulations gained a second purpose: reducing greenhouse-gas emissions. In the United States, the EPA's Endangerment Finding brought greenhouse gases under the Clean Air Act, with later emissions standards aligned closely with CAFE rules. While technology-neutral, the rules encouraged innovation in hybrids and electric vehicles (EV). Ironically, the Obama administration's \$465 million Department of Energy loan to Tesla in 2010 helped accelerate an EV industry now dominated by China.

China's experience is even more instructive. It introduced mandatory fuel-consumption standards in 2004, initially regulating individual vehicle models by weight rather than fleet averages. As car ownership surged, concerns over oil imports and urban air pollution grew. The standards tightened over time before China changed direction in 2018 with the introduction of its Dual Credit System.

Under this framework, manufacturers must meet both Corporate Average Fuel Consumption (CAFC) standards and New Energy Vehicle (NEV) credit requirements. Fuel-efficiency compliance alone is insufficient. Companies that fail to earn enough NEV credits through EV or plug-in hybrid production must purchase credits from those with surplus EV production, creating a market that rewards innovation and penalises delayed electrification. For example, in India, Maruti Suzuki could remain NEV credit-deficient by 18%



Kunal Shankar

Weak fuel efficiency norms risk keeping the country dependent on imported oil

despite having highly fuel-efficient ICE models if it had no EVs in its portfolio. It would need to buy credits from companies such as Tata Motors or Mahindra, which generate NEV credits through their EV portfolios. While CAFC credits can be banked, carried forward or transferred within corporate groups, NEV credits cannot be offset in the same way. The results are evident. According to the International Energy Agency's Global EV Outlook 2026, China sold more than 13 million electric cars in 2025, accounting for almost 55% of new passenger vehicle sales. Comparable figures were about 27% in the European Union, nearly 10% in the U.S. and around 4% in India.

India's own debate has centred on differences between Maruti Suzuki, Tata Motors and Mahindra & Mahindra. An earlier proposal effectively carved out lighter small cars from the full stringency of CAFE III. That exemption has since been removed. The current proposal seeks to reduce average emissions from around 113 gCO₂/km to 77 gCO₂/km by FY2031-32. On paper, that appears ambitious. Yet, the headline target tells only part of the story.

The cost of flexibility
The revised framework introduces several flexibility mechanisms that, taken together, substantially reduce its effective stringency.

The first is the Carbon Neutrality Factor, which awards compliance benefits for vehicles compatible with higher ethanol blends and other fuels. Yet, the government has informed Parliament that no decision has been taken to move beyond E20 blending (20% plant-based ethanol with 80% regular petrol). Manufacturers therefore receive compliance advantages for technologies whose long-term policy trajectory remains uncertain. Ethanol is also more expensive than petrol, and has lower energy density, and therefore delivers lower mileage – a fact belatedly acknowledged by the Centre after it drew severe criticism.

The second is the use of super credits. Battery EVs, plug-in hybrids, strong hybrids and flex-fuel vehicles receive additional weight in fleet calculations. While this encourages cleaner technologies, it also means that fewer actual low-emission vehicle sales are required to offset higher-emission models. Strong hybrids, which generally rely primarily on the ICE while using electric propulsion over relatively short distances and at lower speeds, also receive super-credit benefits despite offering only partial electrification.

The third mechanism is banking and trading of compliance credits. Manufacturers outperforming their targets can accumulate credits and sell them to others. In addition, the draft allows companies to buy credits directly from the Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE) at administratively fixed prices if deficits remain

after trading. The BEE is therefore not a market exchange but effectively a seller of last resort.

In theory, this introduces efficiency into the system. In practice, it allows companies that are lagging to meet compliance requirements without upgrading their own technology. Moreover, the draft notification allows manufacturers to buy compliance credits from the BEE at ₹2,500 per gram of CO₂/km in FY2028, rising to ₹4,500 by FY2032. By comparison, the Energy Conservation Act prescribes additional penalties of ₹25,000 or ₹50,000 per vehicle depending on the extent of non-compliance. Expressed in CAFE terms, the lower penalty threshold is broadly equivalent to a little over ₹5,000 per gram of CO₂/km, implying that the proposed buyout price begins at less than half that level.

Finally, compliance is assessed over three-year blocks before shifting to two-year blocks, allowing manufacturers to average performance across multiple years rather than meeting targets annually. Therefore, delays in one year can be compensated in another.

The case of CNG
Taken together, these mechanisms significantly alter the stringency of these regulations. Which raises a fundamental question: What is the purpose of a regulation?

Regulation should shape markets rather than simply accommodate prevailing market preferences. India's own experience with compressed natural gas (CNG) illustrates the point. Once policy support aligned with regulatory certainty, manufacturers rapidly introduced CNG variants. Regulation can create markets as much as respond to them.

To put this in perspective: manufacturers' voluntary commitments already average nearly 20% EV share by 2030, with several original equipment manufacturers aiming for 30% or higher. In effect, the revised regulation attempts only half of what the industry itself has committed to. The timing also matters. India remains heavily dependent on imported crude, exposing the economy to geopolitical shocks, imported inflation and currency pressures. Strengthening fuel-efficiency standards is therefore not merely an environmental objective. It is an energy-security strategy, an industrial policy and a macroeconomic imperative.

These developments highlight the urgency and significance of revising India's CAFE norms, as they offer an opportunity to address a macroeconomic vulnerability while helping meet India's Glasgow commitment on energy efficiency.

India should seize this opportunity to position itself alongside the world's leading automotive markets in the transition to low-carbon mobility.

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AI's next test — reaching India's informal women worker

India's journey towards Viksit Bharat by 2047 rests on whether the productivity gains unlocked by artificial intelligence (AI) are broadly shared or concentrated among those already well-served. AI is reshaping value chains across agriculture, logistics, health care and financial services. The design choices in these systems, who they are built for, whose data they train on, and whose languages they speak, will determine whether this transformation amplifies India's inclusive growth story or adds a dimension to structural inequalities.

About 82% of working women in India are in informal employment according to a 2018 ILO report, spanning agriculture, home-based production, domestic services and micro-enterprises. The gender implications of AI adoption are, above all, a question of economic inclusion. India's AI Governance Guidelines, released in November 2025, set out seven guiding principles, including fairness and equity; translating these into gender-responsive outcomes is both a governance priority and a development opportunity. As UN Women has warned, AI is already reimagining reality for billions, but it is still getting women wrong; without gender-responsive design, testing and oversight, it risks amplifying stereotypes, discrimination and digital violence instead of expanding opportunity.

In agriculture and informal work
AI holds considerable promise for Indian farmers through precision agriculture applications, real-time advisory on crop health, input optimisation and market access. With 76.9% of rural women engaged in agriculture as in Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) 2023-24 reporting, women are a primary constituency. Early evidence is telling: a 2024 study of Farmer.Chat, deployed across 12 States, found that 61% of women users reported improved quality of life within 45 days, with engagement levels two to three times those of male users. While the specific design features driving this outcome



S. Krishnan

Secretary, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), Government of India



Shoko Ishikawa,

Country Representative, UN Women India and part of Team UN in India

Artificial Intelligence (AI) must empower informal women workers for truly inclusive economic growth

require further documentation, the results suggest that when AI agricultural tools reach women, keeping in mind language, land access patterns, mobility constraints, and relevance, meaningful engagement follows. Building on this foundation, three areas merit focused attention as India scales its AI deployment.

Governance priorities
First, gender impact assessments. The India AI Governance Guidelines' principles of fairness and equity require operationalisation through proportionate gender impact assessments for AI systems affecting economic opportunity, welfare access or safety for women and girls. These should examine whether outcomes vary by sex, location, caste, disability and work status, and whether redressal mechanisms are accessible in regional languages. Where AI decisions on credit, employment or welfare cannot be explained, trust suffers disproportionately among marginalised groups. Similarly, Gender Responsive Budgeting offers a practical test for decisions on AI spend. For any significant AI investment, four questions can be applied: which women will benefit; which specific barrier (access, language, safety or capability) is being addressed; how outcomes will be measured; and which budget line will finance corrective action if results fall short.

Second, AI literacy as public infrastructure. Access to tools is a necessary but not sufficient condition for inclusion. Training programmes for women in informal work must be designed around their time constraints, literacy levels and livelihood contexts. Embedding AI literacy within Deen Dayal Antyodaya Yojana - National Rural Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NRLM), Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Grameen Kaushalya Yojana (DDU-GKY) and Skill India, with linkages to Mission Shakti's Sakhi network, would allow trusted community infrastructure to carry new digital capability. The measure of success should be outcome-based: did this help a woman access an entitlement, navigate a platform, or move to

better-paid work? Third, digital safety as a condition for economic participation. Technology-facilitated gender-based violence, including deepfakes, online harassment and non-consensual imagery, creates a measurable "chilling effect", discouraging women from participating fully in digital economic spaces. The IT (Amendment) Rules, 2021 require grievance mechanisms for harmful content; the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)'s proposed mandatory labelling of AI-generated synthetic content adds further protection. Effective implementation, with accessible survivor-facing remedies in regional languages, is a prerequisite for women's sustained digital participation.

The National Commission for Women's review of cyber laws provides evidence-based recommendations warranting timely inter-ministerial action.

AI prosperity for all
India has built substantial AI infrastructure in a short period: the IndiaAI Mission, the BHASHa Interface for India (BHASHINI) multilingual platform, the AI Governance Guidelines and targeted cross-sector partnerships. The India AI Impact Summit 2026 showed that these ambitions are matched by a growing ecosystem of practitioners, innovators and civil society.

The opportunity is to ensure that the productivity gains from this infrastructure reach those at the base of the economic pyramid, viz., women farmers, home-based workers, self-help group members, platform participants. This requires deliberate design: in procurement standards, training programmes, safety frameworks and the measurement of success.

By 2047, the measure of India's AI success should not be aggregate indicators alone, but whether women in informal work have gained meaningful, productive access to the tools and opportunities that AI enables. That is the standard consistent with Viksit Bharat, and it is within India's reach.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Beyond sympathy
It is amusing that the Prime Minister and the Home Minister have expressed deep concern for the students and youth of the nation, particularly after the government faced sustained protests under the banner of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP). If they truly

believe that students are important, should they not accept overall responsibility for unfortunate actions against students?
Tharcius S. Fernando,
Chennai

Now that the protest is over and a committee has been formed to recommend a

robust mechanism for conducting examinations, I presume the issue will gradually be pushed into the background. However, to ensure effectiveness and improve the quality of students we prepare, the government must focus on strengthening the foundation of education,

which begins at the school level. Instead of playing around with language and

historical facts, the emphasis should be on building a strong value

Corrections & Clarifications

Neha Bora is the All India President of the All India Students' Association (AISA), and not the "Delhi secretary of AISA" (Inside pages, "Hunger strike was challenge to govt., the movement is still on, says AISA secretary" (July 27, 2026).

The Readers' Editor's office can be contacted by Telephone: +91-44-28576347/28576300; E-mail: readerseditor@thehindu.co.in

system and providing sound, science-based learning at all levels. The evaluation system, starting from the school level, also requires strengthening.
K. Soundararajan,
Chennai

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

To fix unemployment, fix the economy first

The Cockroach Janta Party’s movement has highlighted the political urgency for reforming the economy to create more employment for India’s youth. Fixing the education system alone will not solve the unemployment problem. The basic structure of the economy must be reformed.

China and India, the only two countries in the world with populations exceeding one billion, have the greatest need for meaningful employment. If citizens are not fully employed, and incomes of masses do not rise, their economies cannot grow. China has done much better than India in this regard; the per capita income of Chinese citizens has risen roughly eight times faster than Indians’ in the last 30 years.

India’s leaders find themselves in the middle of conflicting trends. First, they are pushing ahead with reforms for ‘ease of doing business’; diluting the rights of workers to organise; and weakening environmental protection. Second, they are promoting the wide-spread application of Artificial Intelligence (AI) to improve ‘productivity’ (and other benefits) in agriculture, industry, health and education, with productivity defined, purely in economic terms, as more output with less human input. Third, they also see the need to change the pattern of growth and increase employment elasticity. Employment elasticity is the amount of meaningful employment created with each unit of GDP growth, in which India has been a laggard since the liberal market economic reforms of the 1990s.

Since India has the largest population of youth in the world, its economic growth should have the highest employment elasticity. However, the increased adoption of AI will only make it worse.

The China model

China has invested billions to become an AI superpower and has raced to integrate the technology



Arun Maira

Author of ‘Reimagining India’s Economy: The Road to a More Equitable Society’

across a range of industries. By 2024, more than two million robots were already working in Chinese factories. And in Beijing, Shanghai and Shenzhen, Meituan, the nation’s largest food delivery service, has experimented with using small autonomous robots to deliver food. But China’s advances in AI have run headlong into a growing problem: anxiety over the workers who could be displaced.

China’s political and economic history reveals that, despite being an authoritarian country, the Chinese government is very attentive to what people are thinking and saying on the Internet. History has taught them that another revolution will form if disenchanted and educated youth rise along with the disgruntled workers and peasants. They know they must respond.

Unemployment has been increasing in China. The unemployment rate for migrant workers rose to 5.7% in March this year, which has been the highest in nearly three years for China, while youth unemployment stood at 16.3% in April. Moreover, 70% of unemployed young people are university graduates, with older laid-off workers facing prolonged periods of joblessness.

However, Chinese courts have been swift to act. A court ruled in May that a tech company had illegally laid-off a worker after replacing him with AI software. Another ruled that, “the development of artificial intelligence technology should be applied to liberating labour, promoting employment and improving people’s livelihood”. And yet another ruled that “companies that benefit from technology must, at the same time, adopt social responsibilities and protect worker rights”.

China’s Ministry of Human Resources and Social Security announced in January that it would roll out policies to address the impact of AI on jobs, including targeted support for key industries. In June, the State Council issued a plan on

implementing an “employment-first” strategy for the 2026-2030 period. Party officials have proposed sweeping government interventions such as requiring employers to offer training to help workers adapt to an AI-centric job market.

The Chinese government’s ‘people-first’ ideology has served China’s economy and its people well. China’s leaders have remained socialists; they have always put the needs of common citizens, and the stability of China’s society, above economists’ demands for deregulation of markets and prices, especially with respect to labour, food, education, health, and housing.

The road ahead for India

Indian income levels must rise rapidly – in agriculture, manufacturing, and services. The government has added ‘ease of living’ to ‘ease of doing business’ as the purpose of the reforms required for India to become ‘Viksit Bharat’ by 2047. To make it a reality, it will have to put more teeth into its policies to increase employment and incomes, and stave off the negative impacts that AI will have on employment. Policies must require that employers take more responsibility for training their own workers; they must be restrained from laying them off.

New policies must put workers’ rights ahead of capitalists’ rights, as China has done. India’s labour market reforms, with the four labour codes, are directed to improve ‘ease of doing business’, which is undoubtedly necessary. However, the ‘ease of doing business’ must now become subordinate to the ease of living and earning for all citizens.

India’s leaders would do well to learn from China’s leaders on how to navigate this moment in history. The rights of all workers must be firmly protected. While the views of financial investors must be heard, the views of workers and small-time entrepreneurs must be heard much more.

Rayalaseema: India’s new industrial hub

The TDP government has transformed the arid region into an economic hub

STATE OF PLAY

V. Raghavendra

Chronic drought and resultant famines have been an integral part of Rayalaseema, with the region having some of the driest places in India.

However, the economic landscape here has undergone a perceptible transformation in the last decade and a half, as some mega manufacturing industries have started moving in with huge investments. Except agriculture and horticulture, which flourished in isolated pockets, Rayalaseema never had any major industrial activity to boast of, but this is rapidly changing and in no small measure.

Numerous cotton ginning and pressing, textile mills, and mineral-based units were the earliest industries to come to the region in the mid-20th century. Multiple large-scale industries, including the State-owned Rayalaseema Thermal Power Plant, the cement plants of Dalmia Bharat and Zuari in the Kadapa-Kurnool belt, and a clutch of renewable energy projects such as the ultra-mega solar parks in the Kadapa and Kurnool districts, were established subsequently.

After a big gap thereafter, the stage has been set for yet another tranche of massive investments, the most prominent being the integrated steel plant being built by the JSW Group in Kadapa district; a string of defence sector projects namely the DRDO’s Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft integration and flight testing centre at Puttaparthi, Bharat Forge’s defence energetics facility in Madakasira, and a high-precision ammunition making unit of HFCL in



Sri Sathya Sai district; and the Royal Enfield manufacturing plant near Tirupati. Then there is the Space City poised to take shape close to the country’s only rocket launchpad at Sriharikota.

These are only a few projects turning parts of the Rayalaseema region into a manufacturing hub.

A gradual boom

Due to its location in the rain shadow area of the Deccan plateau and the consequent inability to fully capture the bountiful rains which the southwest and northeast monsoons normally bring, the Rayalaseema region had for centuries been starved.

However, over the years, the same vast tracts of barren lands, which entrepreneurs would not even look at, became beehives of industrial activity as the Telugu Desam Party (TDP) government of 2014-19 and the present TDP-led ruling coalition offered attractive incentives and created the necessary infrastructure that brought about an industrial revolution of sorts in this resource-rich yet parched region.

The establishment of India’s only KIA Motors’ car manufacturing plant in Anantapur (the site is now in Sri Sathya Sai district) in 2019 was a trigger for the steady flow of big-ticket investments into this region. Royal Enfield’s entry into Tirupati from Tamil Na-

du, which is the only State where Eicher Motors is currently making the iconic motorcycles, complements the existing automotive ecosystem in Anantapur, positioning the region as a growing hub for vehicle manufacturing.

What clearly clinched all these projects is the government’s focus on ‘ease of doing business’, and its subsequent evolution into the ‘speed of doing business’, and the untiring efforts made by the government through the State Investment Promotion Board to promote Rayalaseema as an investment destination.

While going the whole hog in rolling out the red carpet to investors across the industrial manufacturing spectrum, the government now has its sights fixed on consolidating the region’s leadership in the production of horticulture crops. Accordingly, the food processing sector is being aggressively promoted.

Looking back, it was the JSW Group’s Rayalaseema Steel Plant, for which the foundation was laid on July 3, which gave a fillip to the industrialisation of this region; its investment roll-out for Phase-I is ₹4,500 crore (1 MTPA capacity) out of the overall proposed investment of ₹16,350 crore.

From then on, several new major industries started taking tangible shape in Sri City, adding up to the ‘core manufacturing sector’ in Rayalaseema that gained momentum.

The present government has essentially gone all out to woo investors to this region that was jinxed for decades and the positive outcome of its efforts can be seen in the fact that these projects which were once only on paper have started translating into reality.

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Why India’s youth compete fiercely for government jobs

While the student protests achieved accountability, India must work on reshaping investment and growth to build health, education, and employment

DATA POINT

Shipra Nigam

What began with a single leaked entrance exam paper became, in the student protesters’ own telling, a movement about unemployment, shrinking opportunity, and how much a young person’s future hinges on a handful of competitive examinations.

India has dramatically expanded school and higher education; today’s young Indian is far more educated than her parents. Governments across party lines have invested heavily in skilling, apprenticeships, and vocational training.

However, these investments have collided with a labour market incapable of absorbing the aspirations they helped create. Of about 307 million people aged 15 to 29, some 141 million are in the labour force and 127 million are employed. Yet only about 15 million, fewer than one in eight, hold a regular salaried job with a contract and social security – what most would regard as a ‘good job’ with fair pay, social protection, decent working conditions, and career progression. This scarcity creates two forms of distress, often mistaken as separate problems.

At one end are young people who leave school early. Among Indians aged 15-29, whose education is largely complete, about 39% have not finished secondary school and over half hold no qualification beyond Class 10. Most are employed; joblessness among the middle-educated is below 5%. However, they work in informal, low-paid, and often subsistence jobs as casual labourers; are self-employed; or are unpaid workers in family farms and businesses (Chart 3).

A worker who completed only Class 8 earns roughly ₹12,300 a month, and finishing secondary school adds barely another

₹1,000. For many young women, this arithmetic ends in withdrawal: with wages this low, marriage and unpaid care win. Over two in five are neither working nor studying, against fewer than one in 10 men.

At the other end are graduates. While conventional analyses often state that educated youth are rejecting work by holding out for comfortable jobs, the data says otherwise. Graduates face the highest unemployment rate of any group at 22.7%, more than three times that of those who never completed school (Chart 1). They are only 17% of India’s youth population, but 56% of all unemployed young people. While expectations matter, it is far lesser than what the “choosy graduate” narrative suggests. Only about 22% of the labour force earns more than ₹15,000 a month, with nearly 55% earning below ₹9,000. Only about 17 out of 100 graduates secure the salaried employment a degree promises (Chart 2).

India, then, has roughly 15 million meaningful jobs and 300 million young people.

The appeal of government jobs

Hence, the extraordinary importance of government recruitment examinations. They are among the few routes to secure work for first-generation graduates who do not have the money for elite or foreign degrees, and the networks of class, caste, and family that shape private-sector hiring networks which are far less open to marginalised households, regardless of talent. These exams promise to judge candidates by performance alone. In 2024, roughly 30 lakh candidates competed for about 17,700 government posts; about 170 candidates for every vacancy.

Part of the problem is that the transition from school to work is itself broken. Fieldwork by JustJobs Network particularly highlights the wage-expectation mismatch. Young people express clear ambitions but cannot name the course or occupation that would get them

there; and when a job appears, the entry-level pay of ₹10,000-15,000 a month falls well below the ₹20,000-25,000 graduates say they need even locally. Moreover, a job requiring migration is worth taking only at a pay of ₹30,000-₹40,000. Faced with no visible path, many rationally default to a general degree and the examination queue.

These failures are symptoms of a deeper structural problem. India’s economy has become efficient at generating output, but less so at generating meaningful employment. Through much of the 2010s, growth remained strong while employment stagnated; since 2019, much of the increase has reflected workers returning to low-productivity agriculture rather than moving into better-paying jobs. Investment has favoured capital- and technology-intensive sectors, with rising automation creating relatively fewer jobs.

Public investment has risen significantly, but it has flowed more into physical infrastructure than into health and education systems. India spends about 2.7% of its GDP on education, well below the national target of 6%, and about 1.9% on health, short of the 2.5% its National Health Policy set for 2025.

None of this is the fault of the young people who took to the streets. The school-leaver in unpaid family work and the graduate on her fifth attempt face the same shortage from opposite ends. Neither lacks effort. What is scarce is not determination but good quality jobs.

The students achieved what a protest can: accountability for an immediate failure, and national attention for a larger crisis. But no recruitment reform can change the arithmetic of 170 applicants for every vacancy. The deeper challenge is to reshape growth itself.

Until growth generates opportunity as fast as education generates aspiration, India’s young will keep waiting for the economy to catch up with their ambitions.

Chasing opportunity

Data were sourced from the Periodic Labour Force Survey, the Economic Survey and national accounts; and field research by JustJobs Network. Dr. Shipra Nigam is a Research Director at JustJobs Network



CHART 1: Graduates in the age group of 15-29 face the highest unemployment rate at 22.7%, more than three times that of those who never completed school

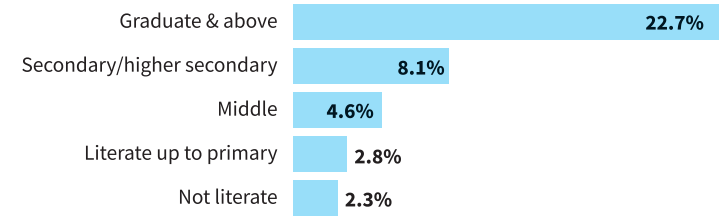


CHART 2: Education barely pays until one gets a degree, as the average monthly earnings of young workers by highest-level of education shows (In ₹)

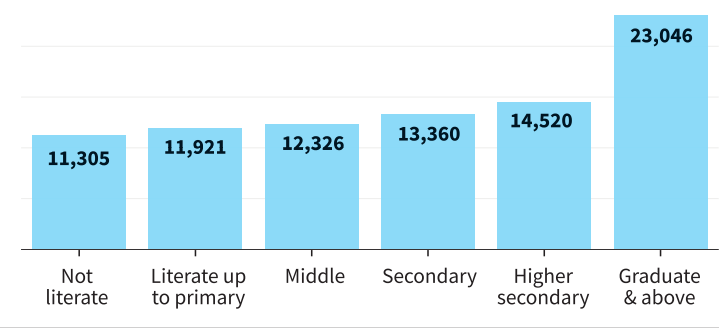


CHART 3: Only one in eight workers hold a ‘good job’. The share of employed youth (aged 15-29) by status of employment

FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindia

FIFTY YEARS AGO JULY 28, 1976

Concordance of Indus script to be published

Madras, July 27: The Tata Institute of Fundamental Research, Bombay, will publish the Concordance of the Indus script by a new process, incorporating additional study material.

More than 9,000 “seals”, with signs and symbols of the Indus script have been found at the sites of Mohenjo Daro and Harappa (now in Pakistan) and in Kalibanga in Rajasthan. These valuable finds throw significant light on the Indus valley civilisation dating back to 4,000 years. Recently, Finnish scholars studied them and prepared a concordance, with the help of a computer.

The Russians have also brought out a publication in their own language.

An Indian scholar, Mr. I. Mahadevan is now trying to publish the same, using the computer technique, but adopting a new method. Under this “computerised photo composition printing” process, being attempted for the first time in India, all the basic symbols in the Indus script will be drawn by an artist and the same will be microfilmed. The text, the positions, the statistical analysis of signs and other relevant information, will be typed and recorded on electronic tapes. The entire matter will then be fed into the press.

Each sign will have a code number. The computer will select the appropriate signs from the micro-film and feed them into the press by the photo composition method. By this, the entire text of the concordance, brought upto date, running to about 700 pages, will be printed in a short time and made available at a comparatively cheap price.

The Finnish scholars adopted the computer plotting method in which the electronic gadget itself drew each and every sign. Under the new technique, one symbol in the micro-film can be used for several impressions.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO JULY 28, 1926

£6,800 for “Pilgrim’s progress”

London, July 27: The first edition of the Pilgrim’s Progress was auctioned at Sotheby’s for £6,800. The purchaser was Mr. Quaritch. Only four other perfect copies are known.

Govt. introduces paper leak Bill in Lok Sabha; debate likely today

Six hours allocated for discussion; 91 amendments moved by members, says Speaker as he brokers truce between govt. and Opposition, which demanded a discussion on police action on protesting students; Ram Temple, E20 issues may be raised

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

The Union government on Monday introduced in the Lok Sabha a Bill providing for harsher penalties and time-bound investigations into examination paper leaks amid a huge uproar by the Opposition members, who demanded a discussion on the police action on protesting students in the country.

The stalemate is likely to end on Tuesday, with Speaker Om Birla brokering a truce between the Treasury and the Opposition benches on Monday afternoon, sources said. The floor leaders of both National Democratic Alliance and Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) had been in touch since the morning.

Six hours have been allocated for the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, and 91 amendments have been moved by Lok Sabha members cutting across party lines, Mr.



Presiding officer Dilip Saikia arriving to conduct the proceedings of the Lok Sabha during the Monsoon Session on Monday. ANI

Birla announced in the House earlier.

The Bill seeks to amend the anti-paper leak law with stricter punishment of up to 10 years in jail and ₹50 lakh fine.

The proposed legislation, which seeks to amend an existing law, was first promised by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in a midnight Instagram post last week in a bid to quell the students' protest at Jantar Mantar.

The Bill was introduced by Union Minister of State for PMO and Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions Jitendra Singh even

as the Opposition protested and sloganeered over the police crackdown on students during the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP)-led July 20 protest march to Parliament as well as in some States like West Bengal and Bihar.

No let-up in protests

The Opposition, which had been protesting since 11 a.m., when the House was convened, was unrelenting and did not let the Bill be taken up for discussion and passage despite repeated appeals from Mr. Birla as well as Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren

Rijiju. He said several members, including those from the Opposition, were prepared to participate in the debate but the Congress and "some of its friends" were causing disruptions and not allowing a debate. At 2 p.m., however, the Speaker said both ruling and Opposition sides should try and arrive at a decision by 5 p.m. till when the House was adjourned.

Senior Congress leaders are understood to have met the Speaker after this and agreed to the discussion being taken up on Tuesday.

"All political parties have agreed to discuss the anti-paper leak Bill on Tuesday. Following Om Birla's initiative and sustained dialogue, floor leaders of political parties have agreed to commence discussion on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill 2026," sources said.

Opposition sources said they were now looking to widen the offensive by targeting the government over the alleged Ram Temple donation embezzlement

case and ethanol-blended fuel.

With the Uttar Pradesh Assembly election due in early 2027, the Samajwadi Party is seeking to use the Ram Temple issue to make inroads among the BJP's core support base of Ram devotees, while the Congress has held over 50 press conferences demanding Prime Minister Narendra Modi's statement on the alleged donation theft.

"We shouldn't allow the BJP to hijack our religion. We are all very proud Hindus and not political Hindus like them," a senior Congress leader told *The Hindu*.

The Opposition plans to highlight concerns over ethanol-blended fuel, which it believes resonate with the middle class, another key BJP constituency.

And with the CJP taking limelight for spearheading the Gen-Z protests and the government appearing intent on sidelining Opposition parties, these parties do not want to give much elbow room to the government.

Opposition set to maintain pressure on Shah, take part in debate on paper leak Bill

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

On the first day of Parliament after the students' protests were called off, the Opposition signalled that it would continue to target Home Minister Amit Shah over the use of pellet guns and excessive force by security personnel against protesting students.

At the meeting of the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance on Monday, there were differences on whether to disrupt or participate in the debate on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, though it was later resolved that the parties should present their point of view.

Samajwadi Party sources said the Opposition should demand a debate on the Ram Temple donation theft case. According to sources, Dharmendra Yadav, the SP's chief whip, said during the meeting that this issue should not be allowed to be buried. However, a significant section of Opposition leaders was of the opinion that they should continue to fo-



Action plan: Congress leader Rahul Gandhi speaking at an INDIA bloc meeting in New Delhi. FILE PHOTO

cus on policy issues such as education. Wading into the Ram Temple issue would communalise the narrative. "The students have done their job. We must not fail them," a top Opposition leader said.

The Opposition leaders shared the details of the instances of "police brutalities" in their respective States. It was decided that during the debate on the Bill, these instances must be highlighted. The Opposition has also resolved that its strategy should include coordination on agitations beyond Parliament.

Among those who pushed for participation in the debate on the Bill, known in common parlance as the "paper leak Bill", was Revolutionary

Socialist Party MP N.K. Premachandran. Speaking to *The Hindu*, he said, "This Bill is an eyewash. Beyond increasing the fine and the jail term, it introduces no substantive changes. In fact, the Centre has inserted provisions that effectively reduce States to spectators, including a clause enabling the creation of a task force to investigate paper leaks that reports exclusively to the Union government."

The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam, which has been skipping INDIA bloc meetings, has also expressed a similar opinion. "I would like to know what action has been taken so far under the existing Act," DMK Rajya Sabha floor leader Tiruchi Siva said.

How BJP, RSS are framing the protest and its aftermath

NEWS ANALYSIS

Nistula Hebbar
NEW DELHI

There is both a doubling down and a softening in the approach being taken by the government and the larger Sangh Parivar in its messaging after young protesters concluded their protest against the NEET exam paper leak.

Going by the statements made publicly, a few things spring immediately to the mind on how the BJP and the Sangh Parivar are framing the protest and its aftermath.

Former Union Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's letter announcing his resignation on X, addressed to "young friends" rather than the President, states that he takes responsibility for what happened under his watch, that he initiated action when informed of the leak, handed the case to the Central Bureau of Investigation, and conducted a re-test successfully. The reason he specifically provided for his resignation was: "However, even during this time, individuals in responsible positions attempted to create obstacles and mislead students, which caused me deep distress."

"Considering the situation at Jantar Mantar and across the country – with the aim of preventing anti-national forces from exploiting it, preserving national unity, ensuring that not a single Indian student's future gets entangled in legal complexities, and allowing our children to devote their time to studies and focus on building their careers – I have submitted my resignation to the Honourable Prime Minister," he said.

This frames the protest as something that could have hurt the security of India, and the government, by asking for the Minister's resignation, had sought to end the protest

Modi's reels, RSS chief's speech on role of mothers offer clues on the party's approach on matter

in the larger interests. Moreover, the Centre maintains it has administratively carried off all the required measures for the NEET paper leak. The letter and the government's statements thus try to make it seem the NEET exam paper leak was more an act of omission than commission, a matter on which the intent of the government should not be interrogated.

The support offered to Mr. Pradhan, both online and offline, by his party and government colleagues, demonstrate that he is likely to make a political comeback soon, possibly in the BJP's party organisation.

For the long run, one may look to the reels posted by Mr. Modi on Instagram, and the speech on the role of mothers, at the height of the protests in Delhi, by Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh chief Mohan Bhagwat.

'A social issue'

He appeared to suggest that he viewed the protests as a social issue pertaining to young Indians and education. "There is a need to give the new generation a sense of belonging. We need to communicate. Not dictation, but discussion. Not orders but consensus," he said.

Mr. Modi's posts on Instagram can also be seen as a way of reaching young people, via the platform they seem to prefer. Whether these two simultaneously offered approaches, one aimed internally at the political class and the other a societal position, will hit the mark in the conundrum now facing the government and the Sangh Parivar remains to be seen.

'Gen Z' protests test the Sangh, raise uncomfortable questions

Nistula Hebbar
Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

Protests by students over the alleged NEET paper leak appear to have hit closer to home for the BJP and the larger Sangh Parivar than previous agitations against the NDA government at the Centre.

After reports emerged that the daughter of Assam Minister Keshab Mahanta, Dibisa Mahanta, had joined the protests by students, other instances of disquiet among BJP members and those associated with the Sangh Parivar have also come to the fore.

News about Manika Rana, former president of the BJP's youth wing in Uttarakhand's Tehri Garhwal, also went viral on social media. Reports claimed that she had been expelled from the party after participating in the Cockroach Janta Party-led student protest at Jantar Mantar.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, Ms. Rana confirmed that she had been to the protest and that she supported the students' demands. She, however, denied reports



CJP supporters celebrating after Union Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation at Jantar Mantar. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

that she had been expelled because of her participation.

"I was removed from the post of youth wing president in April as I was busy due to certain personal engagements. Yes, I support all demands made by students, including the resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan but I am still with the party," she added.

Other concerns

Former Union Minister Murlu Manohar Joshi had expressed concerns over the police action against protesters on July 20, and after Mr. Pradhan's resignation, he posted, "Better late than never".

RSS member Ratan

Sharda, who is also a contributor to the RSS mouthpiece *Organiser*, has publicly argued that the BJP's communication machinery and IT Cell failed to effectively counter the narrative around the "Cockroach Protests", calling it a "spectacular failure".

In a post on X, which he clarified as "his own view" and had "nothing to do with the RSS", Mr. Sharda said the BJP's media team relied on memes and "whataboutery" instead of building a counter-narrative, and failed to gauge growing youth anger over issues such as NEET, lacking a feedback mechanism from the ground.

BJP MPs face Opposition flak for 'Pradhan Zindabad' slogan

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

BJP leader Dharmendra Pradhan, who stepped down as Education Minister over the NEET controversy, was greeted by BJP MPs with slogans of "Pradhan Zindabad" in the Parliament complex on Monday.

This prompted some of the Opposition MPs, who too were protesting outside the main entrance to Parliament against the police crackdown on protesters, to counter their BJP counterparts with chants of "Chor Chor, Paper Chor [thief, thief, paper

thief]". The Congress termed the felicitation "grave insult" to the country's youth.

Calling Mr. Pradhan a symbol of "corruption and India's ruined education system", Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi said the system "claimed the lives of 26 children and forced millions of youth onto the streets".

"And today, the BJP is garlanding that same person in Parliament. This isn't any honour—it's a celebration of the destruction of millions of children's futures," Mr. Gandhi said in a post

on X. Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh said the BJP was honouring Mr. Pradhan "as if he had achieved some great feat", despite the paper leak crisis, the collapse of the examination system and the police action against protesting students. He questioned whether the BJP believed Mr. Pradhan's tenure was "commendable".

Congress leader Pawan Khera alleged Mr. Pradhan was being celebrated because he had implemented the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh's agenda through the Education Ministry.

RS adjourned again; Opposition MPs seek apology from Shah

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Rajya Sabha adjourned for the day on Monday for the sixth day in the Monsoon Session without taking up any business.

The Prevention of In-sults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026 was listed for consideration and passing. But it could not be taken up as the Opposition demanded an apology from Union Minister Amit Shah for the police action against protesting students.

In the afternoon, when the House met at 2 p.m., Deputy Speaker Harivansh invited Minister of State for Home Nitayanand Rai to move the Bill. Opposition members Pramod Tiwari, John Brittas and Tiruchi Siva raised objections. While Mr. Tiwari and Mr. Brittas demanded a discussion on police atrocities, Mr. Siva said the Bill was against the Constitution.

The Deputy Chairman, however, denied the "point of order" raised by the members and Mr. Rai

moved the Bill for consideration of the House amid din. Opposition MPs were heard shouting slogans demanding that Mr. Shah must come to the House.

At 5.15 p.m., the Deputy Chairman invited Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju. He said the government was ready for discussions on the issue of paper leaks and requested the Congress to take up the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, for discussion. "Such an important Bill has been brought forward. We appealed to the Congress yesterday, we have been appealing to them since this morning, but they are not agreeing," he said.

Countering this, Congress leader Mallikarjun Kharge said the Opposition did not shy away from discussion. "But before discussion, the Home Minister should come and make a statement," he said. When he was speaking, BJP MPs raised their voice and soon after the House was adjourned for the day.

BJP to mark Guru Ravidas' 650th birth anniversary

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The BJP on Monday said it would launch a nationwide "Samrasta Sankalp Abhiyan" (campaign for social harmony and resolve) from July 29, 2026, to February 20, 2027, to mark the 650th birth anniversary of the mystic poet-saint Guru Ravidas.

At a press conference held by BJP national general secretaries Tarun Chugh and Dushyant Kumar Gautam, it said 131 sacred urns would be sent across the country from Varanasi, the birthplace of Ravidas.

Initiatives for social harmony would be organised at 21,000 locations and processions, including a month-long yatra from Jalandhar to Varanasi, would be taken out, they said.

The government had undertaken several initiatives to preserve the saint's legacy, including the development of airports, special trains, his birthplace, pilgrim routes, and the restoration of sites linked to Ravidas, they said.

	NATIONAL BOARD OF EXAMINATIONS IN MEDICAL SCIENCES (Autonomous body of the M/o. Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of India) NAMS Building, Medical Enclave, Ansari Nagar, New Delhi-110029
NBEMS DIPLOMA FINAL THEORY EXAMINATION – OCTOBER 2026	
NOTICE	
National Board of Examinations in Medical Sciences (NBEMS) shall conduct the NBEMS Diploma Final Theory Examinations on 11th, 12th and 13th September 2026 .	
The online applications are being invited from 28-07-2026 (05:00 PM onwards) to 17-08-2026 (Till 11:55 PM) at NBEMS website:- https://natboard.edu.in/viewnbeexam?exam=diploma	
There is no other method for submitting the application other than the above online method. Applications submitted through any other medium will be summarily rejected.	
Candidate Care Support: +91-7996165333	• Helpline Portal on applicant login page • Communication Web Portal on NBEMS Website

A CH-CHE

Business

INBRIEF



Merck inks pact with 4 Indian drugmakers for HIV drug

Pharma major Merck has signed non-exclusive voluntary licensing agreements with Aurobindo Pharma, Cipla, Emcure and Viatris in India to enable supply of its investigational, once-monthly oral HIV pill Alimatravir. The royalty-free agreements with the companies will enable supply of generic alimatravir in 129 low- and middle-income countries (LMICs) that account for a substantial majority of new HIV diagnoses globally, Merck said recently.

Thai FDA approves new treatment for gonorrhoea

Thailand’s Food and Drug Administration has approved Nuzolvence (zolitlodacin), a first-in-class oral antibiotic for the treatment of uncomplicated urogenital gonorrhoea for which Dr. Reddy’s Laboratories with support from The GARDP Foundation had led the priority review submission. Thailand is the second country to approve the new chemical entity. Six months ago the U.S. Food and Drug Administration had approved the drug.

Bondada acquires 60% in Maharashtra solar project SPV

Bondada Engineering has acquired 60% stake in Onix IPP, a special purpose vehicle implementing a 225 MW (AC) solar photovoltaic power project in Maharashtra under a government scheme. The acquisition aligns with Bondada Group’s plans to diversify beyond EPC execution into renewable energy asset ownership and creation, thus generating predictable annuity-based revenues and complementing its annuity income from Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) assets.

Dual immunotherapy from Bristol Myers to treat cancer

Bristol Myers Squibb (BMS) unveiled RELOPDUO, a fixed-dose combination of nivolumab and relatlimab) in India following approval from the Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO). According to the company the therapy is India’s first LAG-3-based dual immunotherapy and is indicated for adults and children aged 12 years and above with unresectable or metastatic melanoma.

Allana Consumer to boost frozen food business in India

Allana Consumer Products Ltd., a part of the 161-year-old Allana Group, one of India’s largest processed food products and agri-commodity exporters, said it will boost domestic frozen food business to cater to rising demand from households and hotels, restaurants and cafes by unveiling new products, a company official said. “Our objective is to make high-quality frozen food more accessible while building a reliable farm-to-freezer value chain,” said Parag Vishnu Gadre, business head, fruits, vegetables and ice cream division, Allana Consumer Products Ltd.

CIL’s Q1 net almost flat on costs, to pay ₹5.5 dividend

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

State-owned miner Coal India’s Ltd. (CIL) net profit in the June-end quarter stayed almost flat year-on-year (YoY) as cost of explosives and industrial diesel, among other essentials required for mining, cumulatively rose in double digits amid the West Asia conflict even as it sought to absorb the impact of the elevated pricing. Net profit stood at ₹8,850 crore, increasing by a marginal 0.7% YoY. Expenses climbed 27% YoY to ₹3,260 crore. The miner declared an interim dividend of ₹5.50 per equity share.

HDFC fines CEO and CFO ₹1 lakh each for ‘business overreach’

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

HDFC Bank imposed a fine of ₹1 lakh each on MD-CEO, CFO and group head, retail assets for ‘business overreach’ after an internal review into deposit arrangements with MSRDC. “The bank announces the conclusion of an internal review process pertaining to the arrangement with Maharashtra State Road Development Corporation (MSRDC) for garnering deposits in 2017 and 2021. Based on the findings and recommendation of the Special Disciplinary Committee of Independent Directors, the board concluded the conduct of the

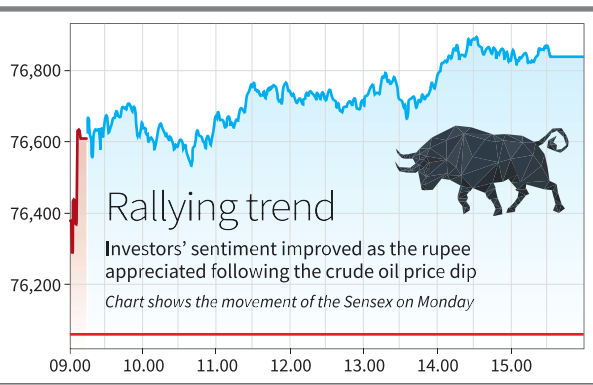
BSE adds ₹5.1 lakh crore as rupee appreciates, crude dips

Broad-based buying and improving global sentiment lead the rally; market capitalisation of BSE-listed firms surges ₹5.1 lakh crore to ₹480.8 lakh crore, following the rebound in equities

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI

A sharp fall in crude oil prices amid easing tensions in West Asia and appreciation of rupee, propped up India’s equity markets with Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE) gaining more than 1%, adding ₹5.10 lakh crore in capitalisation. The 30-share BSE Sensex closed 1.02% higher at 76,835.78 points and the 50-share National Stock Exchange (NSE) Nifty surged 228.50 points, or 0.96% to 23,995.95 points.

Broad-based rally More than 2,250 stocks increased of the 3,446 that traded on Monday and all the sectoral indices improved, suggesting a broad-based rally. The market capitalisation of BSE-listed companies surged ₹5.1 lakh crore to ₹480.8 lakh crore, following the rebound in equities. “The market has bounced back sharply from near the cluster support of around 23,600 (previous opening upside gap of June 15 and ascending trend line) and is now on the verge of breaking above the immediate resistance of 24,000-24,100 levels,” said Nagaraj Shetti, Senior Technical Research Analyst at HDFC Securities. The optimism can be attributed to the 61 paise appreciation in the value of the Indian rupee, pushing it to ₹95.96 a dollar as crude oil dipped to \$86.5 a barrel, 6% below the previous session. At the interbank foreign exchange, the rupee opened at 96.18 and touched the low of 96.27 and high of 95.78 against the greenback during the session, finally settling at 95.92 (provisional) against the dollar, up 61 paise against its previous closing



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level. According to forex traders, the local currency also support from a firm trend in domestic equities and weakness in the US dollar against major currencies. Further, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) governor said that Indian banks had drawn FCNR(B) deposits worth \$32 billion so far, which is at least half of \$50 billion to \$70 billion that the monetary authority plans to garner from NRIs, in a bid to reign in the rupee depreciation. “Despite continued vulnerability to oil related volatility arising from geopolitical tensions, technical indicators have shifted materially. Spot USDINR has slipped below its ascending channel support, signalling potential continuation toward 95.60 and 95.40 in the sessions ahead,” said Dilip Parmar, Senior Research Analyst at HDFC Securities. (With inputs from PTI)

‘Data centre capacity to jump to 12 GW as AI fuels demand’

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

India’s operational data centre capacity is projected to jump more than five-fold to 12 GW by 2030 from 2.2 GW in 2025, driven by rapid adoption of artificial intelligence (AI), hyperscale cloud investments and the expanding digital

economy, according to a Wood Mackenzie. AI-dedicated capacity is expected to rise multifold to 6,546 MW by 2030 from 275 MW in 2025, while data centre electricity demand is forecast to grow to 191 terawatt-hours (TWh) by 2040 from 10 TWh in 2025, its report said. “India’s data centre mar-

ket becomes a structural investment thesis,” said Souhardya Pal, Research Associate at Wood Mackenzie. “The convergence of hyperscale capital, AI workload growth and a decade of policy support have created the conditions for India to rival any market in Asia-Pacific. The question for developers and inves-

tors is no longer whether to enter India, but where and how.” **Digital economy** India’s digital economy, valued at ₹32 lakh crore in 2025 and accounting for about 12% of GDP, together with more than 1.03 billion active internet users and around 22 billion monthly

UPI transactions, is driving demand for data centre infrastructure. India’s domestic AI market is projected to reach ₹11.7 lakh crore by 2032. Wood Mackenzie said Maharashtra and Tamil Nadu currently account for about 65% of installed IT load, but future investment is expected to expand into

A.P., Telangana, U.P. and Karnataka. These emerging markets are attracting significant commitments from global hyperscalers, including Amazon Web Services and Google, alongside domestic operators such as AdaniConnex, which has announced a development pipeline of 2.6 GW.

TMB Q1 net crosses ₹400 cr; now eyes overseas expansion

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamilnad Mercantile Bank Ltd (TMB) has reported a 34.97% year on year (YoY) increase in net profit to ₹411.51 crore for the quarter ended June compared with ₹304.89 crore in the corresponding quarter last year. “This is the highest-ever net profit in the bank’s history. For the first time, we have crossed the ₹400 crore mark,” said Salee S. Nair, managing director and CEO of the bank. The private sector lender’s net interest income increased to ₹765.08 crore from ₹579.55 crore, a growth of 32.01% YoY. Net interest margin im-



Net interest income rose 32% YoY to ₹765.08 crore from ₹579.55 crore a year earlier.

proved to 4.29% from 3.84%, up 45 basis points.

Deposits rise 20% The Thoothukudi-based headquartered bank’s total deposits rose 19.71% YoY, to ₹64,409 crore, while advances grew 27.01% YoY to ₹57,306 crore.

“As we move through FY27, our priorities remain centered on deepening customer relationships, strengthening our retail, micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) and agriculture franchises, expanding our deposit base and accelerating investments in technology and digital capabilities to enhance customer experience and operational efficiency,” Mr. Nair said. “The bank still does not have an international presence, and that’s something we are seriously looking at. We are evaluating three specific territories like Malaysia. Singapore and West Asia particularly Dubai...but that’s in the future.”

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

Digital insurance platform Policybazaar said it started offering U.S. dollar-denominated term insurance plans of partner insurers for non-resident Indians (NRIs) through the International Financial Services Centre, GIFT City, Gujarat. This allows NRIs to pay premia and receive claim payouts in U.S. dollars, addressing one of the biggest but least discussed financial risks faced by Indians living overseas – currency depreciation, it said. The launch reflects the growing role of GIFT City in bringing global financial products closer to the Indian diaspora. Over the last



New vistas: A general view of the Gujarat International Finance Tec-City (GIFT City) in Gandhinagar, Gujarat.

few years, the IFSC enabled several banking, investment and insurance solutions traditionally available only via overseas financial centres. Global Indians can now access internationally-aligned financial products within India’s regulatory framework, Policybazaar added.

Chief business officer- Life Insurance, Policybazaar Vivek Jain said “GIFT City has created the foundation for a new generation of financial products for global Indians. Our role at Policybazaar is to ensure the opportunities reach customers in a simple and accessible manner.”

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA – DEPARTMENT OF SPACE CONSTRUCTION & MAINTENANCE GROUP, SDSC – SHAR SRIHARIKOTA – 524124

Brief E-TENDER NOTICE

e-Tender Notice No.CMG/C/CON/268715 Date: 24/07/2026

On behalf of President of India, Item Rate tenders are invited through e-tendering for the following works:

Brief Name of work	Est. Value (Rs)
Miscellaneous works around the facilities and providing MS gates at Tiruchendur & Sattankulam Taluk, Thoothukudi District, Tamil Nadu.	74 Lakhs

Last date for sale (Tender documents can be downloaded) up to 03/08/2026 14:30 hrs. For eligibility criteria and other details, interested tenderers may please refer to the detailed bilingual (Hindi-English) Notice Inviting Tenders (NIT) on the website <https://www.isro.gov.in/Tenders.html> and tender free view at <https://www.tenderwizard.com/isro>.

Sd/- GROUP HEAD, CMG/ SDSC SHAR

CYBERABAD MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

O/o. The Superintending Engineer, STSQM (HQ), CMC, 2nd Floor, Cyberabad Municipal Corporation, NAC Building, Izzath Nagar-500 084.

e' Procurement Notice

NIT.No.16/SE(STSQM)/HQ/CMC/2026-27 Date: 27.06.2026.

S.No.	Name of the work
1	Expression of interest for Selection of agency for feasibility study for mechanized sweeping of roads excluding CRMP roads and adoption of mechanized road sweepers of suitable configuration for Cyberabad Municipal Corporation (CMC).

Events	For works
Bid Download Start Date	28.07.2026 @ 11.30 AM
Bid Download End Date	12.08.2026 @ 11.30 AM
Last Date & Time for uploading of Bids	12.08.2026 @ 11.30 AM
Price Bid Opening Date	12.08.2026 @ 12.00 PM

Sd/- Superintending Engineer
DIPR R.O.No.6846-PP/CL/ADVT/2026-27 Dt.27.07.2026 STSQM, HQ, CMC, (Ph.No.9121240341)

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OFFICE OF THE CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (P&C) IDCO, IDCO TOWER, BHUBANESWAR

Tender Call Notice No. File No.: IDCO/HO-P&C/A-100927/04/2026/V-1 21392, Dated : 20/07/2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER THROUGH e-PROCUREMENT

Name of the Work : Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning of 11kV dedicated feeder for providing power supply to Industries at Indranipatna Industrial Estate, Choudwar, Cuttack ..

Estimated Cost put to tender : Rs.2,20,28,726.00

Period of completion : 5 (Five) Calendar Months

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender On-Line for Bidding	
		From	To
1	2	3	4
Chief General Manager (P&C) IDCO, IDCO Tower, Bhubaneswar	Bid Identification No.:- P&C/EST/E-14/2026-27	17:00 hours of dt. 29.07.2026	17:00 hours of dt. 13.08.2026

Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement Portal www.Tendersodisha.gov.in and Corrigendum if any will be published in newspapers and can only be seen in the e-procurement portal as well as in IDCO website.

Sd/- Chief General Manager (P&C), IDCO, Bhubaneswar

4001/221/2627 OIPR-4001/4075/11/26-27/0076

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E-TENDER FOR THE FOLLOWING WORKS ARE INVITED:-

NIT No.: CE(P)/WBSETCL/ 315 MVA Trf./26-27/15 Procurement of 400/220/33 kV, 315 MVA Auto Transformers. Bid documents can be downloaded from 28.07.2026, 03:00 P.M. Bid submission starting date (online): 12.08.2026, 03:00 P.M. and bid submission closing date (online): 27.08.2026, 03:00 P.M.

NIT No.: CE(P)/WBSETCL/ 200 MVA Trf./26-27/16 Procurement of 220/132/33 kV, 200 MVA, 3 Phase Auto Transformer. Bid documents can be downloaded from 28.07.2026, 03:00 P.M. Bid submission starting date (online): 12.08.2026, 03:00 P.M. and bid submission closing date (online): 27.08.2026, 03:00 P.M.

NIT No.: CE(P)/WBSETCL/ 80 MVA-132-33kV-Trf./ 26-27/17 Procurement of 132/33 kV, 80 MVA Power Transformers. Bid documents can be downloaded from 30.07.2026, 03:00 P.M. Bid submission starting date (online): 14.08.2026, 03:00 P.M. and bid submission closing date (online): 31.08.2026, 03:00 P.M.

Visit the following websites - www.wbtenders.gov.in, www.wbsetcl.in for details.

ICA-T13474(3)/2026

A CH-CHE

CARACAS

Will not take part in U.S.-backed talks: Venezuela’s Maria Machado



REUTERS

Venezuelan Nobel Peace Prize laureate and government critic Maria Corina Machado said on Sunday she will not be part of U.S.-backed talks with interim President Delcy Rodriguez planned in August. In a statement, Ms. Machado said the Opposition will “not participate” in the “design, development and operation” of the talks. AFP

LONDON

U.K.’s new PM Burnham welcomes Zelenskyy as first foreign visitor

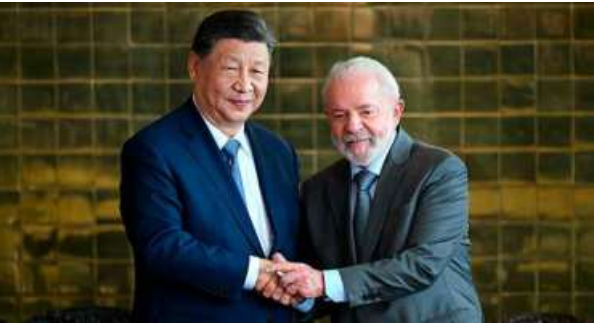


AFF

Britain’s new Prime Minister Andy Burnham welcomed Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy as his first international visitor on Monday, in a move reflecting London’s resolute support for Ukraine. “Britain stands with Ukraine, shoulder to shoulder, and our support remains unwavering,” Mr. Burnham said in a statement. REUTERS

BEIJING

China supports Brazil in opposing ‘external interference’: Xi tells Lula



AFF

Chinese President Xi Jinping told Brazilian President Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva on Monday that he supports the country in “opposing external interference”, Beijing’s state media said, reporting a call between the leaders. According to the Brazilian presidency, Mr. Lula “agreed on speeding up talks on the Mercosur-China trade deal”. AFP

RIYADH

Houthis, pro-Iran groups based in Iraq launch drones at Saudi Arabia



AFF

Saudi Arabia said it intercepted drones launched by pro-Iran groups in Iraq on Monday, while Iran-aligned Houthi rebels in Yemen also claimed attacks on Saudi oil infrastructure. The Houthis said they launched drone attacks in response to incursions by the kingdom’s drones. Pro-Iran groups in Iraq have not claimed any attacks. AFP

Red Sea shipping slows after Houthi hits on Saudi Arabia

Reuters
SINGAPORE

Ship traffic through Bab el-Mandeb fell on Sunday after Yemeni Houthis attacked Saudi oil installations along the Red Sea coast, while transit through the Strait of Hormuz stayed low over the weekend, shipping data from Kpler showed on Monday.

Eleven commodity vessels passed through the Bab el-Mandeb strait on Sunday, the lowest level in months, the data showed.

Red Sea traffic has been disrupted off the coast of Yemen since last week by the Iran-aligned Houthis, who want to blockade Saudi exports, expanding the U.S.-Iran conflict that has already choked oil supply through the Strait of Hormuz.



Navy sailors from the Yemen’s Aden-based government seen aboard a vessel patrolling in the Red Sea on Monday. AFP

Seven of the vessels that passed through strait were oil tankers with three of them entering the Red Sea. Two of them are very large crude carriers (VLCCs) heading to the port of Yanbu to load Saudi crude while the third is a Russian-linked ship, the data showed.

Four vessels exited the

Red Sea on Sunday. Another ship is exiting the waterway through the Bab el-Mandeb strait.

Lull in Hormuz

Fewer than 10 commodity vessels passed through the Strait of Hormuz daily over the weekend even though the U.S. and Iran have paused strikes in West Asia, shipping data from Kpler showed.

Seven vessels transited on Sunday including three Iranian-linked oil products tankers that exited the strait, the data showed.

On Saturday, there were only three vessels that passed through with their transponders switched off.

On Friday, seven vessels passed, mostly exiting the Gulf, including two VLCCs carrying crude from Iraq and the UAE and a tanker carrying fuel oil.

Iran says it still controls Hormuz, not involved in negotiations with the U.S.

Six ships turned back after trying to pass the strait without permission, Iran state media reports; amid halt in campaign by both sides, Trump says ‘good chance’ of progress in talks to produce a deal, dismisses concerns on ammunition shortage

Reuters
DUBAI

Iran said on Monday it was still in control of the Strait of Hormuz and not seeking to resume peace talks with the U.S., after President Donald Trump halted a two-week bombing campaign that his top brass told him had run its course.

Following 13 successive nights of bombing that provoked Tehran to fire on U.S. bases, Mr. Trump halted the campaign over the weekend. Iran said it would pause its own attacks for as long as the U.S. pause in bombing endures.

On Monday, Mr. Trump said that diplomacy with



Tehran backdrop: A woman walks near a billboard depicting U.S. President Donald Trump in the Iranian capital on Monday. REUTERS

Iran could produce a deal to end the war, but warned that Washington would resume military strikes if negotiations failed.

“I have a lot of patience... We’ll see what happens. I think there is a

good chance that something could happen,” Mr. Trump told reporters. “If it doesn’t, we go back to doing what we were doing two days ago.”

Mr. Trump’s had suspended the campaign fol-

lowing advice from his top brass that the bombing, aimed at breaking Iran’s grip on strait, had reached the limits of what it could achieve, according to a U.S. official and U.S. media reports.

The official said the chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff, General Dan Caine, had also expressed concern over the depletion of air defence weapons.

But Mr. Trump dismissed concerns that five months of war had depleted U.S. munitions.

“We have a lot of ammunition,” he said. “We have a lot of the mid-level stuff too, more than we could ever use, no matter what.”

Earlier in the day, Es-

mail Baghaei, Iran’s Foreign Ministry spokesperson, said in a televised press conference that Iran had not asked to resume peace talks with the U.S.

In a clear bid to signal that the U.S. bombing had failed in its objective, Tehran indicated it was still in control of the crucial waterway. Several Iranian state media outlets carried the same report that Iran had turned around six “offending ships” on Monday that had attempted to cross the strait without its permission. “The traffic route in Hormuz is the route specified by Iran, and other routes are contaminated and have no way out,” the state media reports said.

President-elect says Colombia will cut ties with Cuba, Nicaragua

Agence France-Presse
BOGOTA

Colombia’s hard-right President-elect Abelardo de la Espriella vowed on Sunday to break off diplomatic relations with Cuba and Nicaragua when he takes office on August 7.

Mr. De la Espriella said he will also close 15 consulates and 14 embassies in countries including Algeria, Barbados, Ethiopia, Haiti, Hungary, Senegal and South Africa.

“In my government, there will be no ties with tyrannies,” Mr. De la Espriella said in a social media post, referring to the leftist governments of Cuba and Nicaragua. However,

he said the decisions “do not mean breaking off diplomatic relations” with the other countries.

“With the rest of the countries and organizations, Colombia will maintain its international relations and will guarantee attention for its nationals through other embassies,” he said.

The President-elect, whose election campaign centred on “iron fist” security policies, said closing embassies would allow the government to redirect money to security.

Mr. De la Espriella announced plans to open an embassy in Jerusalem in July as he seeks to restore ties with Israel.

Syria to seek joint security agreement with Israel: al-Sharaa

Reuters
DAMASCUS

Syria is seeking to reach a security agreement with Israel, Syrian President Ahmed al-Sharaa said in an interview with Al Jazeera on Sunday.

He said a deal could pave the way for peace between the two countries without compromising Syria’s right to the Golan Heights, an area that Israel captured from Syria in the 1967 Six-Day War and annexed in 1981.

Mr. Sharaa said Syria was trying to involve more countries to pressure Israel to adopt a more balanced policy towards Syria. “We are avoiding getting into

confrontations,” he added. Soon after former President Bashar al-Assad fell to rebel forces under Mr. Sharaa’s leadership in 2024, Israeli troops pushed into Syria and seized strategic territories. Israeli troops moved into a demilitarised zone inside Syria, including the Syrian side of Mount Hermon. Since then, Israel has launched strikes on Syria and detained individuals from within the country.

In a statement on X on Sunday, U.N. Secretary-General Antonio Guterres – who is visiting Syria – called for respect for Syria’s sovereignty, independence, unity and territorial integrity.

Sudan’s Army claims control of major highway linking Khartoum to El-Obeid

Agence France-Presse
KHARTOUM

Sudan’s Army has regained control of a key highway linking the capital Khartoum with the flashpoint city of El-Obeid, military sources said on Monday.

Their rival paramilitary Rapid Support Forces (RSF) have for months amassed troops around El-Obeid, attempting to encircle it ahead of an apparent large-scale assault.

They have now been pushed west, off the 400-kilometre highway that connects Khartoum with the largest city in the embattled Kordofan region.

Hours after the development, paramilitary drone strikes shook El-Obeid. At



Amid ruins: Damaged interiors of a building after it was reportedly targeted by the Rapid Support Forces in El-Obeid on Monday. AFP

dawn, RSF drone strikes tore through two municipal buildings in apparent retaliation.

Crucial link

El-Obeid lies at a key crossroads: its north-south high-

way runs from Khartoum to the rest of Kordofan, while its east-west axis connects RSF strongholds in the Darfur region to Army-controlled central and eastern Sudan.

The highway to Khar-

toum remains closed to civilians, who have for most of the war relied entirely on the eastern road to the White Nile, where the RSF regularly launches deadly drone strikes. The Army advance “opens a second supply route to El-Obeid and beyond”, according to the military source.

The war between the Army and the RSF – former allies before they fell out in a power struggle – erupted in April 2023 and has since killed over 200,000 people, aid workers estimate.

It has also created the world’s largest displacement and hunger crises, with over 33 million people in need of humanitarian aid.

THE HINDU

Young world

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CM

A CH-CE

ON COURSE

Sachin, Ankush and Sakshi one win away from clinching a medal



PTI

Indian boxers Sachin Siwach, Ankush, *in pic.*, and Sakshi Chaudhary advanced to the quarterfinals of the Commonwealth Games. Sachin beat England's William Hewitt 4-1 in men's 60kg. Ankush outplayed Jan Zalaan of Antigua and Barbuda 5-0 in men's 80kg. Sakshi blanked Lethabo Modukanele of Botswana 5-0 in women's 51kg.

REWARD

Sports Minister Mandaviya fetes CWG bronze medallist Jhandu



PTI

Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya on Monday felicitated para-powerlifter Jhandu Kumar with a cash prize of ₹10 lakh for his bronze medal-winning performance that opened India's account at the Glasgow Commonwealth Games. The felicitation took place at the Minister's residence in New Delhi.

HIGH PRAISE

Sooryavanshi has the attitude and mindset to improve, says Laxman



AFF

Very mature. And that's what I really appreciate about Vaibhav Sooryavanshi. He was disappointed not to get a hundred, but we told him it's not going to be the first or the last opportunity he'll get. He's got a long career ahead, and he has the attitude and mindset to improve every day — Stand-in India coach V.V.S. Laxman.

CAREER-BEST FIGURES

Greaves' maiden five-wicket haul helps Windies gain slender lead



AFF

Justin Greaves claimed his maiden five-wicket haul as West Indies gained a first-innings lead of 29 runs against Pakistan on the third day of the first Test at Tarouba on Monday. **The scores:** West Indies 311 & 30/3 in 14 overs vs Pakistan 282 in 80.1 overs (Imam-ul-Haq 63, Shan Masood 109, Justin Greaves 5/27), **at tea.**

Gyaneshwari finishes with silver after a gripping duel

The Indian comes second best to Nigerian Didih in 53kg event despite successfully completing all her attempts; the latter secures the gold after setting both Commonwealth and Games records

CWEALTH GAMES

K. Keerthivasan
GLASGOW

There hadn't been a more gripping weightlifting contest at the Glasgow Commonwealth Games here than the women's 53kg event on Monday.

In a battle that went right down to the final lift, Nigeria's Onome Omolola Didih edged out India's Gyaneshwari Yadav to claim the gold medal.

Gyaneshwari lifted a total of 199kg, while Didih produced a total of 206kg — both a Commonwealth and Games record. The Nigerian also rewrote the record books in the individual lifts, establishing both Commonwealth and Games records in the snatch (93kg) and clean and jerk (113kg).

Gyaneshwari had produced a flawless performance by successfully completing all her attempts with remarkable composure and precision.

The duel reached its climax in the clean and jerk. Gyaneshwari opened with a successful 103kg lift, while Didih responded with 105. In the second round, the former confi-



Making a big impression: Gyaneshwari bagged a silver in her maiden Games. PTI

dently cleared 107, only for the latter stay ahead with 110.

With the pressure mounting, Gyaneshwari raised the bar to 111 for her final attempt and nailed it, drawing loud cheers from the crowd.

Didih, however, replied with an outstanding lift of 113 to seal the gold medal in dramatic fashion.

The moment she completed the winning lift, the 22-year-old waved to the

spectators before turning towards the television cameras and shaking her head in celebration.

Didih established her as one of Africa's leading lifters by winning the 55 kg gold in the African championships in Moka, Mauritius, last year. Later in 2025, she also won the Commonwealth championships in Ahmedabad in 53kg. With the gold here, Didih has firmly established herself as the pre-

mier lifter in the Commonwealth.

Earlier, Gyaneshwari was on a roll in the snatch series, comfortably clearing 82, 85 and 88kg. Those effortless lifts suggested she was well poised for the clean and jerk.

But Didih was a different beast altogether. Every challenge Gyaneshwari posed, Didih answered with an even bigger lift, staying one step ahead throughout the contest.

Bindyarani's bronze adds to India's haul

K. Keerthivasan
GLASGOW

India's Bindyarani Devi settled for bronze in the women's 58kg weightlifting event with a total lift of 199kg. The 27-year-old, who won silver in the 55kg category at the previous Commonwealth Games in Birmingham, could not reproduce that form here, even as Nigeria's Rafiatu Folashade Lawal claimed gold (229kg).

The Indian lifted 83kg, 85kg and 87kg in snatch, followed by a best of 112kg in clean & jerk.

Lawal, the reigning Commonwealth Games champion (59kg), broke three records on her way to the title. She lifted 103kg in snatch, a Commonwealth and Games record, before clearing 126kg in clean & jerk, also a Games record. Her total of 229kg was a new Games record.



Bindyarani. GETTY IMAGES



Wait ends: Raja, who returned to the Commonwealth stage after an eight-year gap, earned his first medal at the Games. PTI

Bitter-sweet silver for Raja; no stopping Aznil

K. Keerthivasan
GLASGOW

Throughout his interaction with the Indian media on Sunday night after winning silver medal in the men's 65kg weightlifting event of the Commonwealth Games at the Scottish Event Campus, Raja Muthupandi remained glum.

Rated by Indian head coach Vijay Sharma as one of the country's bright medal prospects, the Tamil Nadu lifter finished with a total of 286kg, 13kg behind Malaysia's Muhamad Aznil Bin Bidin. Aznil clinched his third successive gold at the quadrennial event with a Games record of 299kg.

The 26-year-old Raja, son of a truck loader and an employee of Southern Railway, never looked at his best. He successfully completed only two of the six attempts — 126kg in snatch and 160 in clean and jerk.

In the snatch series, Raja failed to clear 126 in his first and 129 in the third

try. And in clean and jerk, Raja couldn't assert himself as he failed again in the first (158kg) and third (170) attempts.

In contrast, Aznil produced a flawless display, setting Games records in the snatch (133), clean and jerk (166) and total.

Raja did not shy away from admitting his disappointment. "My (Indian team) coach Vijay Sharma believed I could give my best for the gold. But I couldn't deliver," he said.

Expectations were high after his National record-breaking performance at the Nationals in Modinagar in February, where he lifted a total of 302kg (130 in snatch and 172 in clean & jerk).

He had finished sixth on his Commonwealth Games debut at Gold Coast in 2018 before an injury ruled him out of the Birmingham Games in 2022. Returning to the Commonwealth stage after an eight-year gap, Raja finally earned his first medal at the Games.

Sreeshankar, Sathyanathan, Shirse in final

Press Trust of India
GLASGOW

India's M. Sreeshankar qualified for the men's long jump final by breaching the automatic qualifying standard while Lokesh Sathyanathan advanced on the basis of his top-12 finish at the Commonwealth Games here on Monday.

Sreeshankar jumped 8.01m to earn direct qualification from Group A. The qualification standard was set at 8m or at least the 12 best performers.

Competing in Group B, Sathyanathan managed a jump of 7.77m in his first attempt. He finished fourth.

Tejas Shirse became the first Indian to qualify for the men's 110m hurdles final at the Games, finishing sixth overall in the heats with a timing of 13.76 seconds. The 24-year-old finished third in Heat 1.

Other Indian results: Men: Athletics: 100m: Gurindervir, 10.39s, second in Heat 4 and overall 28th.

Swimming: 200m butterfly: Sajjan Prakash, 1:58.59s, second in Heat 2, made it to the final after finishing sixth overall.

4x200m freestyle relay (final): Dhakshan Shashikumar, Aneesh Sunil Kumar Gowda, Aryan Nehra and Srihari Nataraj 7:29.84, finished sixth.

Lawn bowls: Putul Sonowal lost to Anwar Hamada (Ken) 0.5-1.5, finished fifth in Section D.

Women: Artistic gymnastics (final): Protistha Samanta, 12.883, ended up seventh.

Staying focused and strong do the trick for Anahat

SQUASH

Anirudh Velamuri

For four years, the World Juniors was Anahat Singh's ghost story — a quarterfinal exit here, a semifinal collapse there and an Egyptian racquet always standing in her way. She even called it a curse.

On Saturday, in her final year as a junior, she buried it. Anahat won in straight games in the final against Ruqayya Salem, ended Egypt's run of 13 straight titles, and secured a first for Indian squash.

"The score says 3-0, but it was definitely not comfortable. In a final, every single point feels like it's the last," she told *The Hindu*, in a virtual interaction facilitated by JSW Sports, on Monday.

Anahat felt she had a real shot at the title after the first two games — until things got tight in the third game.

She caught herself just in time, before the ghosts stirred again.

In the end, she lost just two games in the entire tournament and showed why she was the top seed



On a roll: Top seed Anahat lost just two games in the entire tournament. WORLD SQUASH

and India's No. 1 ranked player.

"The mental strength was always there, but I've not used it well. So I told myself to focus, get it done and then enjoy it all. Following a set routine really helped, and I think I have to follow it going forward."

That said, her nerves actually eased as the competition wore on.

"I was more stressed out in my first few rounds because you really need to get the momentum right. I

knew I was playing well and I was quite confident [going into the final]. I just wanted to get it over with because it was too stressful in the build-up to the tournament."

Yet even history has its blind spots. The 18-year-old's one regret? The winning moment itself.

"My celebration was really bad! Winning the title felt unreal, and so I couldn't think of anything in the moment," she added with a laugh.

Camaraderie will be an ally at the Olympiad, says Pragg

CHESS

C. Shyam Sundar
CHENNAI

Camaraderie among the members of the Indian Open squad will help in the Olympiad title defence, Grandmaster R. Praggnanandhaa said while expressing confidence of a strong show.

The 20-year-old felt the team was strong and had the experience to handle the pressure of being the defending champion. He said the core of the team from the winning campaign in 2024 was same time except for Nihal Sarin replacing P. Harikrishna.

"I think we are all very good friends. Being friends helps a lot when you are playing a team event like the Olympiad," he told *The Hindu* on the sidelines of an event at D.G. Vaishnav College here.

Asked if there would be huge pressure on India as the title-holder, Praggnanandhaa said, "There will always be pressure when you are representing the country. You want to do



Praggnanandhaa. FILE PHOTO

well. It's not about pressure from outside. It's more of an expectation from yourself that you will do well. We have experienced all this and are ready." He expected the home team Uzbekistan to be among the teams to beat in the Olympiad.

Backing Gukesh

About World champion D. Gukesh's below-par performances since winning the sport's biggest prize, Praggnanandhaa said, "He has won gold (board prize) and been part of a victorious Olympiad campaign. I don't know who else has done these things."

"He has shown that he belongs at the top. Sometimes everyone has these bad phases. This is just one of those".

Wong sizzles as Malaysia shocks top seed India

TABLE TENNIS

Amol Karhadkar
NEW DELHI

Top seed India suffered a shock defeat to underdog Malaysia in the 22nd Commonwealth Table Tennis Championships at the Thyagraj Stadium on Monday, serving an early reminder of the challenges that lie ahead this week and at the Asian Games in Japan in September.

Earlier in the day, India had thrashed Zimbabwe 3-0. On paper, the India-Malaysia contest appeared one-sided. Four Indian paddlers are ranked inside the world's top 100, while Malaysia's highest-ranked player, Wong Qi Shen, is only placed 202. But rankings counted for little as Wong produced a captain's performance, defeating both Harmeet Desai and World no. 38 Manav Thakkar to script one of Malaysia's memorable victories over India.

Manav had given India the ideal start with an easy win over Choong Javen, but Harmeet, returning to action after skipping UTT, was unable to match



Wong. AMOL KARHADKAR

Wong's consistency. The momentum swung Malaysia's way when Tey Hong Yu edged Manush Shah in a gripping contest, less than 24 hours after the Indian had guided U Mumba TT to the UTT-7 title in Goa.

With India trailing, Manav needed to overcome Wong to send the tie into a decider. The Indian fought valiantly before going down in five games.

ing to the quarterfinals.

"Malaysia played out of their skins and we were slightly off the mark. Perhaps you can call it a wake-up call, but I don't think we have too much to worry about. It was just an off-day for all three of our players," India coach Sourav Chakraborty told *The Hindu*.

Important results: Men: Malaysia bt India 3-1 (Choong Javen lost to Manav Thakkar 3-11, 3-11, 4-11; Wong Qi Shen bt Harmeet Desai 8-11, 11-9, 11-8, 11-7; Tey Hong Yu bt Manush Shah 11-13, 5-11, 11-5, 12-10, 11-7; Wong bt Manav 9-11, 11-8, 11-7, 3-11, 11-9); India bt Zimbabwe 3-0 (Manav bt Taenda Mumvuma 11-3, 11-2, 11-6; Harmeet bt Tapiwa Musarurwa 11-5, 11-4, 11-5; Payas Jain bt Vikram Singh 11-3, 11-3, 11-8); Malaysia bt Wales 3-0, England bt Cyprus 3-0, New Zealand bt Falkland Islands 3-0, Canada bt Scotland 3-0, Singapore bt Northern Ireland 3-0.

Women: Singapore bt Sri Lanka 3-2, India bt Maldives 3-0 (Sutirtha Mukherjee bt Fathimath Dheema Ali 11-4, 11-2, 11-5; Yashaswini Ghorpade bt Aishath Rafa Nazim 11-2, 11-5, 11-7; Swastika Ghosh bt Mishka Mohamed Ibrahim 11-3, 11-5, 11-2), Northern Ireland bt South Africa 3-2, Australia bt Bangladesh 3-0, England bt Cyprus 3-0, Malaysia bt Scotland 3-0.

INBRIEF



Koivun holds off Scheffler for PGA 3M Open title

Jackson Koivun, playing only his third PGA Tour event as a professional, held off top-ranked Scottie Scheffler in Sunday's final round to capture the 3M Open in record fashion. The 21-year-old American fired a five-under par 66 to finish 72 holes in a tournament record 25-under par 259 at Blaine in Minnesota (USA) and defeat Scheffler by three strokes.

Soumya Sarkar returns to Bangladesh's Test squad

The Bangladesh Cricket Board (BCB) announced a 15-member squad for the opening Test of the two-match series against Australia. The squad includes Soumya Sarkar, who returns to the Test set-up after last featuring in the format in 2021.

The squad: Najmul Hossain Shanto (Capt.), Soumya Sarkar, Shadman Islam, Tanzid Hasan, Mominul Haque, Mushfiqur Rahim, Amite Hasan, Jaker Ali Anik, Mehidy Hasan Miraz (vice-capt.), Taijul Islam, Taskin Ahmed, Hasan Mahmud, Syed Khaled Ahmed, Ebadot Hossain Chowdhury and Musfik Hasan.

FIFA president Infantino slams World Cup critics

FIFA president Gianni Infantino hit back at World Cup critics, claiming they were "spreading hate and false rumours" and arguing the tournament delivered "only joy and happiness". In a long open letter published on Monday, Infantino urged detractors to "take a moment to reflect, meditate, pray" after a tournament marked by controversies. "Sorry that you were so consumed by hate and criticism that you missed it all," Infantino wrote in a post shared on FIFA's official channels.



Pirlo bitter over debate that cost him Italy coaching job

Former Italy playmaker Andrea Pirlo, who was favoured for the national coaching post, expressed his bitterness on Monday over the debate which has led to him no longer being a candidate. The 47-year-old had become the favourite to be tasked with reviving the national side's fortunes after it failed to qualify for the World Cup for the third successive time. Whilst Pirlo had a stellar playing career, his coaching CV is short on success. A contract with a Russian betting firm had only added fuel to misgivings.

Brilliant Lad may score an encore

RACING

HYDERABAD: The four-year-old gelding Brilliant Lad, who won in his last start, may score an encore in the Royston Rock Plate, the main event of Tuesday's (July 28) races.

1 SHAMIRPET TROPHY (DIV. II) (1,200m), Maiden, 4-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 1.10 p.m.: 1. Analysis (2) G. Naresh 60, 2. Cypress (1) Kuldeep Sr. 59.5, 3. Darling Spirit (7) Suraj Narredu 58.5, 4. Mysore Pharaoh (2) Ajay K 58.5, 5. Divine Faith (6) B.R. Kumar 58, 6. Bold Indian (4) Md. Ismail 36, 7. Golden Aura (8) Abhay Singh 56 and 8. Midnight Beauty (5) Surya Prakash 54.

1. DARING SPIRIT,
2. DIVINE FAITH,
3. CYPRESS
2 SCARLET PRINCE PLATE (1,200m), (Terms) Maiden, 3-y-o only (Cat. II), 1.40: 1. Advait (8) Trevor 56, 2. Master Class (11) Gaurav 56, 3. Phoebus (12) Suraj Narredu 56, 4. Smashing Grey (14) P. Sai K 56, 5. Twilight King (7) P. Ajeerh K 56, 6. Vidyutprabhava (5) Md. Ismail 56, 7. Weseethamesun (13) Ajay K 56, 8. Wind Castle (9) Kuldeep Sr. 56, 9. Ane-mara (10) B.R. Kumar 54.5, 10. Kinship (6) B. Nikhil 54.5, 11. Love All (2) R.S. Jodha 54.5, 12. N R 1 Mega Power (4) Shivam 54.5, 13. Northern Sky (1) Rafique Sk. 54.5 and 14. Velveira (3) Akshay K 54.5.

1. ADVAIT, 2. MASTER CLASS,
3. TWILIGHT KING
3 FIRECREST PRINCE PLATE (DIV. II) (1,100m), 3-y-o and upward rated 40 to 65 (Cat. II) (No Whips), 2.10: 1. Dubai Touch (5) Neeraj 61.5, 2. Kalki (9) Surya Prakash 60, 3. Greif (2) P. Sai K 57.5, 4. Arion 61, 5. (4) B.R. Kumar 57.5, 5. Arthisha (4) B. Nikhil 55.5, 6. Tur-riya (7) Trevor 55.5, 7. Dashing

Charm (6) Akshay K 54.5, 8. First Lady (1) Shivam 52 and 9. Sweet Dancer (3) P. Ajeeth K 51.5.

1. DASHING CHARM,
2. GRIFF,
3. DUBAI TOUCH
4 MALAKPET PLATE (1,600m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 2.45: 1. Pride Aside (3) Kuldeep Jr. 61.5, 2. Orionvale (7) A.A. Vikrant 61, 3. Mountain Touch (5) Neeraj 60, 4. Divine Tiger (6) Akshay K 59.5, 5. Only My Way (2) Rafique Sk. 58, 6. Yuvraj (4) Kuldeep Sr. 57.5 and 7. La Fleuriere (1) Trevor 57.

1. DIVINE TIGER,
2. LA FLEURIERE,
3. MOUNTAIN TOUCH
5 SHAMIRPET TROPHY (DIV. I) (1,200m) Maiden, 4-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 3.20: 1. Dream To Fly (6) G. Naresh 60, 2. La Quinta (4) Ajay K 59, 3. Ek (2) Akshay K 58.5, 4. My Honey (5) Kuldeep Sr. 57, 5. Valledonna (1) Trevor 57, 6. Zindabad (8) B.R. Kumar 56, 7. Honey Luna (9) Abhay Singh 55, 8. Faizah (3) Rafique Sk. 53.5 and 9. Rate Of Interest (7) Santosh Raj 53.

1. EK, 2. LA QUINTA,
3. DREAM TO FLY
6 ROYSTON ROCK PLATE (1,200m) (Terms), Horses rated 50 and above (Cat. II), 3.55: 1. Born Brave (7) Shivam 60, 2. Brilliant Lad (6) Neeraj 60, 3. Walking Thunder (1) Trevor 60, 4. Calista Girl (4) B. Nikhil 56.5, 5. D Minchu (5) 6. N R 1 High Power (2) Akshay K 56.5, 3. Torchbearer (15) P. Ajeeth K 59.5, 4. Golden Gazelle

(2) Akshay K 59, 5. China Town (13) Kuldeep Sr. 58.5, 6. Arm-strong (1) A.A. Vikrant 57.5, 7. Clara (9) Kuldeep Jr. 57.5, 8. Wolf Creek (14) Ashad Asbar 56.5, 9. Corinthian (12) Trevor 55.5, 10. N R 1 Range (10) G. Naresh 55, 11. Clefairy (4) B. Nikhil 54.5, 12. Perfect Light (6) Surya Prakash 54.5, 13. Blue Pantheress (8) Rafique Sk. 54, 14. Lifes Journey (3) Gaurav 53, 15. Torobravo (11) Abhay Singh 52 and 16. Emperors Charm (6) Md. Ekram 50.

1. CORINTHIAN,
2. GLORIOUS POWER,
3. ARMSTRONG
8 FIRECREST PRINCE PLATE (DIV. I) (1,100m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 40 to 65 (Cat. II) (No Whips), 5.05: 1. Calistoga (9) Md. Ismail 62.5, 2. Best Buddy (1) Md. Ekram 60, 3. Rival (10) Ajay K 59.5, 4. Ayushmaan (8) Kuldeep Sr. 57.5, 5. Foxy Girl (3) Kuldeep Jr. 56, 6. Colt Pistol (6) Rafique Sk. 55.5, 7. See The Light (2) Akshay K 55, 8. Flying Fury (7) G. Naresh 52, 9. Jura-mento (4) Surya Prakash 52 and 10. Feel The Magic (5) B. Nikhil 50.

1. SEE THE LIGHT,
2. AYUSHMAAN,
3. FOXY GIRL
Day's Best: **DIVINE TIGER** Jackpot: 4, 5, 6, 7 & 8
Mini Jackpot: (i) 2, 3, 4 & 5, (ii) 5, 6, 7 & 8
Treble: (i) 1, 2 & 3, (ii) 3, 4 & 5, (iii) 2, 3, 4 & 5
Tanala: All races.

LIVE TELECAST

CWG 2026: Day 5, Sony Sports Ten 2 & LIV, 1 p.m.

Durand Cup: Sony Sports Ten 5 & LIV, 4.30 & 7.30 p.m.

West Indies vs Pakistan: First Test, Day 4, FanCode, 7.30 p.m.



On the podium: Yueyue, Esha, and Manu pose for a picture.

SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

standings with an outstanding score of 586-20x, closely followed by Esha in second place with 585-18x to comfortably advance to

the eight-shooter final. Ra-hi Sarnobat posted 582-16x, while Simranpreet Kaur Brar (576-20x) and Abhidnya Ashok Patil (573-

McGrath backs Prasad to play a key role going forward



Masterclass: McGrath and Senthilnathan interact with MRF Pace Foundation trainees. R. RAGU

next-gen pacers were making encouraging progress. "I think they've been doing okay. I'm a big fan of Prasad as well. It's always a big ask to fill the shoes of Shami and Bumrah, so it's always going to be a transitional period."

McGrath reserved special praise for Prasad, saying that the seamer had matured a lot since he first saw him.

"From seeing him when he was here (MRF Pace

Foundation) to watching him play IPL cricket, he just seemed to mature – his pace and just the way he was bowling, the way he held himself.

"He's tall, bowls good areas, gets that bounce and pace. It's the whole package, really. He was very much an enforcer when he bowled – just the way he went through the crease, the pace he was bowling at, the bounce, and the areas. Occasionally, he was

16x) delivered steady performances competing under Ranking Points Only (RPO) status.

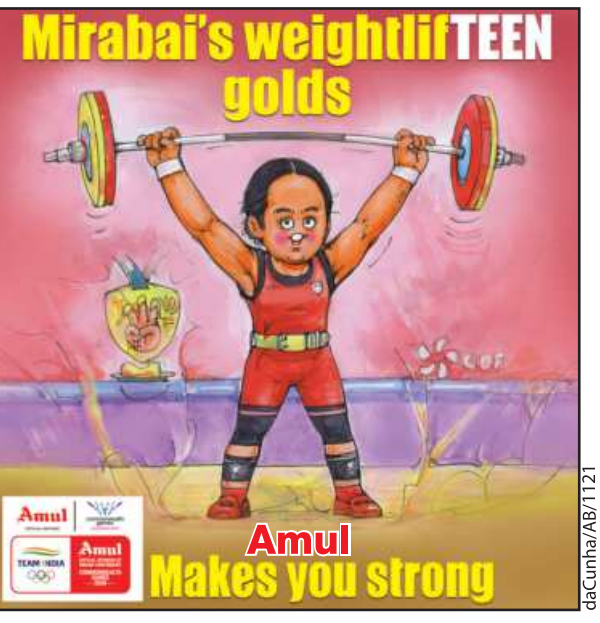
Reflecting on overcoming the mental pressure following her record-setting World Cup gold in Munich earlier this season, Esha said: "This match was very pressure-riding for me because of the previous medal I had.

"The better you get in your event, the more you feel that weight of prestige you have to conquer. I'm happy that I was able to get past it today and grateful that I had the ability to endure it."

Another landmark

The gold medal adds another landmark achievement for Esha, who hails from Hyderabad.

Earlier this season at the ISSF World Cup in Munich, Esha set both the senior and junior world records with 43 hits in the final.



Veteran sports scribe Jaswinder Sidhu passes away

Sports Bureau
NEW DELHI

Veteran sports journalist Jaswinder Sidhu passed away in a road accident on Sunday night. He was 54.

In a career spanning decades, Sidhu, always Jassi to his friends, worked primarily with *Amar Ujala* before branching out as an independent analyst.

A regular presence in most press boxes across India and overseas, Sidhu always kept the travelling press corps in good humour. He cracked one-liners, was helpful and forged a kinship with many sports writers, including those hailing from Pakistan's Punjab and Sindh.

The Sports Journalists'



Jaswinder Sidhu.

Federation of India (SJFI) expressed its profound grief and sorrow over Sidhu's demise. The Press Club of India condoled Sidhu's passing away through a post on X. "His dedication to sports journalism, unwavering professionalism and insightful reporting earned him immense respect across the media fraternity".

Mohammedan has it easy against Baghpat

DURAND CUP

Sports Bureau
KOLKATA

Mohammedan Sporting began its 135th Durand Cup campaign with a convincing 4-0 victory over Baghpat FC of Banaras at the Salt Lake Stadium here on Monday.

Fardin Ali Molla gave the home side the lead in the 29th minute, helping Mohammedan take a solitary-goal advantage into half-time even as Baghpat put up a disciplined defence.

The Kolkata outfit

stepped up the pressure after the break as substitute Lalremsanga Fanaï doubled the lead in the 73rd minute following some attacking changes made by coach Mehrajuddin Wadoo.

Israfil Dewan added a third in the 80th minute, before Fanaï scored his second goal in the 84th, finishing off a long ball from goalkeeper Subhadip Pandit with an impressive solo run.

The result:

Mohammedan Sporting 4 (Fardin Ali 29, Fanaï 73 & 84, Israfil Dewan 80) bt Baghpat FC 0.

Diablo wins feature

HYDERABAD: Trainer K.S.V. Prasad Raju's ward Diablo, ridden by P. Sai Kumar, won the Anab E Shahi Plate, the main event of Monday's (July 27) races here.

The winner is owned by M/s. Ashok Ranpise, Seshadri Reddy Pochana, Teegala Sumant Reddy, Teegala Vijender Reddy, Satish Kumar Reddy Poondla, Giri Prathamesh Mahadev, Bollineni Krishnaiah & Teja Gollapudi. Trainer R.H. Sequeira and jockey B.R. Kumar scored a treble each.

1. ADILABAD PLATE (DIV. I) (1,100m): MY WAY MY RULES (Akshay Kumar) 1, Queen Eternal (B.R. Kumar) 2, Trishka (Rafique Sk.) 3 and You Tuber (Md. Ekram) 4. Neck, 2-1/4 and 2-3/4. Im, 7.61s. ₹43 (w), 12, 12 and 17 (p). SHP: 46, THP: 41, FP: III, Q: 44, Tanala: 548. Favourite: Queen Eternal. Owner: Mr. Syed Mohiuddin Mufeed. Trainer: Magan Singh.

2. CON AMORE PLATE (DIV. II) (1,400m): PERCEPTION (G. Naresh) 1, Knight Crusader (B.R. Kumar) 2, Arabeska (Akshay K) 3 and Silver Act (P. Sai K) 4. 4-1/2. Neck and 1. Im, 25.70s. ₹54. Neck and 15 (p). SHP: 34, THP: 67, FP: 158, Q: 86, Tanala: 3.583. Favourite: Yali. Owners: M/s. N.V. Rohin Kumar & Vijay Anand Jangiti. Trainer: S. Sreekanth.

SNAPSHOTS

New Indian Football League season to begin on October 16

NEW DELHI: The next season of the Indian Football League (IFL) will begin on October 16, the AIFF said on Monday. Also among the key decisions made during the Governing Council meeting was the move to allow a maximum of three foreigners in a line-up. It is aimed at increasing game time for Indian players. "We also discussed the roadmap for the new season, including the proposed budgets," AIFF deputy secretary general M. Satyanarayan said.

Red Rangers takes the honours

CHENNAI: V.S. Ruthrappriya's four for 43 and R.S. Varsha's unbeaten 72 helped Red Rangers post a three-wicket win over Pink Warriors in the final and clinch the TNCA Freyer Cup One Day League tournament title.

The scores (final): Pink Warriors 224 in 49.3 overs (M. Anurakini 79, M.S. Aishwarya 41, V.S.



Triumphant: The victorious Red Rangers cricket team.



Champion: The SRM IST ball badminton squad with its big prize.

Ruthrappriya 4/43, D. Swagata 3/27) lost to Red Rangers 225/7 in 48.4 overs (K.R. Paar Mukhil 40, R.S. Varsha 72 n.o., Roshini Rajasekaran 52, M.S. Aishwarya 4/55).

Special awards: Best batter: M. Anurakini; **best bowler:** D. Swagata; **best all-rounder:** Sweata (Silver Strikers); **player-of-the-tournament:** B. Jenitha (Green Invaders).

SRM IST triumphs SRM IST emerged the champion of the State-level 'B' ball badminton tournament for men, organised by the R.J.J.S. Ball Badminton Club in Tiruchi. Thiruvottiyur Ball Badminton Club (TBBC) finished runner-up.

R. Kaushik

Two series, six matches. Two half-centuries, one Player of the Match award, one Player of the Series honour. That's Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's international CV thus far after an exhilarating, whirlwind July when he took his first, firm steps towards moving from boy wonder to a man for all seasons.

The 15-year-old's inclusion in the Indian T20I squads for the twin tours of Ireland and England was welcomed with more than a frisson of excitement and expectation. There ought to have been not a semblance of discussion on whether he should feature in the squad if not for his tender age, because especially in IPL 2026, he had showcased his exceptional talent with one bruising masterpiece after another. A season-high tally of 776 runs and the Orange Cap in his first full season should have, as it thankfully eventually did, been an automatic rite of passage to the national side. If there were any misgivings at all, it was because he was 15, not 18 or 19.

Sooryavanshi had battered the best bowlers in the world in the IPL, smashing them to smithereens and often instilling dread and fear as they ran in to deliver the little white orb because even the Cummins' and the Hazlewoods, the Bumrahs and the Rabadas, knew that the margin for error was miniscule. His consistency reiterated that he was more than just a one-trick pony. He blazed to 15-ball half-centuries for fun, the sixes flowed as if there was an invisible, illegal spring in his bat (something Sanath Jayasuriya was hilariously accused of after his pyrotechnics in the 1996 World Cup) and for the first time in many years (since maybe 1988?), India was transfixed by the breathtaking audacity of a teen phenom.

Not just India, of course. Such is the reach, magnetic pull and popularity of the world's most celebrated 20-over league that global audiences were treated to the Sooryavanshi magic. To see David take down Goliath is one of the time-tested endearing subtexts to any sporting contest. Tens of thousands willed the young lad to succeed not just for the novelty value but the sheer entertainment he provided, the joy he brought with uninhibited freedom which is often professed in the dressing room but hard to put into practice ball after ball, innings after innings.

Shreyas Iyer and Gautam Gambhir, the new leadership group of the T20I setup, chose to make the restless teenager wait for his baptism. Contrary to expectations that he would be blooded against the Irish in a series India were expected to dominate, Sooryavanshi watched from the sidelines as his colleagues crashed and

burned to an unprecedented, seismic 0-2 defeat, their first losses to the Irish in international cricket. He was eventually handed his India cap for the second of five T20Is against Harry Brook's England, in Manchester on July 4. His maiden outing fetched only 14 runs (off 10 balls), but there were two sixes thrown in, including one off Rajasthan Royals teammate Jofra Archer, a brief first appearance that suggested that he wasn't out of place in the bustling cauldron of

country vs country battle.

Sooryavanshi's next two outings in England weren't productive either - 13 off 5 balls in Nottingham, and 15 off 10 in Bristol - after which he was benched for the final game at Rose Bowl in Southampton. He must have watched with mounting frustration as, on an absolute belter, the hosts racked up 257 for three and India replied with a competitive but eventually woefully inadequate 201 for eight. There is no gainsaying how Sooryavanshi would have acquitted himself; whispers were starting to surface that the short ball into the body was a kryptonite of sorts, but there is little sustained evidence to support that theory. England brought the young lad 42 runs off 25 deliveries with one four and five sixes, hardly sensational but definitely not enough to write him off.

In Zimbabwe in the week gone by, however, the international game was privileged to witness the phenomenon reprise his IPL magic. Sooryavanshi has quite a tryst with the Harare Sports Club, where Shreyas' bunch locked horns with the host nation in a three-match showdown. India had gone through seven winless games in Ireland and England, losing six with one game (the opening fixture against England) abandoned halfway through, and Shreyas desperately needed a victory against his name after a horror start to his T20I captaincy stint.

Happy hunting ground

He needn't have worried too much, as it turned out. After all, he had the ace in his pack, a young man who dug into his memory bank, dredged up happy thoughts of his time at the Harare Sports Club, and brutalised a solid Zimbabwe pace attack spearheaded by the towering Blessing Muzarabani and the left-armed, Richard Ngarava.

Muzarabani, more than his left-handed counterpart, had played a big part in Zimbabwe making it to the Super 8 of the T20 World Cup earlier this year at the expense of fancied former champions Australia. Standing six feet eight inches (203 cms) in his socks, he used his height to great advantage, fusing bounce with movement to resemble a one-man wrecking ball. Muzarabani finished as the joint second-highest wicket-taker of the tournament; his 13 scalps (only one behind Jasprit Bumrah and Varun Chakaravarthy) came in only six bowls, his strike rate of 11 balls per wicket bettered among the top-five wicket-takers only by Shadley van Schalkwyk (6.84) of the United States, who also ended up with 13 wickets. He was expected to give India's batters, who had a miserable run in England, a torrid time, but Sooryavanshi had other plans.

In February, at the same venue, Sooryavanshi had made the Under-19 World Cup final against England a ridiculously one-sided affair well before the halfway stage of the contest. After Ayush Mhatre chose to bat, the left-handed opener went

India's youngest international cricketer, male or female, became the youngest half-centurion in all T20Is when he lashed an even 50 in the first encounter against Zimbabwe



In Zimbabwe, in the week gone by, the international game was privileged to witness the phenomenon reprise his IPL magic

on the rampage, tearing into the shell-shocked English boys with utter disdain.

Boundaries cascaded off his bat with remarkable regularity; he reached his 50 off 32 deliveries, took only 23 more to bring up his century, and went from 100 to 150 in a mere 16 balls. By the time he was dismissed, gloving a slog-sweep to the wicketkeeper, he had hurtled to 175, from just 80 deliveries, with 15 power-packed fours and an equal number of towering sixes. He had accounted for 69.72% of the runs India had scored (251) till he was at the crease. Sooryavanshi's blitzkrieg ended off the third delivery of the 26th over, just past the halfway stage of the Indian innings. Who knows what he would have finished with had he batted for even a half-hour more.

In Sooryavanshi's corner on that occasion was Hrishikesh Kanitkar as the head coach, with former India left-arm spinner Sunil Joshi too travelling as the bowling/spin coach. And, of course, there was V.V.S. Laxman , the wonderfully affable and positive-talking Hyderabad who has quietly elevated the profile of the Centre of Excellence (previously the National Cricket Academy) without getting either his due or craving for approbation and plaudits, who travelled for the second half of the Under-19 World Cup as the team's mentor, among other things.

While Kanitkar wasn't in Harare this last week, both Laxman and Joshi were. With Gambhir and his support staff taking a break ahead of the Test tour of Sri Lanka beginning in a little over a week's time, Laxman stepped in as the interim head coach, like he has done quite a few times in the past, with Joshi for support. Perhaps, the familiarity with the ground, previous dizzying success at the venue and a sense of ease around the coaching staff that has overseen his progress over the last year and a bit helped calm Sooryavanshi down. He was clearly in his elements, reprising the destructive avatar that made him such a compelling attraction during the IPL.

India's youngest international cricketer, male or female, became the youngest half-centurion in all T20Is when he lashed an even 50 in the first encounter on Thursday, July 23. The half-century came off only 18 deliveries, though he saw off the Muzarabani threat with commonsense rather than bravado. India were chasing a modest target of 126 and Sooryavanshi's early blitz powered them to a commanding victory with 40 deliveries to spare, though the Player-of-the-Match award went to pacer Mayank Yadav for his spell of two for 18. After a whirlwind nine-ball 20 in Saturday's game two, Sooryavanshi went into overdrive in the final, dead rubber on Sunday. In the clearest indication yet that he has a terrific cricket brain nestled in that young, still developing head, Sooryavanshi batted with tremendous maturity and intelligence on a worn surface where the bounce was uneven and where the ball didn't exactly gush on to the bat.

Laxman believes that Sooryavanshi will progress and break all records at the international level as he has the potential and ability to do that

No half-measures

Sooryavanshi picked the balls to attack with care and diligence, but when he went on the offensive, he didn't hold back. There were no half-measures, his commitment to the stroke indisputably maximal. Abhishek Sharma fell cheaply again and the normally fluent Ishan Kishan struggled for timing, but Sooryavanshi seemed immune to the vagaries of the pitch.

His fifty appeared measured, yet it came off just 31 deliveries; as he raced into the 80s, visions of a maiden century loomed until he fell to a wonderful catch in the deep by Brad Evans. His final returns - 81 off 49, eight fours, four sixes. As India completed a comfortable 35-run victory to seal a 3-0 series sweep, there was only one candidate for both the match and the series honours. Welcome to the world of international cricket, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi. And what's the fuss all about, right? Laxman's personality doesn't lend itself to hyperbole, so when he says something, you know that that's precisely what he means. He was glowing in his praise of the young lad, extolling his maturity and cricket smarts not just during the last week but over the last six months, from the Under-19 World Cup onwards.

"He's got a long career ahead, and he has the attitude and mindset to improve every day," the magician with wrists of steel proclaimed. "I'm sure he will progress and break all the records at the international level. He's got all the potential and ability to do that."

Over to you now, young man, to prove the great man right.

THE GIST

Sooryavanshi needn't have worried too much, as it turned out. After all, he had the ace in his pack, a young man who dug into his memory bank, dredged up happy thoughts of his time at the Harare Sports Club

Sooryavanshi picked the balls to attack with care and diligence, but when he went on the offensive, he didn't hold back. There were no half-measures, his commitment to the stroke indisputably maximal

Laxman was glowing in his praise of the young lad, extolling his maturity and cricket smarts not just during the last week but over the last six months, from the Under-19 World Cup onwards

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Income tax returns filed for assessment year 2026-27

4 in crores. More than four crore income tax returns have been filed so far for the 2026-27 assessment year, the Income Tax Department said. The department urged taxpayers to file ITR-1 (Sahaj) and ITR-2 before the July 31 deadline. ITR-1 is meant for eligible resident individuals with an annual income of up to ₹50 lakh from specified sources. PTI

Death toll in attack by armed assailants on Nigerian village

30 At least 30 people were killed when armed men attacked the Naridon village in Nigeria's Kaduna state, according to residents. The assailants reportedly opened fire and set houses ablaze during the overnight raid. Eight children were among those killed, while four others were injured. No group has claimed responsibility for the attack. REUTERS

People charged alongside Hasina by Bangladesh tribunal

40 Prosecutors at Bangladesh's International Crimes Tribunal filed charges against former Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina and 40 others in a crimes against humanity case linked to the 2013 police crackdown on a Hefazat-e-Islam rally in Dhaka. The tribunal also issued arrest warrants for the fugitives, while nine accused are already in custody awaiting trial. PTI

Pending consumer cases threshold for forum rationalisation

1000 disputes. The Supreme Court has allowed States with fewer than 1,000 pending consumer cases to abolish some district consumer forums and transfer those cases to serving judicial officers, subject to prior approval from the jurisdictional high courts. The direction aims to improve the dispute redressal mechanisms. PTI

Death toll from Ukrainian drone strikes on Russia

5 Ukrainian drone strikes on Russia killed five people, including a child, in the Rostov region, according to Russian officials. Moscow said that it intercepted 276 drones overnight, while Ukraine said it struck an export terminal in Rostov and oil facilities in the Yaroslavl and Udmurtia regions as part of its long-range attacks. AFP
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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The next chapter for Education Ministry

As Pralhad Joshi takes charge of the Education Ministry, several key 'reforms' remain under way, including the National Curriculum Framework, the Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan Bill, the three-language formula, and new teacher-training initiatives in school education

EXPLAINER

M. Kalyanaraman

The story so far:

Pralhad Joshi, the new Union Minister for Education, inherits a range of structural changes to Indian education initiated by Dharmendra Pradhan.

Mr. Pradhan's exit as Education Minister has been under a cloud, but his five-year tenure was marked by a ramping up of efforts to implement the National Education Policy 2020, which the Union Cabinet had accepted a year before he took charge. Earlier, at the Petroleum Ministry, he had made his mark on programme implementation by delivering eight crore LPG connections to poor households in three years against a four-year target.

From the National Curriculum Framework, flexible learning and multidisciplinary, and the Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan Bill (VBSA), to PM SHRI, the three-language formula and new teacher-training initiatives in school education, his Ministry was constantly in the news for introducing "reforms." Common threads ran through them: performance evaluation and accountability, skilling-education convergence, promotion of a certain vision of Indianness, ambition undercut by implementation challenges, and a push for uniformity that critics called centralisation and a disregard for diversity. Almost all remain works-in-progress that the new Education Minister will have to carry forward.

NEP's recommendations on foundational literacy

Through Nipun Bharat, formally launched by Mr. Pradhan's predecessor on the heels of pandemic-era learning losses, the government was finally acting on decades of evidence from surveys by voluntary organisations that India's schoolchildren



Union Minister Pralhad Joshi took additional charge of the Ministry of Education on July 26. ANI

were lagging far behind in reading and math, despite formally graduating year after year. It seeks to ensure every child attains foundational literacy and numeracy – a concept advocated by NEP – by the end of Grade 3, by 2026-27. ASER 2024 showed a seven-percentage-point gain in numeracy since 2018, and PARAKH 2024 found Grade 3 students who benefited from the mission's first three years, outperforming Grades 6 and 9 in language and math. Yet fewer than a quarter of students nationally could read a Grade 2 text, and Grade 5 levels remained roughly where they were pre-pandemic – a sign of implementation gaps that may well necessitate a Nipun Bharat 2.0.

The push to boost teaching quality

Though standards for teachers are common in advanced nations, the National Professional Standards for Teachers (NPST) is India's first initiative to assess and classify teachers – as proficient, expert or advanced – against uniform national standards, with career

progression tied to this ladder. The National Mentoring Mission, meant to identify mentor teachers to guide others up this ladder through nomination and volunteering, is being rolled out with online sessions, but awareness among the country's one crore teachers remains low and impact assessments are yet to be formalised. NPST itself has not been rolled out, leaving teachers little incentive to engage with the mentoring sessions.

Key changes attempted in higher education

Some initiatives drew sharper controversy. The 2025 draft UGC regulations on appointing teachers, Vice-Chancellors and staff faced strong opposition – notably for giving governors a decisive say in Vice-Chancellor appointments and for removing the cap on contractual professorships. Separately, the UGC's new undergraduate and postgraduate degree rules, built around flexibility and multidisciplinary to create a skilled workforce, have been formally in force since the 2025 academic year – but

institutions across States are still barely grasping radical concepts such as a commerce student studying science, or transferring credits across colleges via the National Credit Framework.

An example of education-skilling convergence is the Swayam Plus platform, which offers over 500 industry-developed courses across 15 sectors, including emerging technologies. Some 6.5 lakh have registered for these courses. The new modules under "AI for All" have reportedly drawn one lakh registrations. Courses such as AI for Physics, AI for Chemistry, AI in Accounting, AI for Educators, and AI/ML using Python are intended to be skilling courses for professionals that are supposed to make them job ready. The key gap is that most colleges that come under State universities are often resistant to changing the idea of giving a package deal and accept flexibility in accepting credits. There is an awareness gap, too.

While the higher education initiatives appear aspirational and sound grand on paper, there is little or no funding allocation to State universities to accomplish such flexibility. The VBSA in fact has no grant giving function – a key element of the University Grants Commission that it seeks to replace.

The controversy over language policy

Mr. Pradhan also pushed to steamroll NEP adoption – particularly the three-language policy – by tying central funding for primary education schemes to compliance by States. Tamil Nadu remains a holdout, though West Bengal's new government has accepted it. In CBSE schools, Mr. Pradhan directly mandated the learning of two *Bharatiya* languages from Classes 6 to 12, prioritising Indian languages over English. Some relief has been granted to current students, but the government has held firm on this as the norm going forward – even though NEP, in the same breath as it champions Indian languages, also emphasises the learning of English and other foreign languages.

THE GIST

▼ Dharmendra Pradhan's exit as Education Minister has been under a cloud, but his five-year tenure was marked by a ramping up of efforts to implement the National Education Policy 2020.

▼ Pradhan pushed to steamroll NEP adoption – particularly the three-language policy – by tying central funding for primary education schemes to compliance by States.

What is India's policy on urea production?

What are the key changes in the National Investment Policy for Urea 2026?

A. M. Jigeesh

Amid concerns of fertilizer shortage during the ongoing kharif season due to the situation in West Asia, greater demand because of *El Niño* and complaints of over-use of chemical fertilizers such as urea, the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs recently approved the National Investment Policy for Urea (NIPU)-2026.

The new policy is aimed at self-reliance in urea production, a sector which is dependent on imports. According to the Government, the policy will encourage new investments in the urea sector for setting up the gas-based urea manufacturing units in the country.

The key changes in the policy, compared to the existing policy, include the separation of fixed and variable costs for greater transparency, introduction of a viable Return on Equity (RoE) band with a floor at 12% and a ceiling at 16%, and

mitigation of foreign exchange risk through conversion of fixed cost into Indian rupees after four years based on prevailing exchange rates.

How has the urea policy evolved?

The Union Government had announced such a policy for urea sector in 2012, 2013 and it was amended in October 2014 to facilitate fresh investment.

Six new urea units have been set up under the 2012 policy, which includes four set up through Joint Venture Companies (JVC) of nominated PSUs and two set up by the private companies. At present, there are 33 operational urea manufacturing units with total reassessed/installed capacity of 269.42 Lakh Metric Tonnes (LMT), according to the Union Fertilizers Ministry.

"There is a need to increase the indigenous production of Urea. There is a gap in the indigenous production and demand of urea in the country which is filled by the import of urea," the

Government had said.

The Government amended the policy further in May 2015 for the existing 25 gas-based urea units and it led to additional production of urea by 20-25 LMT as compared to the production during 2014-15 annually.

From 225 LMT per annum during 2014-15, the current production from all these units has reached 314.07 LMT during 2023-24. "During 2025-26, 293.30 LMT of Urea was produced in the country," the Government says.

What is India's fertilizer subsidy bill?

The total fertilizers subsidy in 2025-26 is ₹ 2,17,281.10 crore. In 2024-25, it was ₹1,77,162.06 crore. Out of this, the urea subsidy alone for 2025-26 was ₹1,42,175.74 crore and for 2024-25 it was ₹1,24,319.50 crore. For phosphorus, and potassium, the subsidy component is ₹74,999.99 crore and ₹52,810 crore respectively. For promotion of organic fertilizers, the Government provided a subsidy of

₹105.37 crore and ₹32.56 crore in the last two financial years.

How is urea made available?

According to the data provided by the Government in Parliament, as on March 3, 2026, the country has the requirement of 370.84 LMT of urea for the kharif season. The availability is 432.44 LMT, out of which 381.59 LMT will be for sale under Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) system where all subsidised fertilizers will be sold to buyers is made through Point of Sale (PoS) devices "installed at each retailer shop and the beneficiaries are identified through Aadhaar Card, KCC, Voter Identity Card etc". In 2024-25, the requirement was 364.01 LMT and availability was 443.83 LMT.

The Government claims that it has taken steps to promote the balanced and efficient use of fertilizers. "The Government is promoting Integrated Nutrient Management (INM), which advocates the judicious and scientific integration of organic sources, chemical fertilizers, and biological inputs for efficient and sustainable nutrient management," the Ministry said adding that the INM aims to meet the nutrient requirements of crops in an economical and environmentally sustainable manner while maintaining long-term soil fertility. It had also experimented with Nano Urea, which is yet to get popularity among farmers, apparently after controversies over its scientific efficacy and result.

THE GIST

▼ The Centre recently approved the National Investment Policy for Urea (NIPU)-2026, which is aimed at self-reliance in urea production, a sector which is dependent on imports.

▼ The Union Government had announced such a policy for urea sector in 2012, 2013 and it was amended in October 2014 to facilitate fresh investment.

CACHE

What can be done to address the CBSE evaluation controversy?

The Supreme Court's concern over 'frustrated young minds' has renewed focus on the unresolved CBSE On-Screen Marking (OSM) controversy. A simple SOP could still restore fairness, accountability, and public trust in digital evaluation.

Rajeev Kumar

India witnessed two major examination-related controversies in the summer of 2026–NEET and the Central Board of Secondary Education's (CBSE) On-Screen Marking (OSM) crisis. Both predominantly affected Class XII students. In both cases, the then Union Education Minister assured the nation that no student would suffer injustice. However, the national response to the two controversies differed sharply.

Alleged irregularities in NEET, involving admissions to about 1.4 lakh medical seats, rightly led to Re-NEET 2026, nationwide debate, judicial scrutiny, organisational restructuring, and policy reforms on an unprecedented scale. In contrast, the unresolved CBSE-OSM controversy, which affected nearly 18 lakh Class XII students, received comparatively little public attention despite its much wider academic impact.

Around 98 lakh answer scripts had already been digitised under OSM system. Yet only about 4 lakh students could access nearly 11 lakh evaluated scripts, leaving around 14 lakh students without a meaningful opportunity to verify their evaluation or seek correction of genuine errors. Complaints about portal glitches, payment failures, blurred scans, missing pages, mismatches in answer sheets, and other procedural deficiencies remained largely unaddressed. Even the limited scrutiny that followed revealed substantial mark revisions after re-evaluation, raising serious questions about the robustness of the review process.

The issue eventually reached the Supreme Court through a public interest litigation (PIL). Referring to the “frustration of young children” and the “creeping problems” in the OSM process, the Court highlighted concerns that went beyond individual grievances to the integrity of the evaluation system itself.

The central issue is no longer whether mistakes occurred. It is whether every student was given an equal opportunity to verify the evaluation, identify genuine errors, and have them corrected. This transparency gap can still be bridged through a simple, practical, and time-bound reform.

Why was re-evaluation uptake so low?

The limited number of students who reached the re-evaluation stage reflected structural flaws in the OSM review process. Unlike the earlier pen-and-paper system, where answer scripts had to be retrieved and digitised on request, every OSM answer script had already been digitised during evaluation. In principle, every student could therefore have been given immediate access to an authenticated digital copy of the evaluated answer script.

Instead, the OSM review process required students to apply, pay the prescribed fee, and rely on an online portal to access records that were already in digital form. They also had to verify the completeness and authenticity of their answer scripts before seeking re-evaluation. However, portal glitches, payment failures, delayed access, and overlapping verification and re-evaluation timelines left little time to detect and



Sparse attention: The CBSE-OSM crisis, which affected nearly 18 lakh Class XII students, received comparatively little public attention. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

report deficiencies before the review window closed.

As a result, access to re-evaluation depended more on overcoming procedural and technical barriers than on the merit of a student's grievance. While a small fraction of students completed the process, the overwhelming majority never had the opportunity to determine whether genuine evaluation errors had affected their results. In a digital evaluation system, transparency should begin with universal access to evaluated answer scripts, not with procedural hurdles that deny students an equal opportunity to seek redressal.

What remains unresolved in the OSM crisis?

The answer scripts that underwent independent scrutiny revealed serious concerns, including blurred scans, missing pages, mismatches in answer sheets, and substantial mark revisions after re-evaluation. In one widely reported case, a student's History marks increased from 74 to 97, and in another, a student was elevated to the position of a CBSE topper. Such outcomes demonstrate that the review process could correct significant evaluation errors – but only for those who managed to access it. If serious deficiencies emerged from this limited scrutiny, it is reasonable to ask what a universal review might have revealed, leaving open the possibility of a much larger Pandora's box.

The unresolved issue is the absence of equal opportunity. Students who could not access their evaluated answer scripts were denied the chance to verify whether similar errors had affected their own

results. In a digital evaluation system, transparency cannot remain selective. Unless every student has a fair opportunity to verify the accuracy of the evaluation, public confidence in the OSM system will remain incomplete.

Can the crisis still be resolved?

Since every answer script already exists in digital form, CBSE can still restore transparency through a simple ‘seven-day framework’. On the first day, authenticated digital copies of evaluated answer scripts should be made available to all students. The next three days should be devoted to verifying the completeness and authenticity of the scripts, including identifying blurred scans, missing pages, omitted supplementary sheets, and mismatches in the answer sheets. After rectifying any verified deficiencies, the remaining four days should be reserved for re-evaluation of genuine grievances.

At the end of the process, CBSE should publish anonymised statistics on verification requests, deficiencies detected, re-evaluations conducted, and mark revisions made. This framework requires no new technology or major expenditure. It simply ensures that every student has an equal opportunity to verify the fairness of the evaluation, thereby strengthening transparency, accountability, and public confidence in the OSM system.

Who is accountable?

The OSM controversy is no longer merely a technical issue; it is a question of governance and accountability. Responsibility rests with the CBSE, which was expected to design, monitor, and

continuously improve the evaluation process, as well as with the Ministry of Education for effective oversight. The inability to address systemic deficiencies and restore students' confidence points to shortcomings in institutional governance.

The Central Information Commission (CIC), exercising its powers under Section 25(5) of the RTI Act, had already advised CBSE to frame comprehensive SOPs, describing them as “the dire need of today's scenario”. Yet these SOPs remain unpublished. The priority now is to implement a transparent and robust framework that ensures every student has an equal opportunity to verify the fairness and accuracy of the evaluation.

What can be the way forward?

The new Union Minister for Education now has an opportunity to bridge the transparency gap in the OSM system. The proposed ‘seven-day transparency framework’ offers a practical, low-cost roadmap to ensure universal access to evaluated answer scripts, timely verification, and transparent grievance redressal.

The credibility of the OSM system will ultimately be judged by its ability to deliver transparency, fairness, and equal opportunity to every student. If these reforms are implemented with urgency, the Supreme Court's “frustrated young minds” can become millions of smiling faces, confident that their performance has been evaluated fairly, transparently, and justly.

(Prof. Rajeev Kumar is a former Computer Science Professor at IIT Kharagpur, IIT Kanpur, BITS Pilani, and JNU, and a former scientist at DRDO and DST.)



FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

What is the meaning and origin of “not be up to scratch”? (M. Ganesh, Mysore)

When you say that something is “not up to scratch” it means that it is not up to the mark. It is not of an acceptable standard or quality. Here are some examples.

I find that Alok's designs aren't up to scratch.

The tests showed that the new recruits were not up to scratch.

This is an idiom that comes from the world of boxing. In the old days when boxing was still a primitive sport, a line was drawn in the centre of the ring. The line was called a “scratch”. Nowadays whenever a boxer is knocked down during the bout, all he/she has to do is to stand up before the referee counts to ten. During the early days of boxing, the contestant who had been knocked down had to demonstrate that he was in control of his faculties by walking to the line (‘scratch’) within 38 seconds. If the boxer was unable to come up to the ‘scratch’ within the allotted time, then he was considered unfit to continue the fight.

What is the question tag to be used for “I am a boy”? (K. Sathis Kumar, Kasargod)

The question tag that is normally used is “aren't I?”. This would be considered standard. In informal contexts one could also say “ain't I?”. The word “ain't” however is considered non-standard. It is also possible to say “am I not?”

What is the meaning of “carte blanche”? (B. Balaji, Pondicherry)

The first word “carte” is pronounced like the word “cart”. The “a” in “blanche” is pronounced like the “o” in “hot” and “cot”. The final “che” sounds like the “sh” in words like “should”, “shut”, and “ship”. As you have probably guessed, the expression comes from French.

When you give someone “carte blanche”, you give them total freedom to do whatever they want. The literal French meaning of carte blanche is “blank document”. Therefore when you are given “carte blanche” you are given complete freedom or authority to do whatever you think is right. For example:

The new Director was given carte blanche to do what he wanted.

Is it OK to say, “Australia's Northern Territory passed an euthanasia law”? (C. Selvamani, Bangalore)

We generally use the article “an” before words that begin with a vowel sound. Do not get confused between “sound” and “letter”. The words “university” and “unique” begin with a vowel – at least in spelling. But when you pronounce these two words they begin with a consonant sound. Therefore one has to use the indefinite article “a” and not “an” before these two words. We have to say “a unique person” and “a university”.

Similarly, the word “euthanasia”, though it begins with a vowel letter, when the word is pronounced, the first sound is a consonant one. Therefore the article that will precede it is “a”. It should be “a euthanasia law”. Euthanasia as you know is sometimes referred to as “mercy killing”. It is the act of painlessly killing an individual who has no hope of recovering from the disease that is slowly killing him. Euthanasia is illegal in most countries. Published in *The Hindu* on May 29, 2001

THE DAILY QUIZ

With Sarnath becoming India's 45th UNESCO World Heritage Site, here's a quiz on the other sites in the country

V.V. Ramanan

QUESTION 1

Apart from the Taj Mahal, which other properties from India were the first to be given UNESCO World Heritage Site status in 1983?

QUESTION 2

What is unique about the Khangchendzonga National Park inscribed to the list in 2014?

QUESTION 3

Name the inscribed property that is spread across Tamil Nadu, West Bengal and

Himachal Pradesh?

QUESTION 4

Name the two sites that were at different times part of 'World Heritage in Danger' list?

QUESTION 5

Which site is transnational, being shared with six other countries?

QUESTION 6

Inscribed in 2003, which site exhibits the earliest traces of human life in India?

QUESTION 7

Which Indian currency notes feature the Konark Sun Temple and the Sanchi Stupa?



Visual question: Name this World Heritage Site and the State in which it is located. GETTY IMAGES

Questions and answers to the previous day's daily quiz: 1. Vincent van Gogh's painting 'The Starry Night' depicts' the view from the window of this institution where he was staying. **Ans: The Saint-Paul-de-Mausole asylum in Saint-Rémy-de-Provence, France**

2. This fellow artist was invited by Van Gogh to live and work with him in the “Yellow House” at Arles. **Ans: Paul Gauguin**

3. Van Gogh was deeply influenced by Japanese woodblock prints, a style collectively known by this Japanese term. **Ans: Ukiyo-e**

4. Van Gogh's profession before he decided to become an artist. **Ans: He worked as an art dealer (and later also served as a teacher, bookseller's assistant and lay preacher)**

5. Van Gogh died in July 1890 in this French village. **Ans: Auvers-sur-Oise**

Visual: This is generally believed to be the only painting Vincent van Gogh sold during his lifetime. Identify it. **Ans: The Red Vineyard (The Red Vineyard at Arles)**

Early birds: Tamal Biswas| K.N. Viswanathan| Erfanally Oosmany| Piyali Tuli| Arun Kumar Singh

Word of the day

Corroborate:

to confirm or support something

Synonyms: endorse, verify

Usage: *The findings corroborate earlier research on climate change.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/corroborate

International Phonetic Alphabet: /keɪˈbɒrəreɪt/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Text & Context'